

בְּשִׂיאתֵיבִשְׂאֵת מְעוֹכָה = בְּשִׂיאתֵיבִשְׂאֵת מְעוֹכָה, “In/at/by a/the devastated top/-height.”

Both מָנוֹס (masc.) and מְנוּסָה (fem., from the root נוּס, “to escape,” with a locative *mem*) mean “escape, flight, place of refuge.” E.g., אָבֵד מָנוֹס מִמֶּנִּי, “the refuge has been lost for me” (Ps. 142:5); וּבִמְנוּסָה לֹא תֵלְכוּן, “and by flight you shall not go” (Isa. 52:12); “and let not your inclination ensure you that Sheol is מָנוֹס (a refuge) for you” (m. 'Avot 4:22). Mishnaic Hebrew and Aramaic often add בֵּית, “house of,” before a noun describing a place of something, whether it has a locative *mem* or not. Thus, מָנוֹס = בֵּית מָנוֹס, “place of refuge”; מִקְדָּשׁוֹהַמִּקְדָּשׁ = בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ, “(the) Sanctuary/Temple”; אֹצֵר = בֵּית אוֹצֵר, “storehouse” (see #4, 1:10; #33, 8:1-2).²⁷

Lurie suggests that Manos was the owner or the person after whom the staircase was named. He points out that in the Talmud a similar name רַבִּי מְנַס, Rabbi Simeon ben Menasia occurs.²⁸ Indeed, מָנָס, Mannas, could be a shortened form of מְנַסִּיא, Menasia, and both may be later forms of מְנַשֶּׁה, Manasseh (Gen. 41:51), exhibiting a *šin-samekh* interchange; cf. שִׁמְעוֹן, Simeon (Gen. 29:33), vs. סִימון, Simon.²⁹ Thus, בְּשִׂיאת הַמְּסָבָא שֶׁל מְנוֹס could mean, “In the tower of the staircase of Manos/Mannas,” or “In the staircase tower of Manos/Mannas” (cf. Lurie).

(1:13) בִּירְדָּהוּבִירְדָּה לְשִׁמּוֹאֵל לְשִׁמּוֹאֵל (= בִּירְדָּהוּבִירְדָּה לְשִׁמּוֹאֵל לְשִׁמּוֹאֵל), “in the descent to the left” — ALLEGRO^{pr}: “in one of the sides of the image.” ALLEGRO: בִּירְדָּה לְשִׁמּוֹל, “in the left-hand side.”³⁰ MILIK: בִּירְדָּה אֶל סִמֵּל, “going down to the left.”³¹ LURIE: בִּירְדָּה לְשִׁמּוֹל, “in the descent to the left side (of the cave).”³² PIXNER: “when descending on the left hand side.”³³ WOLTERS: בִּירְדָּה לְשִׁמּוֹל, “on the way down to the left.” יִרְדָּה may be the name of the “steps descending into the cistern.”³⁴ BEYER: בִּירְדָּה אֶל סִמֵּל, “in the wall to the left.”³⁵ GARCIA MARTINEZ and VERMES follow Milik, while Wise agrees with Lurie.³⁶

27 See Bendavid 1, 182; 2, 444.

28 Lurie, 66 n. 3. This Tanna is mentioned several times in the Rabbinic literature; e.g., m. Hag. 1:7; t. Hag. 1:7; 'Avot - Qinyan Torah 6:8; y. Ma'as. Sh. 2:4 (10a); b. Hag. 9:1; Eccl. Rabbah 1:37.

29 E.g., the Amora ר' שִׁמְעוֹן בֶּן פִּזִּי (y. Suk. 4:6 [18b] and b. Ber. 10a, 61a, respectively). סִימון is a Hellenized form of שִׁמְעוֹן where the 'ayin disappeared; see B.Z. Bacher, “ר' סִימון,” in OY 7, 179b-80a.

30 Allegro, 33 (בִּירְכָא is a printing error for בִּירְכָה); Allegro^{rev}, 21.

31 Milik, 284-85; Milik^E, 169.

32 Lurie, 65, 66 n. 5, 67.

33 Pixner, 344.

34 “The Fifth Cache,” 176; Wolters, 32-33.

35 Beyer, 225-26.

36 Garcia Martinez, 461; Vermes, 374; Wise, 191.

The first word of this phrase consists of the preposition *bet* or *kaf*, followed by the letters *yod/waw*, *dalet/reš*/final *kaf* (the bottom of the leg is missing due to a lacuna), plus an *'alef*. This *'alef* may belong to the next letter *lamed*, creating the word *אֶל*, “to.”

The second part of this phrase can be read as *לְסָמַל* = *לְשִׁמּוּאֵל* = *לְשִׁמּוּאֵל* = *לְשִׁמּוּאֵל*, or *אֶל סָמַל* = *אֶל שִׁמּוּאֵל*. *סָמַל* is a defective spelling for *שִׁמּוּאֵל*, plus a *šin-samekh* interchange; cf. *לְסָמּוּלוֹ* = *לְשִׁמּוּאֵלוֹ*, “to its (masc.) left” (10:6), and the possible restoration of *וְלִסְמָלוֹ* = *לְשִׁמּוּאֵלוֹ* (7:5).³⁷ *שִׁמּוּאֵל* means both “left” and “north”; e.g., *אֲשֶׁר מִשְׁמָאל לְדִמְשֶׁק*, “which is on the left of Damascus” (Gen. 14:15), is rendered by the Targumim as: *דְּמַצְפוֹנָא לְדִמְשֶׁק* (TO), *דְּמַצְפוֹנָא לְדִמְשֶׁק* (PsJ), *דְּמַצְפוֹן לְדִמְשֶׁק* (Frag.), *דִּי מִן צְפוֹן לְדִמְשֶׁק* (TN), “which is north of Damascus.” Thus, *לְסָמַל* or *סָמַל אֶל* may mean both, “to the left” or “to the north, northward.”

The following are possible readings, vocalizations, and interpretations for this problematic phrase.

בְּיִרְדוֹ כִּירְדָּא אֶל סָמַל = *בְּיִרְדוֹ כִּירְדָּא אֶל שִׁמּוּאֵל*, “as descending to (the) left/north,” where *יִרְדָּא* is the infinitive absolute of *יִרַד*. Cf. *יִרְדָּנוּ*, “we surely came down” (Gen. 43:20); *מִיִּרְדִּי בּוֹר* (*qeri*), “from my descent to the pit/grave” (Ps. 30:4), also *מִבְּיִרְדּוֹ בְּצִפּוֹן וּבְצִפּוֹן* (Baker^{dr}) - *בְּצִפּוֹן וּבְצִפּוֹן* (Allegro^{dr}, *plene*), “from as it (masc.) descending in (the) left/north” (alt., see #14, 3:11-12).

בְּיִרְדָּהּ וּבְיִרְדָּהּ לְשִׁמּוּאֵל וּלְסָמַל = *בְּיִרְדָּהּ וּבְיִרְדָּהּ לְשִׁמּוּאֵל וּלְסָמַל*, “in/at a/the descent to (the) left/north”; cf. *יִרְדָּתוֹ מִלְּמַעְלָא*, “its (masc.) descent is from above” (see #44, 10:1-2). *יִרְדָּהּ* (MH, fem.), “descent” (cf. Lurie), is the same formation as *יִצְיָאָהּ*, “exit” (from the root *יצא*, “to exit”); cf. *יִצְיָאָתָא*, “exit of the water” (see #32, 7:14). E.g., *יִצְיָאָתּוֹ ... יִרְדָּתּוֹ*, “his exit ... his descent” (baraita b. Zev. 53a); *יִרְדָּתּוֹ ... עֲלִיתּוֹ*, “his descent ... his ascent” (m. Toh. 4:8).³⁸

כִּיִּרְדָּא לְסָמַל וּלְשִׁמּוּאֵל = *כִּיִּרְדָּא לְסָמַל וּלְשִׁמּוּאֵל* (archaic), “as it descends to (the) left/north,” where “it (masc.)” refers to the masculine *שִׁי*, “top/tower”; or *כִּיִּרְדָּהּ לְסָמַל וּלְשִׁמּוּאֵל* = *כִּיִּרְדָּהּ לְסָמַל וּלְשִׁמּוּאֵל*, “as it descends to (the) left/north,” where “it (fem.)” refers to the feminine *מִסְבָּא*, “staircase”; *יִרְדָּהּ וּבְיִרְדָּהּ* (masc.) and *יִרְדָּהּ* (fem., *Qal* pres. part. sg. from the root *יִרַד*, “to descend, go down”) mean “he/she/it descends.” Cf. *עֵינֵי עֵינֵי*, “my eye, my eye flows (fem.) with waters/tears” (Lam. 1:16);

37 When the spelling is *שִׁמּוּאֵל* in the Masoretic Text, the Masorah notes *מָלָא*, “*plene* spelling with a *waw*”; e.g., Isa. 54:3. Also cf., *לֵב חָכֵם לִימִינוֹ וְלֵב כְּסִיל לְשִׁמּוּאֵלוֹ*, “The heart of a wise is to his right, but the heart of the fool is to his left” (Eccl. 10:2), vs. *עַל יְמִין וְעַל*, “to the right and to the left” (Zech. 12:6). And *יְמִין הִישִׁימוֹן* (Zech. 12:6), “to the right/south of (the) Jeshimon” (1 Sam. 23:24). Note, *אֶל*, *עַל*, and *לֹא* are interchangeable.

38 *מַעְלָה* (BH, MH), “ascent, step,” the antonym of *יִרְדָּהּ*, occurs three times in the Scroll (see #57, 12:4).

39 In the Masoretic Text once יָדְךָ is spelled with an extra *he*; $\text{וְהָיָה עַל יֶדְךָ}$, “and it shall be for a sign on your hand” (Exod. 13:16). This is interpreted by the Rabbis as if it were two words, יָדְךָ , “weak hand.” Thus, the phylactery is placed on the left arm (see Rashi on b. Men. 37a and Exod. 13:9; *Keli Yaqar*, *’Or haHayyim*, and *Torah Temimah* on Exod. 13:16). While in the Masoretic Text occasionally יָדְךָ is spelled as יָדְךָ , the latter is the commonly used form in the Dead Sea Scrolls. E.g., $\text{וּבְמַעֲשֵׂי יָדְךָ}$, “and by the work of your hand” (1QSb 3:28), vs. $\text{וּבְמַעֲשֵׂה יָדְךָ}$, “and work of your hand” (Isa. 64:7).

which is in the basin" (Exod. 12:22).

The last word of this item is very unusual. It is the last word of Column 1, the only word in line 15, and it is placed in the middle of the line. In addition, the drawings differ. BAKER^{dr} and MILIK^{dr}: a letter size lacuna followed by a half letter size space, then by a *bet/kaf* and a *dalet/reš*. Due to the lacuna, a letter may be missing, but necessarily. ALLEGRO^{dr}: a somewhat wider lacuna, fragments of the upper and lower part of a *bet/kaf*, followed by a *bet/kaf* and then by a *dalet/reš*. Accordingly, this word can be read as כד, כר, כד, כר, בכד, בכר, בכר, ככר, and ככר.

כָּכָר, "talent," is a singular collective noun. E.g., וַנְחַשֵׁת הַתְּנוּפָה שְׁבַעִים כָּכָר, "And the copper offered (was) seventy talents and two thousand four hundred shekels" (Exod. 38:29). At other places the Scroll uses כָּכָרִין (pl.), "talents." Cf. וְכֶסֶף אֶלֶף אֲלָפִים כָּכָרִים, "and a million talents of silver" (1 Chron. 22:14); כֶּסֶף שְׁקָלִים אַרְבָּעִים, "forty silver shekel" (Neh. 5:15). This occurrence of the singular collective כָּכָר in the Scroll supports the notion that ככ is not an abbreviation for כָּכָרִין (see Appendix A).

בַּד (pl. בְּדִימוֹן), "bar, rod, shoot, pole" (it could be collective); cf. בְּדִין שֶׁל שֵׁשׁ כֶּסֶף, "six silver bars" (2:11, alt., 7:10, alt.); שִׁבְעָה בְּדִין אִיסְתָּרִין אַרְבַּע, "seven bars (and) four *staters*" (9:3, alt.). Although בַּד is masculine, e.g., יִהְיוּ הַבְּדִים, "the rods shall be (masc.)" (Exod. 25:15), in the Scroll בַּד seems to be feminine (see #10, 2:11; #38, 9:3).

בַּד may mean מִשְׁקָל, "weight, measure." The Gemara asks, "And what does בַּד בְּבַד (Exod. 30:34) mean? Ravina says, 'That one shall not put מִשְׁקָל בְּבַד (a measure [of spice] against a measure [of spice] and weigh [with] it)' (b. Ker. 5a). Likewise, the Targumim render בַּד בְּבַד as מִתְקָל בְּמִתְקָל, "weight by weight," i.e., equal weight (Exod. 30:34).⁴⁷

בַּד also means "set apart" (from the root בָּדַד, "to separate, to isolate"); cf. לְבַד, "apart, alone" (e.g., Exod. 26:9). Thus, the previously mentioned phrase בַּד בְּבַד could mean, "each one separate" (Exod. 30:34). בַּד בְּבַד, "one next to other," occurs twice in the Manual of Discipline (1QS 4:16,25).⁴⁸ Similarly the Gemara says, "Talmud scholars who are sitting בַּד בְּבַד (next to each other, or each one separately), and are engaged in the study of the Torah" (b. Ber. 63b; cf. b. Ta'an. 7a; b. Mak. 10a).

בַּד (dual gender, pl. בְּדִימוֹן) is a "pitcher" (it could be collective). בְּבַד means בְּבַד אֶחָד אַחַת, "in one pitcher" (see #25, 6:4-5). Cf. שֵׁשׁ כֶּסֶף שֵׁשׁ, "six silver pitchers," or "six pitchers (containing an unspecified amount of) silver (pieces)" (2:11, 7:10); שִׁבְעָה בְּדִין אִיסְתָּרִין אַרְבַּע, "seven pitchers, four *staters*."

47 In Exodus Rashi explains that each spice must have the same weight; while in the Gemara, as one must weigh each type of spices with an iron weight. Regarding מִתְקָל - מִשְׁקָל, see #1, 1:4.

48 See J. Licht, *The Rule Scroll* (Heb., 1965), 102.

כַּר (masc., pl. כָּרִים, masc.) is a “sack, pack-saddle, cushion” (it could be collective); e.g., וַתִּשֶׂם בְּכַר הַגָּמֶל, “and she put them into the pack-saddle of the camel” (Gen. 31:34); הַכֹּר וְהַכֶּסֶת שֶׁל עוֹר, “the leather cushion and/or mattress” (m. Miq. 7:6); לֹא הָיָה יוֹשֵׁב עַל גִּבֵּי כָרִים וְכִסְתוֹת, “he did not sit upon cushions and mattresses” (b. M.Q. 16b).

Regarding כֶּסֶף, it should be added that in the Masoretic Text where shekel (= *sela*) is implied but not written, usually the Targumim provide that information. E.g., אֶלֶף כֶּסֶף, “one thousand silver (shekels)” (Gen. 20:16), is אֶלֶף סִלְעִין דְּכֶסֶף (TO, PsJ, Frag.), and אֶלֶף דְּסִלְעִין דְּכֶסֶף (TN), “one thousand silver *sela*’s” (see #1, 1:4; #59, 12:9).

Based on the above discussion, the following additional readings, vocalizations, and translations are offered for the phrase in question.

בַּד [כ]סֶף אַרְבָּעִין, “(there are) forty bars/measures of [si]lver,” or “(there are) forty [si]lver (pieces/shekels) set apart.”

בַּד [כ]סֶף אַרְבָּעִין [ב]כְּדִיבְכַר, “(there are) forty [si]lver (pieces/shekels) in one [pi]tcher/pitcher” — Cf. the alternates וּכְסֶף בְּכַדִּין שְׁבַעִין, “(there are) seventy silver (pieces/shekels) are in (an unspecified number of) pitchers,” or “and (an unspecified amount of) silver (are) in seventy pitchers” (see #8, 2:6); and וְהָב בְּכַדִּין שְׁתֵּימָה, “two gold (pieces/shekels) are in (an unspecified number of) pitchers,” or “(an unspecified amount of) gold (are) in two pitchers” (see #56, 12:1). For additional possible cases of בְּכַדִּין, see Appendix A.

בַּד [כ]סֶף אַרְבָּעִין [ב]כְּרִיבְכַר, “(there are) forty [si]lver (pieces/shekels) in one [s]ack/sack.”

בַּד [כ]סֶף [ב]סֶף אַרְבָּעִין [ב]כְּרִיבְכַר, “(there are) in a/the threshold/vestibule forty (unspecified) [ta]lents/talents,” or “(there are) in one basin forty (unspecified) [ta]lents/talents.”

בַּד [כ]סֶף [ב]סֶף אַרְבָּעִין [ב]כְּרִיבְכַר, “(there are) in a/the threshold/vestibule/basin forty bars.”

בַּד [כ]סֶף [ב]סֶף אַרְבָּעִין כַּר, “(there are) in a/the threshold/vestibule/basin forty sacks.”

ITEM 6

בבור המלח שתחת המעלות 2:1

HN 42 ככרין 2:2

- 2:1 In the salt pit, which is below the steps,
2:2 (there are) 42 (unspecified) talents. (Code:) HN.

COMMENTARY

(2:1) בְּבוֹר הַמֶּלַח, “In/at/by the salt pit” — ALLEGRO: בְּבוֹר הַמֶּלַח, “In the salt pit,” which is the Salt Chamber north of the Inner Temple Court.¹ MILIK: בְּבוֹר הַמֶּלַח, “The filled up cistern”; rather than בְּבוֹר הַמֶּלַח.² LURIE: בְּבוֹר הַמֶּלַח, “In the salt pit,” which is located below the steps in Ḥaruba³, in the Valley of Achor mentioned in the first item. Milik’s identification is in error, since this is a pit not a chamber.⁴ SHARVIT: מִלָּה (= מִילּוֹא, BH). Millo, “fortified building” (e.g., 2 Chron. 32:5); a fort near Shechem (Judg. 9:6,20). Three times in the Scroll מִלָּה is spelled with a *he* for *ḥolam*, while twice בְּבוֹר הַמֶּלַח has *waw* for a *ḥolam*.⁵ PIXNER: בְּבוֹר הַמֶּלַח, “In the salt pit.” The Essene community apparently possessed a common salt pit, whose importance is stressed in the Temple Scroll (20:13-14).⁶ GARCIA MARTINEZ: “In the filled tank.”⁷ VERMES: “In the cistern of the esplanade.”⁸ WOLTERS, BEYER, and WISE agree with Allegro.⁸

בוֹר הַמֶּלַח, “the salt pit,” means a pit used for storing salt; cf. בּוֹר הַגָּדוֹל, “the great cistern” (see #3, 1:6). On the other hand, there are seven cases of בּוֹר in the Scroll; all of these can be read in additional two ways: בּוֹרִיכּוֹר (with a *kaf*), “furnace, smelter,” and בּוֹרִיכּוֹר (the *reš* is read as a short-legged final *kaf*), “burial niche.” Regarding בּוֹר, see #3, 1:6; for בּוֹר, #59, 12:8; for בּוֹר, #17, 4:6.

בוֹר הַמֶּלַח and בְּבוֹר הַמֶּלַח could be toponyms. In addition, מִלָּה can be read as מִלָּה (with a *he*), and vocalized as מִלָּה = מִלּוֹא, “Millo, citadel, rampart” (cf. Sharvit), or מִלָּה, Millah, an assumed Hebrew form of the Aramaic toponym מִלְתָּא, Milta. These suggestions can equally be applied to the other two cases of מִלָּה in the Scroll: בְּשִׁיתִּי בְּשִׁית שְׁבַמְלַח־שְׁבַמְלַח, “In/at/by a/the deep

1 Allegro^{pr}; Allegro, 35, 139 n. 38; Allegro^{rev}, 21.

2 Milik, 286; Milik^E, 139.

3 Lurie, 67 (the missing translation seems to be a typographical error).

4 “Iyyunim,” 129 and n. 19.

5 Pixner, 344 and n. 10.

6 Garcia Martinez, 461.

7 Vermes, 374.

pit which is in Melah/Salt" (see #13, 3:8), and בְּקִבְרוֹ וּבְקִבְרֵי שְׂבַמְלַח שְׂבַמְלַח, "In/at/by a/the grave which is in Melah/Salt" (see #14, 3:11).

Based on the above discussion, the following additional readings, vocalizations, and interpretations can be offered.

בְּבוֹר הַמֶּלַח, "In/at/by the pit/cistern of (the) Melah/Salt," or "In/at/by (the) Bor-Melah/Salt-Pit.

בְּבוֹר הַמִּלּוֹ, "In/at/by the pit/cistern of the citadel/rampart," "In/at/by the pit/cistern of the Millo," or "In/at/by (the) Bor-Millo.

בְּבוֹר הַמִּלָּה, "In/at/by the pit/cistern of the Millah," or "In/at/by (the) Bor-Millah."

בְּכוּרוֹ וּבְכוּרֵי הַמֶּלַח, "In/at/by the furnace/smelter of (the) Melah," or "In/at/by (the) Kor/Kur-Melah."

בְּכוּרוֹ וּבְכוּרֵי הַמִּלּוֹ, "In/at/by the furnace/smelter of the citadel/rampart," "In/at/by (the) furnace/smelter of (the) Millo," or "In/at/by (the) Kor/Kur-Millo."

בְּכוּרוֹ וּבְכוּרֵי הַמִּלָּה, "In/at/by the furnace/smelter of (the) Millah," or "In/at/by (the) Kor/Kur-Millah."

בְּכוּרֵי וּבְכוּרֵי הַמֶּלַח, "In/at/by the burial niche of (the) Melah/Salt."

בְּכוּרֵי וּבְכוּרֵי הַמִּלּוֹ, "In/at/by the burial niche of the citadel/rampart," or "In/at/by the burial niche of the Millo."

בְּכוּרֵי וּבְכוּרֵי הַמִּלָּה, "In/at/by the burial niche of (the) Millah."

To the above suggestions the following toponyms can be compared: עֵיר הַמֶּלַח, Salt City (Josh. 15:62);⁹ בּוֹר הַסִּרָּה, Bor-sirah ("Pit/Well of the Pot/-Thorn"), north of Hebron (2 Sam. 3:26); בּוֹר עֶשֶׂן, Bor-ashan ("Smoke-/Smoking Pit/Well"), a Priestly city in Simeon, which in some versions occurs as כּוֹר עֶשֶׂן, Cor-ashan, Smoking Furnace (1 Sam. 30:30); כּוֹר הַבְּרָזִל, "the Iron Smelter," referring to Egypt (Deut. 4:20; Jer 11:4). Also the alternate reading of (בֵּין שְׁנֵי הַכוּוּנִין = הַכוּוּנִים), "between the two furnaces" (see #17, 4:6). בְּאֵר (fem.) "well," synonym of בּוֹר, and its plural form בְּאֵרוֹת, "wells," are also used in compound place names.¹⁰

If בּוֹר הַמֶּלַח refers to a salt pit or cistern, then it is located below the steps of an undisclosed site. If בּוֹרוֹ וּבְכוּרוֹ הַמֶּלַח הַמְּלַח הַמִּלּוֹ is a place name, then the place is located below an undisclosed ascent, and may indicate that there was another similarly named place above the ascent. If בּוֹרוֹ וּבְכוּרוֹ הַמֶּלַח הַמְּלַח הַמִּלּוֹ is rendered as a pit/furnace/niche of a certain place, then the pit, furnace, or niche is located below the steps or ascent of that place.

(2:1) תַּחַת הַמַּעְלֹת, "which is below the steps," cf. תַּחַת הַמַּעְלֹת, "below the steps" (1:2), and the singular תַּחַת הַמַּעְלָה (= הַמַּעְלָה), "below the step"

8 Wolters, 34-35; Beyer, 225-226; Wise, 192.

9 Also, הַמֶּלַח, Salt Sea (known as Dead Sea, Gen. 14:3; Num. 34:3, etc.); תֵּל מֶלַח, Tel-melah (Mound of Salt in Babylon, Ezra 2:59; Neh. 7:61); הַמִּלָּה, Valley of Salt (2 Sam. 8:13; 2 Chron. 25:11; Ps. 60:2; and הַמִּלָּה, ketiv, הַמִּלָּה, qeri, 2 Kgs 14:7).

10 E.g., בְּאֵר אֱלִים, Beer-elim (in Moab, Isa. 15:8); בְּאֵר לַחַי רֹאִי, Beer-lahai-roi (in the Negev; Gen. 16:14, 24:62, 25:11); בְּאֵר שֶׁבַע, Beer-sheba (in the Negev, Gen. 21:31, 26:33, etc.); בְּאֵר בְּנֵי יַעֲקֹב, Beeroth-bene-jaakan (Deut. 10:6, etc.).

(see #57, 12:4).

ALLEGROP^r notes that המעלות is “a rock formation, a steep ‘ascent’ over the hills or the like, rather than part of a building. The ‘salt’ of the cistern would presumably natural (rock) salts; hardly the Dead Sea at such a distance indicated by מעלות. It is again a natural feature, from which the ‘City of Salt’ got its name?”

(2:2) HN 42 כִּכְרִין, “(there are) 42 (unspecified) talents. (Code:) HN.”¹¹ — It is possible to read כִּכְרִין, “talents,” as כִּכְדִין, “in pitchers,” as in other six cases in the Scroll. Accordingly, HN 42 כִּכְדִין could mean, “(there are) 42 (unspecified items) in (an undisclosed number of) pitchers. Code: HN”; or “(there are unspecified items) in 42 pitchers. Code: HN” (see Appendix A). Regarding the Greek letters, see Appendix C.

11 Wise (192) reads “forty-one talents” (it may be a typographical error).

ITEM 7

2:3 במערת בית חמדה הישן ברובד
2:4 השלשי {ל} עשתות זהב ששין וחמש ΘΕ

- 2:3 In the cave of Old Beth Hemdah, in the third
2:4 row of stones, (there are) sixty five masses of unused gold. (Code:) ΘΕ.

COMMENTARY

(2:3) **בַּמְעָרָה** (const.) is the same as **בַּמְעָרָא שֶׁל** (abs.), “in/at/by (the) cave of” (6:7). **מְעָרָה** also occurs in **בַּמְעָרָא בַּמְעָרָא**, “in/at/by a/the cave” (7:8); and in the reconstructed **עֲרַת [בַּמְ]עָרָה**, “[in/at/by (the) c]ave of.” **מְעָרָה** (fem., pl. **מְעָרוֹת**)¹ refers to natural or man-made cave used for: (1) hiding; e.g., the cave used by Lot (Gen. 19:30), the cave used by David (1 Sam. 24:3); and (2) burials; e.g., **מְעָרַת הַמַּכְפֵּלָה**, “the Cave of Machpelah” or “the Double Cave,” purchased by Abraham **לְאַחֲזֹת קֶבֶר**, “for a burial property” (Gen. 23:9). In Mishnaic Hebrew **מְעָרָה** also means “cistern, ritual bath.” Its cognates are **מְעָרְתָּא** (Aramaic), *maḡarat* (Arabic), and probably *grt* in Ugaritic.² Its synonym, **נִקְרָה** (BH, A), “cave, hole,” appears in the Scroll (1:12). **מְעָרָה**, like **בּוֹר**, **בְּרֵכָה**, **שִׁיחַ**, etc., can be applied to both water-works and to burial sites. **חָפַר**, “to dig” (one of the few verbs used in the Scroll), describes the manner of creating these cavities; cf. **חוֹפֵר בּוֹרוֹת שִׁיחִין וּמְעָרוֹת**, “a digger of cisterns, pits and caves” (e.g., m. B.B. 2:12; see #4, 1:12).

A Beth She‘arim inscription reads: **זו אֶרְוֹנוֹ שְׁלִרְבִּי הַלִּיל בְּנוֹ שְׁלִרְבִּי לְוִי**, **שֶׁעָשָׂה אֶת הַמְעָרָה הַזֶּה**, “This is the coffin of Rabbi Hillel, the son of Rabbi Levi, who made this burial cave.” According to Avigad, **מְעָרָה** could mean, “the whole cave or catacomb, one of its branches, or only the single burial room in which the sarcophagus was found.”³ The palaeographical similarity of the Beth She‘arim inscriptions and the Copper Scroll should be noted.

In the late Second Temple era the Jerusalem (Priestly) Court controlled the roads, plazas, water-works, and burial sites throughout Palestine. The Talmud says:

1 It is from the root family of **עָרַר** - **עָרַר** - **עָרָה** with a prefixed locative *mem*; cf. Jastrow, 1819a; SB, 487; BDB, 792b; BY 4, 3195a n. 1; ESh^{dic} 4, 1449a.

2 See U. Cassuto, *The Goddess Anath*, 164-65; *UT*, 436a (#1523); *WUS*, 191 (#1630).

3 *Beth She‘arim* 3, 162, 251-54 (#28). This inscription is mentioned again in #26, 6:7.

On the fifteenth (of Adar) representatives of the Court go (to the country site) and they repair the roads, plazas ... וְחֹפְרִין אֶת הַבּוֹרוֹת וְאֶת הַשִּׁיחִין וְאֶת הַמַּעְרוֹת ... וְאֵת הַמְּקוּאוֹת וְאֵת אֲמוֹת הַמַּיִם (and they hollow out the cisterns, and the pits, and the caves, and the ritual baths, and the water canals) ... and they mark the places of ritual impurities ... (t. Sheq. 1:1-2,4).

On the fifteenth day (of Adar) ... they repair the roads, plazas, וְאֵת מְקוּאוֹת הַמַּיִם (and the ritual baths), and they do all public needs, וְאֵת הַקְּבָרוֹת (and they mark the graves) ... (m. Seq. 1:1).

One may hypothesize that the Copper Scroll describes hidden treasures from the Temple. Since the water-works and burial sites had a unique sanctity, both were especially suitable for storage of Temple wealth.

Finally, מַעְרָה could be a toponym; e.g., וּמַעְרָה אֲשֶׁר לְצִידְנִים (Trg. וּמַעְרָתָא וּמַעְרָה, “and Mearah which is of the Zidonians” (Josh. 13:4). Klein renders, הַרְוִחִין בְּמֵי מַעְרָה וּבְמֵי טַבְרִיא, as “He who baths in the water of Me‘arah or in the water of Tiberias” (m. Shab. 22:5); Me‘arah is a spa in בערה, Be‘erah, Transjordan. He adds that several Palestinian places were named מַעְרִיָּה, Me‘arayyah, one of them is mentioned in the “Baraita of the Priestly Orders,” which is now called Mu‘ar, in Upper Galilee.⁴

(2:3) בֵּית — Forms of בֵּית appear in the Scroll a dozen times; some of them may be toponyms. (1) בֵּית אוֹזָר, “Beth Ošar (= Store-House)”;⁵ cf. וְהָאֶצֶר, “and the store house” (1:10; see #33 8:1-2). (2) בֵּית הָאֲשֻׁחִין/הָאֲשִׁיחִין, “in Beth Ašuhin/Ašihin (= House of the Pools)” (see #55, 11:12). (3) בֵּית הַכּוֹף/הַכּוֹף, “house of the burial niche” (see #59, 12:8). (4) בֵּית הַכְּרֵם, “which is (in/at/by) the Beth-cherem (= House of the Vineyard)” (see #46, 10:5). (5) בֵּית הַמַּיִם, “the water-closet, laundry,” or בֵּית הַחֵמִים, “the hot-house, hot-bath-house, hot-spring-house” (see #49, 10:15). (6) בֵּית הַמַּשְׁכָּב, “the western tomb” (see #56, 11:16). (7) בֵּית הַקֶּצֶץ (= הַקִּיץ), “of the summer/remotest house” or “of Beth Hakkoz (= House of the Thorn)” (see #30, 7:8-9). (8) בֵּית שְׁמֻשְׁמֻשָּׁם, “of Beth Sham/-Shan/Shem/Sam,” or שְׁלִבֵּית שָׁם, “of the House, there” (see #58, 12:6). (9) בֵּית תָּמָר, “Beth Tamar (= House of Palm)” (see #43, 9:14-15). (10) בֵּין שְׁנֵי הַבָּתִּין, “between the the houses” (see #17, 4:6). (11) בֵּתֵי הָעֵצִין, “the woodsheds” (alt., see #8, 2:5). (12) בֵּית הַמְּדָה הַיָּשֵׁן, “the Old Beth Hemdah,” in this item; it will be discussed later.

בֵּית (masc., const. בֵּית, pl. בָּתִּים/בֵּתִי, pl. const. בָּתִּי) means “house, palace, temple, dwelling, room, enclosed area, family.”⁵ It is a common Semitic

4 SY, 106a, 163, 165a. Traditionally this Mishnah is translated as, “He who baths in the water of a cave (heated before Sabbath) or in the (hot) water of Tiberias.” It should be added that מַעְרִיָּה is the Aramaic plural of מַעְרָה (e.g., PsJ and TN on Num. 21:15).

5 The Aramaic forms are: בֵּית (assumed), “a house”; בֵּיתָא, “the house”; בֵּית, “(the) house of”; בָּתִּין, “houses”; בָּתִּיא, “the houses”; בָּתִּי, “houses of”; etc.

noun, derived from the root בית - בּוּת, which in Aramaic means "to lodge, spend the night"; cf. וּבֵית טָוֶת, "and (the king) spent the night fasting" (BA, Dan. 6:19). The roots בּוּת־בֵּית, "to lodge," and בּוּא, "to come, go," may be related to each other, as well as to the prepositions *bet*, "in, at, by, between," and בֵּין, "between, among."⁶ בֵּית (sg.) probably evolved from בֵּת (Phoenician בֵּת, Ugaritic *bt* and *bht*), cf. שֵׁשׁ vs. שֵׁשׁ, "marble"; יְרוּשָׁלַם (*ketiv*) vs. יְרוּשָׁלַיִם (*qeri*), Jerusalem; in old inscriptions יָן for יַין, "wine"; קִין for קֵיין, "summer (fruit)" (see #30, 7:8-9). Most of these nouns in the construct state retain their old forms. The plural בֵּתַיִם (abs.) and בֵּתַי (const.) have peculiar vocalizations; long *qamaṣ* followed by a *dageš* in the *taw*. Perhaps the *dageš* compensates for the loss of *he*, *waw*, or *yod*. בֵּתַיִם appears in Phoenician as *btm*, in Ugaritic as *bht*, as well as *bhtm* and *bwtm*, with an extra *he* or *waw*.⁷

When the first element of a compound toponym is בֵּית, the second element is often prefixed with the definite article; e.g., וּבֵית מַרְכָּבוֹת, "and in Beth-marcaboth (= House of Chariots)" (1 Chron. 4:31), vs. וּבֵית הַמַּרְכָּבוֹת, "and Beth-marcaboth (= House of the Chariots)" (Josh. 19:5); בֵּית הַכֶּרֶם, Beth-cherem, "House of the Vineyard" (Jer. 6:1; Neh. 3:14; also in the Scroll, 10:5). בֵּית, "House of," also connotes "City/Place of," and may be interchangeable with עִיר, Ir, "city of," בָּעַל, Baal, "deity/possessor of," and כֶּפֶר, Kefar, "village of."⁸ E.g., בֵּית שֵׁמֶשׁ, Beth-shemesh, "House of (the) Sun" (Josh. 15:10), vs. עִיר שֵׁמֶשׁ, Ir-shemesh, "City of (the) Sun" (Josh. 19:41); Rav Menahem was a native of כֶּפֶר שְׁעָרִים, Kefar She'arim, "Village of (the) Gates," while others say of בֵּית שְׁעָרִים, Beth She'arim, "House of (the) Gates" (b. Nid. 27a), both may refer to the same toponym; בֵּית מְעוֹן, Beth-meon, "House of (the) Habitation" (Jer. 48:23), vs. בָּעַל מְעוֹן, Baal-meon, "Possessor of (the) Habitation" (Ezek. 25:9), both are the same as בֵּית בָּעַל מְעוֹן, Beth-baal-meon, "House of (the) Possessor of (the) Habitation" (Josh. 13:17); בֵּית תְּמָר, Beth Tamar, "House of (the) Palm" in the Scroll and by Eusebius, the Aramaic כֶּפֶר תְּמַרְתָּא, Kefar Temarta' (= כֶּפֶר הַתְּמָר, Kefar Tamar, in Hebrew), "Village of the Palm" (t. Hul. 3[4]:23), as well as עִיר הַתְּמָרִים, "City of the Palms," i.e., Jericho (Deut. 34:3; 2 Chron. 28:15), are similar toponyms, and they may be related to each other.

In addition, some cities were known with or without the designation of

⁶ Cf. SB, 86a, 100a, 101a. See also #4, 1:9.

⁷ Based on the Ugaritic usage, Gordon suggests that the Hebrew בֵּתַיִם should be pronounced as *bottim* (i.e., with a short *qamaṣ*). See *UT*, 371b-372a (#463). Based on Arabic, Aistleitner renders *bht* (pl. *bhtm*) as *Prachthause* ("luxurious house"; *WUS*, 47 [#501], 61 [#600]).

⁸ Likewise, חֲצָר, "courtyard of," is also used as the first element of compound toponyms; e.g., וְחֲצָר סוּסָה, "and Hazar-susah (= Courtyard of Mare)" (Josh. 19:5), and its variant וּבְחֲצָר סוּסִים, "and in Hazar-susim (= Courtyard of Horses)" (1 Chron. 4:31); see #3, 1:6.

בֵּית, e.g., נִמְרָה, Nimrah (Num. 32:3), vs. בֵּית נִמְרָה, Beth-nimrah, perhaps “House of (the) Leopard” (Num. 32:36; Josh. 13:27);⁹ חֹרֹן, Horon (9:7 in the Scroll), vs. בֵּית חֹרֹן, Beth-horon (e.g., 1 Chron. 6:53); רָמָתָא, Ramata’, “The Heights” (b. Shab. 26a), vs. בֵּית רָמָתָא, Beth Ramata’, “The House of the Heights” (y. Shevi. 9:2 [28a]).¹⁰

(2:3) הַיֶּשֶׁן הַמְדָּה הַיֶּשֶׁן, “the Old Beth Hemdah” — ALLEGRO^r: “the House of MRHHWSN” (i.e., בֵּית הַמְרַחְחוּשֵׁן). The word הַמְרַחְחוּשֵׁן may be a strange spelling for the month name מֶרַחְשֵׁן. Other possibilities are: חֹמֶר, “clay”; חֹמֶר, “bitumen”; חוֹשֶׁן, “breast piece”; or מֶרַח is for חֶרֶם. ALLEGRO: בֵּית הַמְדָּה הַיֶּשֶׁן, “the Old House of Tribute.”¹¹ MILIK: בֵּית הַמְדָּה הַיֶּשֶׁן (a small circle above the final nun), “the old Beth ha-Mareh”; the nun of הַיֶּשֶׁן looks like a waw (i.e., הַיֶּשׁוּ). Cf. מְרוֹת, Maroth (Micah 1:2); מַעְרַת, Maarath (Josh. 15:49); הַבְּרֵכָה הַיֶּשֶׁנָּה, “the old pool” (Isa. 22:11); and שַׁעַר הַיֶּשֶׁנָּה, “the old gate” (Neh. 3:6, 12:39).¹² LURIE: בֵּית הַמְדָּה הַיֶּשֶׁן, rendering as שְׁבִיבֵית הַמְדָּה הַיֶּשֶׁן, “which is in the Old Beth Marah” or “House of Bitterness”; cf. מְרָה, Marah (Exod. 15:23). בֵּית מְרָה is Ein el-Jeheiyr north of the Dead Sea.¹³ THORION: בֵּית הַמְדָּה with a question mark.¹⁴ PIXNER: בֵּית הַיֶּשׁוּ, “the laid-out house (= carpeted divan) of Yeshu.” יֶשׁוּ (as Milik notes), is a shortened form of יֵשׁוּעַ, Jesus. Alternately, “the banished (cast-off) House of Jesus.”¹⁵ Pixner attempts to link the Copper Scroll with the New Testament.¹⁶ The photographs of the ZUCKERMANS demonstrate that the last letter in question is much longer than a usual waw, therefore, the preferred reading is הַיֶּשֶׁן. WOLTERS: בֵּית הַמְדָּה הַיֶּשֶׁן, “the old Washer’s Chamber.” בֵּית הַמְדִּיחִין is similar to בֵּית הַמְדִּיחִין (m. Tam. 4:2) and לְשַׁכַּת הַמְדִּיחִין (m. Mid. 5:3), “the Washers’s Chamber” of the Temple where the sacrificial meats were rinsed.¹⁷ BEYER (reads as Allegro): “old tall house.”¹⁸ WILMOT: הַיֶּשֶׁן הַיֶּשֶׁן בֵּית תִּמְרָה. GARCIA MARTINEZ follows Pixner;

9 Same as נִמְרוֹן, Beth Nimron (y. Shevi. 9:2 [28a], a *he-nun* interchange in final position), נִמְרָה, Beth Namer (m. Pe’ah 4:5), בֵּית נִמְרִין, Beth Nimrin (PsJ Num. 32:36), etc. (SB, 558b; BDB, 649b; Jastrow, 914a).

10 See T. Kahane, “The Priestly Courses and Their Geographical Settlements,” *Tarbiz* 48 (1978/79), 26 and nn. 113-18.

11 Allegro, 35, 139 n. 41; Allegro^{rev}, 21.

12 Milik, 286, 240 C-18, 272 D-49; Milik^E, 139.

13 Lurie, 68-69 and n. 2 (in the translation הַיֶּשֶׁנָּה seems to be a typographical error for הַיֶּשֶׁן).

14 Thorion, 170.

15 Pixner, 344-46 and n. 11.

16 Apparently Charlesworth agrees with Pixner (*Jesus and the Dead Sea Scrolls* [1992], 219, 233 nn. 180-82).

17 “Vocabulary,” 491; “Analysis,” 248; Wolters, 34-35.

18 Beyer, 225-26.

19 “David J. Wilmot and the Copper Scroll,” 20. Wilmot’s suggestion is somewhat

בִּירָה may be from the roots בָּרָה, “to create,” and בָּנָה, “to build” (*nun-reš* interchange), thus related to בָּנִין and בְּנִיָּה, “building” (see #17, 4:6).

בֵּית הַבֵּרָה הַיָּשָׁן, “the Old Beth Berah” — בֵּרָה may be a variant of the personal names בְּאֶרָה, Beerah (1 Chron. 5:6), and בְּאֶרָא, Beera (1 Chron. 7:37); cf. כָּל שְׂרִית יִשְׂרָאֵל, “all remnant of Israel” (1 Chron. 12:39) vs. וּמִכָּל שְׂאֲרֵית, “and from all remnant of Israel” (2 Chron. 34:9).

בֵּית הַבּוֹרוֹת הַיָּשָׁן = בֵּית הַבּוֹרוֹת הַיָּשָׁן, “the old house of the cisterns/wells” — cf. בּוֹר (masc.) in the Scroll (see #3, 1:6; #17, 4:6).

בֵּית הַבְּרִית הַיָּשָׁן = בֵּית הַבְּרִית הַיָּשָׁן, “the old house of the covenant” — בְּרִית (fem.) may be from the root בָּרָה, “to bind.” Cf. אֲרוֹן הַבְּרִית, “ark of the covenant” (e.g., Josh. 3:6); וְזָכַרְתִּי לָהֶם בְּרִית רָאשֵׁנִים, “but I (Lord) will remember for them the covenant of the ancients” (Lev. 26:45); וְזָכַרְתִּי אֶת בֵּית, “and I (Lord) will make a new covenant with the house of Israel and with the house of Judah” (Jer. 31:31); וּבְרִית, “and the covenant of the priesthood and the Levites” (Neh. 13:29); the plural is בְּרִיתוֹת (e.g., Num. Rabbah 14).²⁵

בֵּית הַבְּרִית הַיָּשָׁן, “the old house of the cleaning agent”; it may refer to an old storage of cleaning agent. בְּרִית (from the root בָּרַר, “to select, clean”) occurs twice in the Masoretic Text (Jer. 2:22; Mal. 3:2), as well as in Mishnaic Hebrew; e.g., נֶתַר וּבּוֹרִית, “soda and soap” (m. Shab. 9:5).²⁶

בֵּית הַבְּרִית הַיָּשָׁן, “the old house of the cypress” — בְּרוֹת is a variant and the Targum of בְּרוֹשׁ, “cypress” (*šin-taw* interchange). בְּרוֹת, a synonym of אֶרֶז, “cedar,” appears only once in the Masoretic Text, קִרּוֹת בְּתִינוּ אֶרְזִים רַחֲיִטְנוּ, “the beams of our house are cedar, our panels are (of) cypress” (Songs 1:17).²⁷

בֵּית הַפֶּרֶה הַיָּשָׁן = בֵּית הַפֶּרֶה הַיָּשָׁן, “the old house/chamber of the cow(s)” (*bet-pe* interchange) — cf. בֵּית הַנִּבְחִים, “House of the Sacrifices,” referring to the Temple (Tanḥuma², Toledot 1); בֵּית הַפֶּרֶה, “the Parvah Chamber” of the Temple where hides of the sacrifices were kept (t. Zeb 11:16). It may refer to the chamber where the אֶדְמָה, “red heifer” (cf. Num. 12:2), or its ash was held.

בֵּית הַבְּרִית הַיָּשָׁן = בֵּית הַפֶּרֶת הַיָּשָׁן, “the Old House of the Euphrates,” a *bet-pe* interchange (cf. b. Yoma 10a, referring to Gen. 10:11). Perhaps this house or place was named after the river Euphrates.

בֵּית הַבְּרִית הַיָּשָׁן = בֵּית הַבְּרִית הַיָּשָׁן — (1) “the old house of the escapee”; cf. Isa. 15:5, 43:14 (from the root בָּרַח, to flee, escape); also בֵּית מְנוּס, “house of refuge” (m. 'Avot 4:22), and בֵּשֵׂא הַמִּסְבָּא שֶׁל מְנוּס, which could

25 BDB, 136a-137a; Jastrow, 194b; SB, 123; ESh^{dic} 1, 280b; AC 2, 205; see also J.D. Eisenstein, “בְּרִית” in *OY* 3, 202a-203a.

26 See BDB, 140b-141a; SB, 123b; AC 2, 205b-206a; ESh^{dic} 1, 199, 281b.

27 Likewise, the Targum renders אֶרְזִין, “cedars,” and בְּרִיתִי, “cypresses,” respectively (see Ibn-Ezra and *Mešudat Zion*; also AC 2, 204b-205a).

mean, "in the tower of the escape staircase" (see #5, 1:13). (2) "the Old House of Bariah"; בָּרְיָה, Bariah is a personal name (1 Chron. 3:22).

בֵּית הַבָּרֶחַ הַיָּשָׁן = בֵּית הַבָּרִיחַ הַיָּשָׁן, "the old house of the bar/shaft," or "the old bar holder" — cf. בְּתִים לְבָרִיחֵם, "holders for the bars" (Exod. 26:29, 36:34); כְּבָרִיחַ אֶרְמוֹן, "like the bar of a palace" (Prov. 18:19).

בֵּית הַפֶּרֶחַ הַיָּשָׁן for בֵּית הַבָּרֶחַ הַיָּשָׁן, "the old flower house" (*bet-pe* interchange) — cf. בֵּית אֵילָן, "orchard" (m. B.M. 9:2); בֵּית הַגֶּן, "the garden house," or Beth-gan, a possible toponym in Samaria (2 Kings. 9:27); בֵּית תַּפּוּחַ, Beth-tappuah ("House of Apple"), a city in Judah (Josh. 15:53). Regarding פֶּרֶחַ, cf. Num. 17:23.

בֵּית הַמְּדוּה הַמְּדוּת הַיָּשָׁן — (1) "the old house of the tribute(s)"; cf. לְיוֹנוֹ כֶּסֶף, "we borrow silver/money (to pay) the king's tax" (Neh. 5:4); מְדָה (BA, Ezra 4:20, 6:8) and מִנְדָּה, "tribute" (BA, Ezra 4:13, 7:24).²⁸ (2) "the old large house"; cf. בֵּית מְדוּת, "a large house" (Jer. 22:14;²⁹ from the root מָדַד, "to measure"); also, בֵּית הַמֶּד (9:14-15, alt.). This is like Allegro's reading, but closer to Beyer's interpretation. (3) Same as בֵּית הַמְּדוֹן הַיָּשָׁן, "the Old Beth-Madon"; cf. the Canaanite place מְדוֹן, Madon, (Josh. 11:1, 12:19). מְדָה may be a variant of מְדוֹן, a final *he-nun* interchange.³⁰

בֵּית הַמְּדוּחַ הַיָּשָׁן = בֵּית הַמְּדִיחַ הַיָּשָׁן, "the old house washing house," or "the old Washers's Chamber"; מְדִיחַ (*Hif'il* part. sg. masc.; from the root דּוּחַ, "to wash, rinse") means "rinsing" (cf. Wolters); e.g., וְהִכְרִם מְדִיחִין אוֹתָהּ, "and the stomach (of the sacrificial animal) they (i.e., the priests) wash it in the rinsing chamber (in the Temple)" (m. Tam. 4:2).

בֵּית הַמְּדוּחַ הַיָּשָׁן = בֵּית הַמּוֹדָח הַיָּשָׁן, "the old washed/rinsed house"; מְדָח (*Hof'al* part. sg. masc.) means "washed, rinsed"; e.g., הָרִיחַ בָּהֶם כְּלִים, "If he rinsed in them (i.e., in the water) vessels/garments that already had been rinsed or new ones" (m. Yad. 1:4).

בֵּית הַמְּדוּחַ הַיָּשָׁן, "the old excommunicated house" — מְדָח (*Hof'al* part. sg. masc.; from the root נָדַח, "to push away, chase")³¹ means "chased, hunted"

28 Cf. "And Rabbi Judah said, 'מְנָדָה, this is the king's share'" (b. Ned. 62b). According to Steinberg (433a), מְדָה (BH, BA) and מְנָדָה (BA, the *nun* compensate for the *dageš forte*), are the same as the Akkadian *mandatu*. According to BDB (551b, 1101a), מְדָה is an Akkadian loan word from the root *nadanu*, the same as the Hebrew נָתַן, "to give, set."

29 It is rendered as: "house of size" (BDB, 551); "a wide house" (JPSⁱ); "a vast palace" (JPSⁱⁱ); "a house of large dimensions" (*Tanach*); etc.

30 Rashi's explanations of מְדוּת - מְדוֹן - מְדָה are: בֵּית מְדוּת ("large houses," Jer. 22:14) like מְדוּת אֲנָשִׁים ("tall men," Num. 13:32), the same as מְדָה אֲנָשִׁים ("tall men," Isa. 45:14), מְדָה אִישׁ ("a tall man," 1 Chron. 11:23), and מְדוֹן אִישׁ ("a tall man," 2 Sam. 21:20). The root of מְדוֹן is מָד like of הִמּוֹן is הָם, thus equating מְדוֹן with מְדָה. Rashi, belonging to the "French School," considers triliteral roots having "weak letters" as bilateral roots. See M.H. Haraz, *Lešon Haim* (1975/76), 34. מְדָה - מְדוֹן has a *he* and final *nun* interchange (cf. the possible readings of קְרוּרָה - קְרוּרֹן, see #35, 8:8). Also, וְהַבָּאָה בְּמְדָה, "and which comes in a large size" (m. Kel. 24:4; cf. Rashi b. Shab. 84a). Likewise, Radak explains בֵּית מְדוּת as "large houses," and compares it to מְדוּת אֲנָשִׁים (ad loc.).

(cf. Pixner alt.); e.g., כַּצְבִי מָדָח, “like a chased gazelle” (Isa. 13:14).

בֵּית הַמְדוּחַ הַיֵּשֶׁן = בֵּית הַמְדוּחַ הַיֵּשֶׁן, “the old banished house” — מְדוּחַ is the assumed singular for מְדוּחִים (masc.), “misleading”; cf. וַיִּחְזוּ לְךָ מִשְׁאוֹת שְׁוָא, “but (your prophets) have seen oracles for you that are false and misleading” (Lam. 2:14).³¹

בֵּית הַמְדִּיחַ הַיֵּשֶׁן = בֵּית הַמְדִּיחַ הַיֵּשֶׁן, “the old house of the seducer” — מְדִיחַ (masc.) means “seducer,” e.g., “(Who is) הַמְדִּיחַ (a seducer)? He who says let us go and serve an idol” (m. San. 7:10).

בֵּית הַמָּרָה הַיֵּשֶׁן, “the Old Beth-Marah/Maroth” or “the Old House of Bitterness” — מָרָה is from the root מָרַר, “to be bitter.” Cf. מָרָה, Marah, in the Wilderness of Sinai, named after its bitter spring (Exod. 15:22-23; Milik and Lurie); מְרוֹת, Maroth, a place in Judah (Micah 1:12); עַל הָאָרֶץ מְרוֹתַיִם, “upon the Land of Merathaim,” in Babylon (Jer. 50:21; dual formation); also בֵּית הַמָּר (9:14-15, alt.).

בֵּית הַמּוֹרָה הַיֵּשֶׁן — (1) “the Old Beth-Moreh” or “the Old House of the Teacher” — cf. גִּבְעַת הַמּוֹרָה, Gibeath-moreh, Teacher’s Hill (Judg. 7:1); אֱלוֹנֵי מָרָה, Terebinth of Moreh, Teacher’s Terebinth (Gen. 12:6); and מְרוֹת מָרָה, Terebinths of Moreh, Teacher’s Terebinths (near Shechem, Deut. 11:30); or as a common noun, “the old house of the teacher” (cf. Isa. 30:20; Prov. 5:13); מוֹרָה צַדִּיק, “righteous teacher” (CD 1:11). (2) “the old house of the bitterness”; cf. מָרָה מְאֹד, “it is very bitter” (2 Kgs 14:26, where מָרָה is an adjective). (3) “the old rebellious house”; cf. בֶּן סוֹרֵר וּמוֹרָה, “stubborn and rebellious son” (Deut. 21:18,20); also, בֵּית הַמָּרִי ... בֵּית מָרִי, “the rebellious house ... rebellious house” (Ezek. 12:2). מוֹרָה and מָרִי are from the root מָרַר, “be rebellious.”

בֵּית חֲבֵרָה הַיֵּשֶׁן — (1) “the old community house”; cf. וְאָרַח לְחִבְרָה עִם פְּעָלִי, “and he goes for a company with wicked persons” (Job 34:8). The masculine form of חֲבֵרָה (fem.) is חֲבֵר, “association” (pl. חֲבֵרִים, Ps. 58:6); cf. בֵּית חֲבֵר, “house of assembly” (Prov. 21:9, 25:24); בֵּית חֲבֵר (9:14-15, alt.); also חֲבֵר כֹּהֲנִים, “company of priests” (Hos. 6:9); חֲבֵר עִיר, “city community” (e.g., m. Ber. 4:7).³² (2) “The Old House of Hevrah”; חֲבֵרָה could be a feminine form of the personal name חֲבֵר; cf. בֵּית חֲבֵר הַקֵּינִי, “the House of Heber the Kenite” (Judg. 4:17). (3) “The Old Beth Hevrah,” an assumed toponym; חֲבֵרָה could be a variant of חֲבֵרוֹן, Hebron in Judah (e.g., Gen. 23:2), a final *he-nun* interchange.

בֵּית חֲבֵרָה חֲבִירוֹת הַיֵּשֶׁן = בֵּית חֲבֵרָה חֲבִירוֹת הַיֵּשֶׁן, “the old community house” — cf. חֲמִשָּׁה חֲבִירוֹת שֶׁשָּׁבְתוּ בְּטָרְקָלִין אֶתְדוּ, “Five groups which observ-

31 The roots רוּחַ, רָחַח, and נָחַח are related to each other (SB, 165b, 167a, 536b; ESh^{dic} 1, 412a; 4, 1622a).

32 The latter is explained by Rashi as: צִבּוּר, “public,” and חֲבִירוֹת עִיר, “city community” (b. Ber. 30a), as well as חֲבִירוֹת צִבּוּר, “public gathering” (b. Hul. 94a).

ed the Sabbath in one eating hall" (m. 'Eruv. 6:6). The synonyms חבורה, חברה, and חבר, all are derived from the root חבר, "to unite."

בֵּית תְּבֵרָה־חֶבֶרֶת הַיֶּשֶׁן for בֵּית חֲפֹרָה־חֶפְרוֹת הַיֶּשֶׁן or בֵּית תְּבֵרָה־חֶבֶרֶת הַיֶּשֶׁן for בֵּית חֲפִירָה־חֶפְרוֹת הַיֶּשֶׁן, "the old house of the pit(s)" (*bet-pe* interchange). Regarding חֲפִירָה - חֶפְרוֹה, see #38, 9:2.

בֵּית חֶבֶרָה הַיֶּשֶׁן for בֵּית חֶפְרָה הַיֶּשֶׁן, "the old house of Haferah" or "the Old Beth-Haferah" (*bet-pe* interchange) — חֶפְרָה could be a variant of חֶפֶר, Hephher, a personal name (e.g., Num. 26:33) and a Canaanite city (e.g., Josh. 12:17). It can also be compared with חֶפְרַיִם, Hapharaim, a double city in the Land of Issachar (Josh. 19:19);

בֵּית חֶמְדָּה־חֶמְדַּת הַיֶּשֶׁן — (1) "the old temple," "the old house of delight(s)"; cf. "upon the (destruction of) שְׂדֵי חֶמֶד (the Delighted Field, i.e., Land of Israel), upon (the destruction of) בֵּית חֶמְדָּתִי (the My Delighted House, i.e., Temple)" (Eccl. Rabbah Petiḥā' 24).³³ (2) "the old house of idol(s) worship"; e.g., וּבְתֵי חֶמְדָּתְךָ יִתְרָעוּ and its Targum, "and it shall destroy your houses of delight" (Ezek. 26:12). (3) "the Old Beth (or House of) Hemdah"; חֶמְדָּה may be a variant of the personal name חֶמְדָּן, Hemdan (Gen. 36:26; final *he-nun* interchange).

בֵּית חֶמְדָּה־חֶמְדֹּת הַיֶּשֶׁן = בֵּית חֶמְדָּה־חֶמְדֹּת הַיֶּשֶׁן, "the old cherished house," or "the old treasury" — cf. וּכְלֵי חֶמְדֹּת, "and precious objects" (2 Chron. 20:25); בֵּית חֶמֶד (9:13-14, alt.). The last two possible readings are from the root חָמַד, "to desire."

בֵּית חֶמְרָה־חֶמְרַת הַיֶּשֶׁן — (1) "the old house of the female donkey(s)." חֶמְרָה (fem.; pl. חֶמְרוֹת) is Mishnaic Hebrew (e.g., t. Kil. 5:5). Biblical Hebrew uses only חֶמֶר (masc., e.g., Gen. 32:5), the feminine is called אֶתוֹן, "female donkey" (e.g., Num. 22:23). (2) "the Old House of Hamorah," where Hamorah may be a (feminine) personal name; cf. אֲנָשֵׁי חֶמֶר אָבִי שֶׁכֶם, "the men of Hamor the Father of Shechem" (Judg. 9:28). (3) "the old house of the heap(s); cf. the biblical word play בִּלְחֵי הַחֶמֶר חֶמֶר חֶמְרִים, "with the jawbone of a donkey, a heap, double heaps" (Judg. 15:16). Although חֶמֶר is masculine, the dual חֶמְרִים seems to be from the feminine חֶמְרָה.

בֵּית חֶמְרָה הַיֶּשֶׁן, "the old clay house" or "the old house of heap/homer" — חֶמְרָה may be an unattested feminine formation for חֶמֶר (masc.), "clay"; cf. שֹׁכְנֵי בְתֵי חֶמֶר, "dwellers of clay houses" (Job 4:19); חֶמֶר also means "heap, homer (a dry measure)" (e.g., Exod. 8:10; Isa. 5:10).

בֵּית חֶמְרָה הַיֶּשֶׁן — (1) "the old house of the wine"; חֶמְרָה may be a femi-

33 This Midrash is reflected in a *Seliḥah* written by Rabbi Solomon bar Judah the Babylonian (c. 980), בַּת בִּרְרָה לְבֵית חֶמְדָּתְךָ, "a daughter (i.e., Land of Israel) You have chosen for your Favorite House (i.e., the Temple)." See A. Rosenfeld, *The Authorised Selichot for the Whole Year* (1979), 82; J. Weingarten, *Seder Seliḥot hamMeforash* (1979/80), 68-69. In the Masoretic Text חָמַד (masc.) occurs five times, while חֶמְדָּה (fem.) 16 times; both mean "desire, delight."

nine formation of חָמֶר (Deut. 32:14; Isa. 27:2), “wine”; the same as חָמֶר (Ezra 6:9, 7:22) and חֲמָא (abs., Dan. 5:1-2,23) in Aramaic. (2) “the Old Beth (or House of) Hamrah.” חֲמָרָה may be a variant of the personal name חֲמָרָן, Hamran (1 Chron. 1:41), final *he-nun* interchange.³⁴

בֵּית תְּבוּרָה וְתִבְרוֹת הַיָּשָׁן = בֵּית תְּבוּרָה וְתִבְרוֹת הַיָּשָׁן, “the Old Beth Tevurah/-Tevurot” — תְּבוּרָה and תִּבְרוֹת could be variants of תְּבוֹר, Tabor, a Levitical city in Zebulun (1 Chron. 6:62); cf. הַר תְּבוֹר, Mount Tabor (Judg. 4:6), also, בֵּית תְּבוֹר in the Scroll (9:14-15, alt.).

בֵּית תְּמָרָה וְתִמְרוֹת הַיָּשָׁן, “the old house of the palm(s),” or “the Old Beth Temarah/Temarot — תְּמָרָה (pl. תְּמָרוֹת; e.g., m. Dem. 1:1) is the feminine form of תְּמָר (masc., pl. תְּמָרִים; e.g., Exod. 15:27; m. Pe’ah 1:5); cf. בֵּית תְּמָר (9:14-15).

בֵּית תִּמְרוֹה וְתִמְרוֹת הַיָּשָׁן = בֵּית תִּמְרוֹה וְתִמְרוֹת הַיָּשָׁן, “the old palm-shaped house” or “the Old Beth Timorah/Timorot” — cf. תְּמָרָה and תְּמָרִים in the description of Ezekiel’s Temple (Ezek. 41:18-20).

בֵּית תְּמִירָה וְתִמְרוֹת הַיָּשָׁן = בֵּית תְּמִירָה וְתִמְרוֹת הַיָּשָׁן, “the old house of the pillar(s)” — תְּמִירָה, “pillar” (cf. t. Kel. B.M. 2:6), as well as תִּמְרוֹה are derived from תְּמָר, “date tree”; cf. [בְּמִ]עֶרֶת הָעֵמּוּד, “[In the c]lave of the pillar” (6:1-2).³⁵

בֵּית תְּמִירוֹה וְתִמְרוֹת הַיָּשָׁן = בֵּית תְּמִירוֹה וְתִמְרוֹת הַיָּשָׁן, “the old house of exchange(s)” — תְּמִירוֹה is from the root מוֹר, “to change”; cf.

Rabbi Akiva said ..., “Has it not already been stated, ‘Then it וְתִמְרוֹתוֹ (and its exchange) shall be holy’ (Lev. 27:10)? Where its sanctity descend on it? בְּבֵית הַבְּעָלִים (in the house of the owners). אֵף תְּמִירוֹתוֹ בְּבֵית הַבְּעָלִים (So its exchange [becomes holy] in the house of the owners)” (m. Tem. 1:1).

Many of these suggestions are: (1) Unattested feminine formations of known masculine nouns; cf. כּוֹבָא vs. כּוֹבָהּ (MH), “burial niche” (see #59, 12:8). (2) Possible letter interchanges. (3) Assumed compound toponyms or old buildings where the cave could have existed. (4) Similar to the possible variants of בֵּית תְּמָר in the Scroll (see #43, 9:14-15).

(2:3-4) בְּרוֹבֵד וְכָרוּבֵד הַשְּׁלִישִׁי (ל) “in/at/by the third row of stones” — ALLEGRO^{pt}: “round the pool (?)”; שְׁלִיל, “pool,” the *lamed* is written over the *šin*, and the *yod* is placed above the line; cf. שְׁלִילִית. ALLEGRO: בְּרוֹבֵד הַשְּׁלִישִׁי, “in the Platform of the Chain.” ALLEGRO^{rev}: “in the Chain Platform.”³⁶ Mi-

³⁴ חֲמָרָן, is identical with חֲמָרָן of the previous paragraph, a graphical interchange of *dalet-reš*.

³⁵ Jastrow (1677b) renders תְּמִירוֹת as “the pillars supporting the framework of a lantern.” Ben-Yehuda (8, 7802 and n. 1) suggests that it a scribal error for תְּמוֹכוֹת or תּוֹמְכוֹת, “supporters.” Even-Shoshan derives the Modern Hebrew תְּמִיר (masc., “tall, erect”) and תְּמִירוֹת (fem., “erectness, tallness”) from תְּמָר. Yet he neither mentions the feminine תְּמִירָה nor the Tosephta (ESh^{dic} 7, 2872a).

LIK: **השלישי** **דיבר**, “in the third recess,” **דיבר** is the same as **דביר** (BH). Since the letters **לי** of **השלישי** are smaller and are engraved higher than the rest of the word, the scribe first wrote **הששי**, “the sixth,” and later corrected it to **השלישי**, “the third.”³⁷ **דיבר** is a valid reading, since *dalet* and *reš*, *waw* and *yod* are often undistinguishable in the Scroll. LURIE: **ברובד השלישי**, “upon the third stone bench”; **רובד** (MH) means “stone bench, layer.”³⁸ PIXNER: **ברובד השלישי**, “in the third layer of pavement.”³⁹ SHARVIT: **דִּבְרִי** (as Milik), “corner of the bottom”; a word unknown from other sources. ALLEGRO reads **רובד**, “step”; cf. **רובדִּין של אבן** (m. Tam. 1:1).⁴⁰ WOLTERS: **ברובד השלישי**, “on the third ledge”; cf. **רובד** instead of **רובד** (11:16, alt.).⁴¹ GARCIA MARTINEZ: “in the third platform.”⁴² BEYER: **ברובד** (**השלישי**), “in the third (erroneously corrected from the sixth) step-landing.”⁴³ VERMES: “on the third platform.”⁴⁴ WISE: “on the third terrace.”⁴⁵

Regarding **השלישי ל**, the drawings differ somewhat. The scribe originally engraved **הששל**, and later, perhaps another scribe, added above the second *šin* a smaller size *lamed* and a *yod*, thus the text can be read as **הששיל** (Allegro) or **השלישל**. Nevertheless, the text remained incorrect. The last *lamed* could be a dittograph, or it is instead of a *yod*, i.e., **השלישי** (Milik, Lurie, Pixner). Cf. the superlinear *mem* of **בימ** (see #49, 10:15), *reš* of **ראש** (see #52, 11:5), and the sublinear *ayin* of **דמע** (see #55, 11:14).

רובד (MH, masc., pl. **רובדִּין**) is from the root **רבד** (BH), “to spread, deck.” It is related to **מִרְבֵּד** (masc.), “coverlet,” e.g., **מִרְבֵּדִים רַבְדֵּי עֲרֹשִׁי**, “I covered my couch with coverlets” (Prov. 7:16), and also to **רַבִּיד**, “chain”; e.g., **רַבִּיד הַזֶּהָב**, “the gold chain” (Gen. 41:42), **וְרַבִּיד עַל גְּרוֹנְךָ**, “and chain on your neck” (Ezek. 16:11). Jastrow defines **רובד** as “mosaic pavement, paved level space between steps, landing terrace.”⁴⁶ **רובד** also means “branch of a tree”; e.g., **הַיְתָה יוֹשֶׁבֶת בֵּין שְׁנֵי רוֹבְדֵי אֵילָן**, “(the mother bird) was sitting between two branches of a tree” (b. Hul. 140b).⁴⁷

Occasionally, the term **רובד** is connected with **אֶבֶן**, “stone,” **קֶבֶר**, “grave,” as well as with the Temple.

36 Allegro, 35, 139 n. 42; Allegro^{rev}, 21.

37 Milik, 286, 228 B-5c, 239 C-6; Milik^E, 139.

38 Lurie, 68-69 and nn. 3-4.

39 Pixner, 345.

40 “Jyyunim,” 133 and n. 45.

41 “Vocabulary,” 490; “Analysis,” 248; Wolters, 34-35.

42 Garcia Martinez, 461.

43 Beyer, 225-26.

44 Vermes, 374.

45 Wise, 192.

46 Jastrow, 1455a.

47 Jastrow (1455) translates it in a different manner.

He who plows over a קָבֵר (grave), and so (in the case of) one who plows over a casket/sarcophagus even (if) it is sunk בְּרוֹבְדִים וּבְאֲבָנִים (into the pavements or into the stones) and even if on them are two floors, he is creating an unclean field (t. Oh. 17:1).⁴⁸

וּשְׁתַּיִם עֲשָׂרָה מַעֲלֹת הָיוּ שָׁם (And twelve steps were there [in the Temple hall]). רֹם מַעֲלָה חֲצִי אַמָּה וְשִׁלְחָה אַמָּה (The height of a step is one half cubit, and its depth is one cubit). אַמָּה אַמָּה וְרוֹבֵד שְׁלֹשׁ (One cubit, one cubit, and the platform is three [cubits]); וְאַמָּה אַמָּה וְרוֹבֵד שְׁלֹשׁ (and one cubit, one cubit, and the platform is three [cubits]). וְהָעֲלִיזָה אַמָּה אַמָּה וְרוֹבֵד אַרְבַּע (And the uppermost, one cubit, one cubit, and the platform four [cubits]) (m. Mid. 3:6)

And (the priest) gives to the man who stirs (the sacrificial blood) עַל הָרוֹבֵד (on the fourth platform which is in the Temple) ... and he goes down and leaves it שְׁבַעֲזָרָה עַל הָרוֹבֵד (on the fourth platform which is in the Temple court) (m. Yoma 4:3).

Rashi comments, “The whole pavement is made of marble stone plates, and each row is called a רוֹבֵד” (b. Yoma 43b).⁴⁹ Likewise, the Targum of רִצְפָּה is רוֹבְדָא, “pavement” (2 Chron. 7:3), the Aramaic cognate of רוֹבֵד (see #3, 1:7). רוֹבֵד is also mentioned in the Temple Scroll; e.g., לַחוּץ מִחֻצֵּר הַחִיצוֹנָה רָחֵב אַרְבַּע עֲשָׂרָה בְּאַמָּה וְעִשְׂתֵּיתָה רוֹבֵד סָבִיב, “And you shall make a platform around outside of the Outer Courtyard fourteen cubits wide” (TS 46:6).⁵⁰

(2:4) ΘΕ שְׁשִׁין וְחֶמֶשׁ עֶשְׂתֹּת זָהָב, “sixty five masses/bars of unused gold. (Code:) ΘΕ” — עֶשְׂתֹּת זָהָב appears earlier in the Scroll, 100 עֶשְׂתֹּת זָהָב, “100 masses/bars of (unused) gold” (see #2, 1:6). Regarding the Greek letters, see Appendix C.

Finally, this item, בְּמַעֲרַת ... בְּרוֹבְדִיבְרוֹבֵד הַשְּׁלִישִׁי עֶשְׂתֹּת זָהָב שְׁשִׁין וְחֶמֶשׁ, resembles Item 2, 100 בְּנִדְבָךְ\בְּנִדְבָךְ הַשְּׁלִישִׁי עֶשְׂתֹּת זָהָב, “In/at/by a/the tomb, in the third grave stone, (there are) 100 masses/bars of unused gold.” The latter alternately can be read as, בְּנִדְבָשׁ\בְּנִדְבָשׁ בְּנִדְבָךְ הַשְּׁלִישִׁי עֶשְׂתֹּת זָהָב, “In/at/by a/the tomb of the third small pavement/paved terrace, (there are) 100 bars of unused gold.” In certain cases, נִפֶּשׁ and מְעָרָה could be synonyms (see #2, 1:5-6).

48 Also, רוֹבְדִין שֶׁל אֲבָנִים, “stone pavements” or “levels of stones between the steps” (m. Tam. 1:1; m. Mid. 1:8); this is mentioned by Allegro.

49 See also *Qorban ha-'Edah* on y. Yoma 4:3 [20a], and Bertinoro on this Mishnah.

50 See Y. Yadin, *The Temple Scroll* (Heb.) 1, 212.

ITEM 8

בצריח שבחצר מתי העצין ובתכו 2:5
 בור בן] כלין וכסף ככרין שבעין 2:6

- 2:5 In the catacomb which is in the cemetery of Ezion,
 and in its midst
- 2:6 (there is) a pit, in [it] (there are an unspecified type
 and an undisclosed number of) vessels, plus seventy
 talents of silver.

COMMENTARY

(2:5-6) בור ׀ בצריח ׀ שבחצר ׀ מתי העצין ׀ ובתכו בור, "In/at/by a/the catacomb/-tower which is in a/the cemetery of Ezion, and in its midst (there is) a pit" — ALLEGRO^{pr}: "in the tower in the court of spread with trees (?) and ... in it." "מתוח", 'spread or stretched,' and so a wooden receptacle." ALLEGRO^{pr}: "in the tower in the court, a wooden cage (?) and its document, in it" (i.e., בצריח שבחצר מתוח עצין ובתכו בור).¹ ALLEGRO: "בצריח שבחצר מתוח עצין ובתכו בור", "In the underground passage which is in The Court: a wooden barrel (?) and inside it a *bath* measure." ALLEGRO^{rev}: "In the cistern that is within the underground passage which is in the Court of the Wood Stores"; i.e., בצריח שבחצר, "בצריח שבחצר בתי העצין ובתכו בור".² MILIK: "בצריח שבחצר בתי העצין ובתכו בור", "In the underground chamber of the Courtyard of the wood-sheds, in the middle of which is a cistern." Alternately, since the first letter looks like a *mem*, חצר מתי; cf. חצר מות, "cemetery" (b. Ber. 18b).³ LURIE: "בצריח שבחצר מתי", "In the court of Mathiah, in the pit of the woods, in it there is a *bath* measure of."⁴ PIXNER: "בצריח שבחצר מתי", "In the underground passage, which is in the yard of Mathiah: a wood pile and in its middle there is a cistern."⁵ SHARVIT: "צריח" (MT) means both מגדל, "tower," and בור, "pit/cistern"; "בתי העצין" (MH), "warehouses."⁶ THORION: "בתי חצר

1 Allegro's original reading of ובתכו, "and its (masc.) document," instead of ובתכו, "and in it (masc.) midst," or "and within it," is most interesting. It is like Sarfati's suggested reading of the problematic phrase ובתכן אצלן (Milik, Allegro, Lurie, etc.). See Appendix E.

2 Allegro, 35, 139-40 nn. 44-45; Allegro^{rev}, 21.

3 Milik, 286-87, 248 C-105-06, 272 D-50; Milik^E, 139 (*wood-sheds* is in italics).

4 Lurie, 69-70 and nn. 2-3.

5 Pixner, 346 and n. 12.

העצין.⁷ WOLTERS: בצריה שבחצר מתן העצין ובתכו בירך, “In the vault which is in the court there is donated firewood, in the midst of which, in the recess.”⁸ GARCIA MARTINEZ: “In the cellar which is in Matia’s courtyard there is wood and the middle of it a cistern.”⁹ BEYER: בור בתכו מתי העצין שבחצר, “In the middle of the crypt which is located in the courtyard of Mattai from Ezion(-geber), there is a cistern.”¹⁰ VERMES: “In the underground cavity which is in the courtyard of the House of Logs, where there is a cistern.”¹¹ WISE: “In the burial chamber that is the Courtyard of Matthias: wooden vessels, along with their inventory list. In the recess in the burial chamber.”¹²

This phrase exemplifies the difficulties in reading and interpreting the Copper Scroll. The first letter of the third word is a *mem*, but may be read as a *kaf*; cf. ביאתו (Baker^{dr}, Milik^{dr}) vs. מאות ו- (Allegro^{dr}; see #4, 1:12); בקובע (ה) (Baker^{dr}) vs. בקומע (ה) (Milik^{dr}, Allegro^{dr}; see #41, 9:10). The third letter of the third word, *waw/yod*, can be read as a final *nun* (may be in middle position). The first letter of the fourth word, *he/het/taw*, may be the last letter of the third word. The first letter of the fifth word, *waw/yod*, may be the last letter of the fourth word. The last letter of the fifth word, *waw*, may be read as a final *nun*. The sixth word is בור, כורוכור, or כורוכור.

צִרְיָה occurs four more times in the Scroll (8:11; 8:14; 9:4), plus in three places the text can be emended to read צִרְיָה (9:7; 9:15; 12:9). The singular צִרְיָה appears three times in the Masoretic Text (Judg. 9:46,49), where the Targum employs the same term.¹³ The plural צִרְיָהִים occurs only once, וּתְחַבְּאוּ הָעָם בַּמְעָרוֹת וּבְתוֹחִים וּבְסֻלְעִים וּבְצִרְיָהִים וּבְבֵרוֹת, “and the people hid in the caves, and in the holes, and in the rocks, and in the *serihim*, and in the pits” (1 Sam. 13:6). The Targum for this verse is, וְאִתְמָרוּ עָמָא בַּמְעָרָתָא, “and the people hid in the caves, and in the forts, and in the overhanging rocks, and in the caves of rock, and in the pits.” Interestingly, בַּמְעָרָתָא טִינְרָא, “in the cave of the rock,” the Targum for בְּצִרְיָהִים,¹⁴ is identical with Targum Onkelos for בְּנִקְרָת הַצִּיּוֹר (Exod. 33:22; see #4, 1:12).¹⁵

Rashi offers two solutions for צִרְיָה: (1) פליישיד, *plays(s)ed*, or פליישידין, *plésediz*, “fortress” in Old-French; and (2) וודוי, *vodve*, “underground

6 “Iyyunim,” 129, 131.

7 Thorion, 170. BYT is a printing error for BTY.

8 Wolters, 34-35.

9 Garcia Martinez, 461.

10 Beyer, 225-26.

11 Vermes, 374.

12 Wise, 192. Wise divides this item into two. Regarding “inventory list,” cf. Allegro^{pr}.

13 According to Radak, the Targum considers צִרְיָה as part of the place name.

14 Perhaps the Targum should be read in the plural form, as the rest of the hiding places.

15 Many of these terms occur in the Scroll, בור, צִרְיָה, סלע, מערה, מצדתא (= מצדה), and נקרה.

vault" in Old-French.¹⁶ Many commentators and lexicographers explain צָרִיחַ as a type of מגדל, "tower."¹⁷ BDB compares צָרִיחַ with the Arabic *darīḥ*, "sepulchral chamber (with niches for bodies)" (cf. Nabatean צריחה, from *darāḥa*, "to dig."¹⁸ Ben-Yehuda suggests two roots: וצריח, "tower" (cf. Arabic *ṣrḥ*, and וצריח, "ditch" or a burial "niche" (cf. Arabic *ḍrḥ*).¹⁹ Tal notes that in Nabatean צריחה is a chamber used either for temple service or for burial.²⁰ In a Sabaeen inscription *srḥt* (צרחת) means "upper chamber."²¹

Since many hiding places mentioned in the Scroll are caves or burial sites, צָרִיחַ seems to be an underground chamber or catacomb. Yet צָרִיחַ may mean "tower" (cf. Allegro^{rev}); and the following analysis supports this possibility. The verb צפה, "to look, face," appears in the Scroll seven times (6:2; 6:8; 8:10; 8:12; 9:4; 9:7; 11:5). צפה implies that something is facing something in a certain direction. צָרִיחַ and צפה are interconnected three times in the Scroll: בצָרִיחַ הַצּוֹפָא צפון, "in the catacomb/tower which is facing north" (8:11-12); בצָרִיחַ הַצּוֹפָא מִזְרָח, "in the catacomb/tower which is facing east" (9:4-5); and בצָרִיחַ הַחֲרוּן בְּרוֹחַ הַצּוֹפָא הַצּוֹפָא מִיָּם, "In/at/by/between/among the catacombs/towers of Horon in the direction which is facing west/sea" (9:7); cf. כְּמִגְדַּל הַלְבָּנוֹן צוֹפָה פְּנֵי דַמְשֶׁק, "like the Tower of Lebanon facing toward Damascus" (Songs 7:5; see #25, 6:2).

שְׁבַחֲצֵר (const.) means "which is in/at/by a/the courtyard of." שְׁבַחֲצֵר occurs earlier in the the Scroll, כְּבוֹרוֹ בְּבוֹר הַגָּדוֹל שְׁבַחֲצֵר הַפְּרָסְטוֹן, "In the great pit/cistern which is in/at/by the Court of the Peristyle" (see #3, 1:6).

בְּתֵי הָ-, "houses of the" (Milik, Allegro^{rev}), where בְּתֵי is the plural construct state of בֵּית (masc.), "house"; e.g., עַל בְּתֵי הָעִיר, "upon the houses of the city" (Jer. 33:4). Regarding בֵּית, see #7, 2:3.

וְאַלֶּה בְּנֵי בִתְיָה בַת פֶּרְעֶה, Bithiah, is personal female name; e.g., "and these are the sons of Bithiah the daughter of Pharaoh" (1 Chron. 4:18).

חֲמִישָׁה תְּלִמִּידִים הָיוּ לוֹ לִישׁוֹ, (= מַטַּי הָ-, "Mattai the" (Beyer); cf.

16 See Greenberg, 70, 74, 279 n. 240 (פליישר seem to be copyist error for פליישר); HR 3, 292b (old pagination).

17 E.g., מגדל, "tower" (Radak; SB, 730a; Harkavy, 614b; BY 6, 5631 and nn. 1-2; ESh^{con} 3, 1054b; ESh^{dic} 5, 2265a); מגדל חזק, "strong tower" (Rabag); מגדל גבוה, "tall tower" (*Mešudat Zion*); שן הסלע, "peek of the rock" (Rif). The Targumic צריח is explained as: "Tsriah, Gathering Place, Tower," a place name (Jastrow, 1301b); or the meaning of the place is מגדל, "tower" (AC 7, 47a).

18 BDB, 863b.

19 BY 6, 5631a and nn. 1-2.

20 A. Tal, *The Language of the Targum of the Former Prophets and its Position within the Aramaic Dialects* (Heb., 1975), 93 and n. 29.

21 The inscription reads *sqh wmswd wsrht*, "the cistern and the incense burner sanctuary and the upper room." A. Jamme, *Sabaeen Inscriptions from Mahram Bilqis (Marib)* (1961), 104, #603:5-6, and the notes to these lines. The term *sqh* is like the Arabic *siqayat*, "cistern, reservoir," a cognate of שקת mentioned in the Scroll (10:16).

מַתַּי נִקָּאִי נֶשֶׁר וְבוּנִי וְתוֹדָה, “Jesus had five disciples: Mattai, Naqqai, Nešer, and Buni, and Todah” (baraita, b. San. 43a).²² The personal names מַתַּי, מַתִּיָּה, and מַתְתִּיָּה appear in various funeral inscriptions from the Second Temple era.²³

מַתִּי ה־, “men of the”; מַתִּי is the construct of מַתִּים, which is always plural;²⁴ e.g., מַתִּי יִשְׂרָאֵל, “men of Israel” (Isa. 41:14).

מַתִּי ה־ (cf. Milik alt.), “dead (pl.) of the”; מַתִּי is the construct state of מַתִּים, the plural of מַת (masc.), “dead, corpse”; e.g., מַתִּי מִלְחָמָה, “dead (pl.) of battle” or “war dead (pl.)” (Isa. 22:2). The singular occurs later in the Scroll, תַּחַת הַמֵּת, “under the corps” (see #14, 3:12-13).

מַתִּיָּה (= מַתִּיָּא; Lurie, Pixner, Garcia Martinez, Wise), Mathiah; e.g., the Tanna רַבִּי מַתִּיָּא בֶּן חֶרֶשׁ, Rabbi Mathiah son of Hereš (m. 'Avot 4:15).²⁵

מַתָּן ה־, “Mattan the”; e.g., וַיִּשְׁמַע שְׁפַטְיָה בֶּן מַתָּן, “And heard Shephatiah son of Mattan” (Jer. 38:1).

מַתָּן ה־, “offering/gift of the” (sg. masc. const., plus the definite article of the next word; cf. Wolters).

מַתָּנָה = מַתָּנָה, “offering, gift” (sg. fem.); or מַתָּנָה = מַתָּנָה, “offering/gift of” (sg. fem. const.).

מַתָּנוֹת = מַתָּנוֹת, “offerings, gifts” (pl. fem.); or מַתָּנוֹת = מַתָּנוֹת, “offerings/gifts of” (pl. fem. const.). מַתָּן (masc., BH, MH) and מַתָּנָה (fem., BH, MH; both from the root נתן, “to give, present”) are synonyms for קָרְבָּן קָרְבָּן, אִישׁ כְּמַתָּנֵת יָדוֹ, “each man according to the gift of his hand” (Deut. 16:17); וְזֶה לַיהוָה תְּרוּמָתָם, “and this is yours, the elevated gift of their offerings” (Num. 18:11); מִכָּל מַתָּנֵיכֶם תְּרִימוּ אֶת כָּל תְּרוּמַת ה', “From all the gifts (presented) to you (Levites), you shall set apart all the elevated gifts due to the Lord” (Num. 18:29). The above possible readings can also be compared to קָרְבֵּן הָעֵצִים, “the wood offering” for the altar in the Temple (Neh. 10:35, 13:31). There were days when certain families brought wood offerings to the Temple, even

22 This baraita was deleted by censors in most published versions of the Babylonian Talmud. See, *Hesronot haššas* (1865), 44-45; *AC* 5, 288a; Jastrow, 859a; also, J.D. Eisenstein, “ישו (בתלמוד ומדרש)” in *OY* 5, 230a; E.E. Urbach, “ישו (בתלמוד ובמדרש)” in *EH* 20, 432-34; “Jesus (in Talmud and Midrash),” *EJ* 10, 14-15.

23 See E.Y. Kutscher, “הכתובות העבריות והארמיות בירושלים מימי הבית השני” in *Hebrew and Aramaic Studies* (1977), 356.

24 The singular מת occurs in Ugaritic; e.g., *dnil mt rpi*, “Danil man of god” (1 Aqht 19-21, etc.). See *UT*, 439 (#1569); *WUS*, 198 (#1705).

25 Also in an Aramaic funeral inscription from the Second Temple era, וְבִרְיָה, “Wife of Mattiah and his/her son” (cf. E.Y. Kutscher, “הכתובות העבריות והארמיות בירושלים מימי הבית השני” in *Hebrew and Aramaic Studies* [1977], 352). These names are related to מַתָּנִי, Mattanai (Ezra 10:33, etc.), מַתָּנִיָּה, Mattaniah (2 Kings 24:17, etc.), מַתָּנִיָּהוּ, Mattanyahu (1 Chron. 25:4, etc.), and מַתָּתִיָּהוּ, Mattathias (1 Chron. 9:31, 15:28, etc.); cf. Jastrow, 859b, 861b; Lurie, 69-70 n. 2. Many of these names mean, “Present of God.”

when *לְשֹׁכָה מְלֵאָה עֲצִים*, “(the) chamber (was) full with wood” (m. Ta’an. 4:4-5; t. Ta’an. 4 [3]:4-5; y. Ta’an. 4:4 [19b]; b. Ta’an. 26a, 28a).²⁶

עֲצֵי הָעֵצִין, “(the) trees, wood,” is the plural of *עֵץ* (masc.). In Biblical Hebrew *עֵץ* means both “tree” and “wood,” while Mishnaic Hebrew usually differentiates between *עֵץ*, “wood” for burning or building, and *אֵילָן* (pl. *אֵילָנוֹת*), “tree.”²⁷

עֲצִיּוֹן עֲצִין גִּבֵּר, “(the) Ezion”; it may be a shortened form of *Ezion-geber*, a city near Elath (e.g., Deut. 2:8).

עֲצִיּוֹן הָעֵזֶן = *עֲצֵי הָעֵזֶן*, “(the) Ezen,” a certain toponym, its location is unknown.²⁸ In *עֲצִין* the *yod* may represent a Tiberian *šewa*.²⁹ *עֲצִין* may be a variant or shortened form of *עֲצִיּוֹן* Ezion.

עֲצִיּוֹן הָעֲצִינִי = *עֲצִיּוֹן הָעֲצִינִי*, “of (the) Ezion,” or “the Ezionite,” gentile of *עֲצִיּוֹן*, Ezion (Beyer).

עֲצִיּוֹן הָעֲצִנִי = *עֲצִיּוֹן הָעֲצִנִי*, “of (the) Ezen,” or “the Ezenite,” gentile of *עֲצִין*, Ezen; cf. *עֲדִינוֹ הָעֲצִנִי*,²⁹ “Adino the Ezenite” (2 Sam. 23:8). In *עֲצִין* the *yod* may represent a Tiberian *šewa*. In the last two suggestions, there is a final *nun* in middle position.

בְּתוֹכָוּ וּבְתוֹכּוֹ, “(and) in its (masc.) midst,” is in apposition to *בְּצִירָה* (masc.); cf. *וַיִּבֶן מְגִדָּל בְּתוֹכּוֹ* ... *וַיִּבֶן שָׁמֶן בְּקֶרֶן בְּנֵי שָׁמֶן*, “my beloved had a vineyard in a fertile corner ... and he built a tower in its (masc.; i.e., the vineyard’s) midst” (Isa. 5:1-2).

בְּתוֹכָם וּבְתוֹכָם (= *בְּתוֹכָם וּבְתוֹכָם*), “(and/plus) in their (masc.) midst,” is in apposition to *עֲצִין*, “woods,” i.e., and in the midst of the woods; cf. *כִּי כָל הָעֵדָה כֻּלָּם קְדוֹשִׁים וּבְתוֹכָם ה'*, “since all the congregation, all of them are holy, and the Lord is among them” (Num. 16:3). The *waw* is read as short-legged final *nun*. *תַּכְּן* (ב) (1) occurs five times in the Scroll (see Appendix E).

בּוֹר, “pit, cistern,” which occurs seven times in the Scroll, can also be read as *בּוֹר וְכוּף*, “burial niche” (with a short-legged final *kaf*), and as *כוּר* - *כוּר*, “furnace.” Cf. *בְּתוֹךְ כּוּר*, “in (the) midst of (the) furnace,” and *אֵל תּוֹךְ כּוּר*, “to (the) midst of (the) furnace” (Ezek. 22:18, 22 and 22:20, respectively). Regarding *בּוֹר*, see #3, 1:6; for *כוּךְ*, #59, 12:8; for *כוּר*, #17, 4:6.

26 One of the families was *בְּנֵי אֶרַח בֶּן יְהוּדָה*, “the children of Arah ben Judah.” *אֶרַח* may be connected with the difficult word *אֶרֶח* (see #1, 1:3).

27 This is also the case in Aramaic. When *עֵץ* is “wood,” usually Onkelos renders *אֶעָ*, *אֶעָ* (e.g., Lev. 11:32, 14:4; *ʿalef-ʿayin* and *ʿayin-šade* interchanges); when *עֵץ* means “tree,” its Targum is *אֵילָן*, *אֵילָנָא* (e.g., Gen. 1:11, 29). *אֵילָן* in Hebrew is considered to be an Aramaic loanword (cf. Dan. 4:7), yet it may be a variant of *אֵלון*, *אֵלון*, *אֵלָה*, *אֵלָה* (*he-nun* interchange in final position), all denoting certain type of “trees” (e.g., Hos. 4:13; Josh. 19:33, 24:26). Regarding the blessing on fruits of tree, the Mishnah uses the term *אֵילָן*, while the blessing has *עֵץ*; “One (is obligated) to say before eating *פִּרְיֵת הָאֵילָן* (fruits of the tree), ‘(Blessed are You ...) creator of *הָעֵץ* (the fruit of the tree)’” (m. Ber. 6:1).

28 Cf. SB, 660b; ESh^{con} 3, 1697a.

29 This is the *qeri*; the *ketiv* is *עֲצִינוֹ*.

Based on the above, the following are possible readings, vocalizations, and interpretations. They include many suggestions offered by the scholars.

בְּצִרְתִּי־בִצְרִית שְׁבַחְצֹר בְּתִי הָעֵצִין וּבְתִכּוֹ בּוֹרֻכּוֹ־בּוֹרֻכּוֹ, “In/at/by a/the catacomb/tower which is in/at/by a/the courtyard of the houses of the trees (i.e., woodsheds), and in its (i.e., the catacomb’s/tower’s) midst (there is) a pit/cistern/burial-niche/furnace.”

בְּצִרְתִּי־בִצְרִית שְׁבַחְצֹר בְּתִי הָעֵצִין וּבְתִכְנָן בּוֹרֻכּוֹ־בּוֹרֻכּוֹ, “In/at/by a/the catacomb/tower which is in/at/by a/the courtyard of the houses of the trees (i.e., woodsheds), plus in their (i.e., the woodsheds’) midst (there is) a pit/cistern/burial-niche/furnace.” Thus, in two places were objects hidden.

The plural הָעֵצִין בְּתִי shows that there were more than one “wood storage house” in this courtyard. The Mishnah names the wood storage of the Temple as הָעֵצִים, דִּיר הָעֵצִים, “shed of wood,” and לְשֵׁכֶת הָעֵצִים, “compartment for storage of wood.” הָעֵצִין בְּתִי may be identical with הָעֵצִים דִּיר or לְשֵׁכֶת הָעֵצִים of the Temple (cf. Milik).

Rabbi Joshua testified that once they found (human) bones בְּדִיר הָעֵצִים (in the wood storage of the Temple) and the sages ordered to collect (and remove) each bone separately, and everything remained (ritually) clean” (m. Ed. 8:5; cf. t. Ed. 3:3; b. Zev. 113a).

... (in the) northeast (of the Women’s court in the Temple) was לְשֵׁכֶת הָעֵצִים (the compartment of the wood storage) where the blemished (priests) removed the wormy parts from the wood (used for the altar)” (m. Mid. 2:5).

If the reading is בּוֹרֻכּוֹ־בּוֹרֻכּוֹ, then the burial niche was located in the catacomb. If the reading is בּוֹרֻכּוֹ־בּוֹרֻכּוֹ, then the furnace was located in the catacomb, and the woodshed was needed for the furnace. If it is read as וּבְתִכּוֹן, then the pit, niche, or furnace was located among the woodsheds.

בְּצִרְתִּי־בִצְרִית שְׁבַחְצֹר מִתֵּן הָעֵצִין וּבְתִכּוֹ בּוֹרֻכּוֹ־בּוֹרֻכּוֹ or בְּצִרְתִּי־בִצְרִית שְׁבַחְצֹר מִתֵּן הָעֵצִין וּבְתִכּוֹ בּוֹרֻכּוֹ־בּוֹרֻכּוֹ, “In/at/by a/the catacomb/tower which is in/at/by a/the courtyard of the wood offering(s), and in its (i.e., the catacomb’s/tower’s) midst (there is) a pit/cistern/burial-niche/furnace.” Perhaps it refers to a courtyard where the offered wood were stored for the altar of the Temple.

בְּצִרְתִּי־בִצְרִית שְׁבַחְצֹר מִתְּנֵה־מִתְּנֵה (= מִתְּנֵה־מִתְּנֵה) עֵצִין וּבְתִכּוֹ בּוֹרֻכּוֹ־בּוֹרֻכּוֹ, “In/at/by a/the catacomb/tower which is in/at/by the Courtyard of the Gift(s), (there are) trees, and in its (i.e., the catacomb/tower) midst (there is) a pit/cistern/burial-niche/furnace.” חֲצֹר מִתְּנֵה־מִתְּנֵה, “Courtyard of the Gift(s),” may refer to a place where Temple gifts were collected.

בְּצִרְתִּי־בִצְרִית שְׁבַחְצֹר מִתְּנֵה־מִתְּנֵה (= מִתְּנֵה־מִתְּנֵה) עֵצִין וּבְתִכְנָן בּוֹרֻכּוֹ־בּוֹרֻכּוֹ, “In/at/by a/the catacomb/tower which is in/at/by the Courtyard of the Gift(s), (there are) trees, plus in their (i.e., the trees’) midst (there is) a pit/cistern/burial-niche/furnace.” Thus, in two locations were objects hidden.

בְּצִרְיָה־בְּצָרִיחַ שְׁבַחְצֵר מְתִימָתָן הָעֲצִינִי (= הָעֲצִינִי־הָעֲצִנִי) בְּתִכּוֹ בּוֹרוֹכָה־כּוֹר־כּוֹר
 בְּצִרְיָה־בְּצָרִיחַ שְׁבַחְצֵר מְתִימָתָה עֲצִינִי (= עֲצִינִי־הָעֲצִנִי) בְּתִכּוֹ בּוֹרוֹכָה־כּוֹר־כּוֹר or וְכוּר
 "In/at/by a/the catacomb/tower which is in/at/by a/the courtyard of Mattai/Matiah (the) Ezionite/Ezenite, and in its (i.e., the catacomb's/tower's) midst (there is) a pit/cistern/burial-niche/furnace." Accordingly, the courtyard belonged to or was named after a certain person.

בְּצִרְיָה־בְּצָרִיחַ שְׁבַחְצֵר מְתִי הָעֲצִינִי־הָעֲצִנִי וּבְתִכּוֹ בּוֹרוֹכָה־כּוֹר־כּוֹר
 a/the catacomb which is in/at/by a/the courtyard of the dead of Ezion/Ezen, and in its (i.e., the catacomb's) midst (there is) a pit/cistern/burial-niche/furnace." Accordingly, the courtyard was a cemetery that had a catacomb, and in the catacomb there was a pit, cistern, burial niche, or furnace. Cf. the Judeo-Aramaic phrase, אָזִיל בְּתַרְיָה לְחַצֵּר מָוֶת, "he went after him in the cemetery" (b. Ber. 18b).

בְּצִרְיָה־בְּצָרִיחַ שְׁבַחְצֵר מְתִי הָעֲצִינִי־הָעֲצִנִי וּבְתִכּוֹ בּוֹרוֹכָה־כּוֹר־כּוֹר
 a/the catacomb which is in/at/by a/the courtyard of the dead (pl.) of Ezion/Ezen, and in their (i.e., the graves') midst (there is) a pit/cistern/burial-niche/furnace." Accordingly, the courtyard was a cemetery that had a catacomb, and the middle of the cemetery there was a pit, cistern, burial niche, or furnace. Perhaps in both places were hidden certain objects.

בְּצִרְיָה־בְּצָרִיחַ שְׁבַחְצֵר מְתִי הָעֲצִינִי־הָעֲצִנִי וּבְתִכּוֹ בּוֹרוֹכָה־כּוֹר־כּוֹר
 a/the catacomb/tower which is in a/the courtyard of the men of Ezion/Ezen, and in its (i.e., the catacomb's/tower's) midst (there is) a pit/cistern/burial-niche/furnace." Accordingly, the courtyard belonged to or was named after the "men of Ezion or Ezen."

(2:6) בּוֹר [בּוֹ] כְּלִין, "(there is) a pit/cistern, in [it] (there are vessels)" — The reconstruction seems certain; cf. בּוֹר [בּוֹ] כְּלִין ... בּוֹר [בּוֹ] כְּלִין, "in a/the pit/cistern ... in it (there are) vessels" (see #9, 2:7-8; #18, 4:9-10).

There are minor differences between the drawings. BAKER: *bet/kaf*, a small *waw/yod*, a small *dalet/reš*, a letter sized space, a letter fragment that could be *bet/kaf/nun*, a 'good' letter size space, a damaged *bet/kaf*, a damaged *lamed*, *yod*, and a final *nun*. MILIK: *bet/kaf*, *waw/yod*, *dalet/reš*, a letter size space, a damaged *bet/kaf*, a 'good' letter size space, a damaged *bet/kaf*, *lamed*, *yod*, and a final *nun*. ALLEGRO: *bet/kaf*, a somewhat small-headed *reš*, a short-headed *reš*, two-three letter-size spaces, a damaged *bet/kaf*, a narrow space, a damaged *bet/kaf/mem*, a damaged *lamed*, *yod*, and a final *nun*. In addition, Allegro's drawing indicate a crack that runs through the first three letters and the space following them into the next words, of which all the three drawings show that the top is damaged by a lacuna.

These words have been analyzed as follows. MILIK: בּוֹר [בּוֹ] כְּלִין.³⁰ ALLEG-

³⁰ Milik, 286.

RO: **בַּת מִטְבָּלִין**, “a *bath* measure of untithed goods.”³¹ LURIE: **בת מטבלין** (as Allegro).³² WOLTERS: **בִּירַךְ כְּלִין**, “in the recess: vessels.”³³ ALLEGRO^{rev}, PIXNER, BEYER, GARCIA MARTINEZ, and VERMES follow Milik, while WISE agrees with Wolters.³⁴

Finally, according to the drawings of Baker and Milik, **בִּירַךְ** (= **בִּירָךְ**), “in the bottom” (cf. Wolters), is a sound reading; cf. **בְּבוֹרֵי בְּבוֹר הַגָּדוֹל ... בִּירָךְ**, “In the large cistern ... in/at/by a/the side of its bottom” (see #3, 1:6-7); **בִּירָךְ ... בְּצִרְיָיִי הַחוּרֹן**, “In/at/by/between/among the catacombs of Horon ... in the bottom” (alt., see #40, 9:7-8).

(2:6) **כְּלִין וְכֶסֶף כְּכָרִין שְׁבַעֲיִן**, “(an unspecified type and an undisclosed number of) vessels, plus seventy talents of silver”; or “(an unspecified type and an undisclosed number of) vessels, plus silver (totaling) seventy talents.”

כְּכָרִין, “talents,” can also be read as **כְּכָדִין**, “in pitchers,” as in other six cases in the Scroll (see Appendix A). Accordingly, **כְּלִין וְכֶסֶף כְּכָדִין שְׁבַעֲיִן** means, “(an unspecified type and an undisclosed number of) vessels, plus (an undisclosed amount of) silver in seventy pitchers”; or “(an unspecified type and an undisclosed number of) vessels, plus seventy silver (pieces/shekels) in (undisclosed number of) pitchers.”

Finally, the middle letter of the word in question is a small sized *reš* or *dalet*; it is an obvious scribal correction. In ALLEGRO's drawing this small letter may be the lower part of a *lamed* of which most of the upper vertical line is missing, i.e., **כְּכָלִין**, “in vessels.” Accordingly, **כְּלִין וְכֶסֶף כְּכָלִין שְׁבַעֲיִן** means, “(an unspecified type and an undisclosed number of) vessels, plus (an undisclosed amount of) silver in seventy vessels”; or “(an unspecified type and an undisclosed number of) vessels, plus seventy silver (pieces/shekels) in (an undisclosed number of) vessels.”

31 Allegro, 35, 139-40 nn. 44-45.

32 Lurie, 69-70, and nn. 3-4 (in the translation **כַּר** is a printing error for **בת**).

33 Wolters, 34-35.

34 Allegro^{rev}, 21; Pixner, 346; Garcia Martinez, 461; Beyer, 225-26; Vermes, 374; Wise, 192.

ITEM 9

בבור שנגד השער המזרחי	2:7
רחוק אמות תשעסרא בו כלין	2:8
ובמוקא שבו ככרין עסר ΔI	2:9

- 2:7 In the cistern which is opposite to the eastern gate,
 2:8 at a distance of nineteen cubits, in it (there are)
 vessels;
 2:9 and in the channel which is in it, (there are) ten
 (unspecified) talents. (Code:) ΔI.

COMMENTARY

Since this item refers to two separate deposits, it may be subdivided into Item 9a (2:7-8) — a deposit hidden in the cistern, and Item 9b (2:9) — a deposit hidden in the irrigation channel of the cistern. MILIK, PIXNER, WOLTERS, GARCIA MARTINEZ, VERMES, and WISE use this approach, while ALLEGRO, LURIE, and BEYER consider them as a single unit.¹

(2:7) בְּבוֹרִיבְּבוֹר שֶׁנֶּגֶד הַשַּׁעַר הַמְּזֻרְחִי, “In a/the cistern/pit which is opposite to the eastern gate” — This phrase consists of the preposition *bet* prefixed to a noun (בְּבוֹרִיבְּבוֹר), the relative *šin* prefixed to a preposition (שֶׁנֶּגֶד), the definite article *he* prefixed to a noun (הַשַּׁעַר), and the definite article *he* prefixed to an adjective modifying the previous noun (הַמְּזֻרְחִי). Cf. בְּבוֹר הַמֶּלַח, “in/at/by the salt pit which is below the steps” (see #6, 2:1); בְּבוֹרִיבְּבוֹר שֶׁתַּחַת הַחוֹמָא, “In/at/by a/the cistern which is below the city-wall” (see #10, 2:10); and בְּקִבְרוֹבְּקִבְר שֶׁתַּחַת הַסְּבִין (= הַסְּפִים), “In/at/by a/the grave which is below the thresholds” (see #53, 11:8).

בוֹר, which occurs seven times in the Scroll, can also be read as כּוֹרִיבוֹר, “furnace” (the *bet* is read as a *kaf*), and כּוֹרִיבוֹר, “burial niche” (the *reš* is read as a short-legged final *kaf*; see #3, 1:6; #8, 2:6; #17, 4:6; #59, 12:8).

שֶׁנֶּגֶד הַשַּׁעַר הַמְּזֻרְחִי, “which is opposite to the eastern gate,” resembles the verse עַד נֶגֶד שַׁעַר הַמַּיִם לַמְּזֻרְחָא, “up to opposite the Water Gate on the east” (Neh. 3:26); also נֶגֶד הַפֶּתַח הָעֶלְיוֹן, “opposite to the upper entrance” (see #3,

¹ Milik, 286; Pixner, 346; Wolters, 34-35; “Analysis,” 248; Garcia Martinez, 461; Vermes, 374; Wise, 192; Allegro^{PF}; Allegro, 35; Allegro^{rev}, 22; Lurie, 70-71; Beyer, 225-26.

1:8); נִגְדַּת גִּנַּת צִדּוֹק, “in front of (the) Garden of Zadok (see #52, 11:6).

הַשַּׁעַר הַמִּזְרָחִי, “the eastern gate,” suggests that this city had more than one gate. Nehemiah mentions the Eastern Gate of Jerusalem, שְׁמַעְיָה בֶּן שְׁכַנְיָה שֹׁמֵר שַׁעַר הַמִּזְרָח, “Shemaiah son of Shecaniah, guard of the East Gate” (Neh. 3:29). The Mishnah talks about the Eastern Gate of the Temple (m. Mid. 1:13).² In addition, the next item refers to the wall (הַחוּמָּא) of an unnamed city (2:10). Thus, one can reasonably assume that the unnamed city in both items is Jerusalem or the Temple (cf. Milik, Allegro, Pixner, Wise).

(2:8) רְחוֹק אֲמוּת תִּשְׁעָסְרָא (= תִּשְׁעָ עֶשְׂרֵה), “at a distance of nineteen cubits” — The adjective רְחוֹק (masc., רְחוֹקָה, fem.) means “distant, removed” (from the root רָחַק, “to be distant”). While this adjective occurs 85 times in the Masoretic Text, it is not associated with specific measurement. However, in Mishnaic Hebrew, it often does. E.g.,

הָיָה רְחוֹק מִבֵּית הַסֵּקִילָה כְּעֶשֶׂר אַמּוֹת ([when the person to be executed] was at a distance of about ten cubits from the stoning house) ... הָיָה רְחוֹק מִבֵּית הַסֵּקִילָה אַרְבַּע אַמּוֹת ([when] he was at a distance of four cubits from the stoning house)” (m. San. 6:2-3).

שש עסרה has been interpreted as follows. ALLEGRO^{pr}: תשעסרא for עסרה (2:8), “six(?)teen.” ALLEGRO: תשע <ע>סרא, “nineteen.” The loss of ‘ayin is due to weakening of the gutturals.³ MILIK: חָמֶשׁ עֶסְרָא, “fifteen”; alternatively תשעסרא, “nineteen.”⁴ LURIE: תשע סרא (= תשע עשרה); loss of ‘ayin.⁵ THORION: תשעסרא (?); in the spelling of סרא either the ‘ayin has been lost, or it is a haplography.⁶ GARCIA MARTINEZ and VERMES agree with Milik, while PIXNER, WOLTERS, BEYER, and WISE follow Milik’s alternate reading.⁷

Regarding this number, the drawings differ. BAKER^{dr} and MILIK^{dr}: תשעסרא, a single word having some spaces before and after it. ALLEGRO^{dr}: תשע is followed by a space, then a vertical dotted line passing through the column where the Scroll was cut open. The cut removed the left side of the *samekh* of the word סרא. When the drawings of the two halves were matched, the left half of lines 7 and 8 somehow moved lower than the right half of the column. As a result, סרא is about one-half cm. higher than the word תשע.

תשעסרא is a contracted form of תשע עשרה (= תשע עשרה), where the two ‘ayins merged, while the *sin* and *samekh* interchanged; cf. שבע (= שבע עשרה).

2 A number of שַׁעֲרִים (pl. of שַׁעַר) are mentioned in the Temple Scroll, e.g., שַׁעַר יְהוּדָה שַׁעַר שִׁמְעוֹן שַׁעַר רְאוּבֵן ... שַׁעַר שִׁמְעוֹן ... “Judah Gate ... Simeon Gate ... Reuben Gate” (TS 44:7-11).

3 Allegro, 35; 140 n. 48; Allegro^{rev}, 22.

4 Milik, 286-87, 229 B-12; Milik^E, 139.

5 Lurie, 70-71 and n. 2.

6 Thorion, 167 (in the transcription the *sin* should be a *samekh*; a typographical error).

7 Garcia Martinez, 461; Vermes, 374; Pixner, 346; Wolters, 34-35; Beyer, 225-26; Wise, 192.

עֶשְׂרֶה, "seventeen" (1:4), and שְׁלוֹשָׁרָא (= שְׁלוֹשׁ עֶשְׂרֶה), "thirteen" (9:2). Contracted teens are known from Aramaic, Syriac, Mandaic, etc., yet they do not occur in the Hebrew literature.

תִּשְׁע סָרָא, the reading of Allegro's drawing, can be explained as: (1) a non-contracted form of a contracted teen, such occurs in Aramaic; (2) an Aramaic loanword; (3) the missing 'ayin is due to the loss of gutturals (cf. Allegro, Lurie); (4) or a scribal error (cf. Thorion). The reading of תִּשְׁע סָרָא does not change the fact that Copper Scroll Hebrew uses contracted teens (see Appendix B).

(2:9) וּבְמוֹקָא וּבְמוֹקָא, "and in a/the channel" — ALLEGRO^{pr}: וּבְמוֹקָא, "and in the silt"; מוֹקָא, literally "soft and spongy substance"; cf. מֶקֶק (?). ALLEGRO: מוֹקָא, "and in the hollow."⁸ MILIK: וּבְמוֹקָא, "And in the canal." מוֹקָא (pl.) occurs later in the Scroll (10:3); also, מוֹזִיקָא is the Targum for תַּעֲלָה.⁹ LURIE: מוֹקָא for וּבְעֵמוֹקָה (loss of 'ayin), "and in the depth."¹⁰ Surprisingly, GREENFIELD takes "strong exception" to Milik's interpretation of מוֹקָא.¹¹ The other scholars, including ALLEGRO^{rev}, agree with Milik.¹²

In the Masoretic Text תַּעֲלָה (fem.), "(irrigating) channel," occurs nine times. Seven of these cases the Targumim render מוֹזִיקָא (pl. abs.; if singular absolute, it should be vocalized as מוֹזִיקָתָא) and מוֹזִיקָתָא (sg. const.);¹³ once there are three versions, one of them is חֲרִיצֵי מַיִם (= חֲרוּצֵי חֲרִיצֵי מַיִם in Hebrew), "ditches of water" (Job 38:25); and once is explained in a Midrashic manner (Ezek. 41:4). In the verse בְּתַעֲלַת הַבְּרֶכָה הָעֲלִיּוֹנָה (Trg. בְּמוֹזִיקָתָא בְּרִיקָתָא עֲלִיּוֹנָה), "in the canal of the upper pool" (2 Kgs 18:17; Isa. 36:2; cf. Isa. 7:3), בְּרֶכָה is a pool built from stone and lime into the ground, and תַּעֲלָה is a ditch dug in the ground in which the water flows into the pool.¹⁴ Rashi renders תַּעֲלָה, חֲרוּץ, and חֲרִיץ as פּוֹשִׁיד, *fossed, fosed* in Old-French, "ditch, trench."¹⁵ Jastrow connects מוֹזִיקָתָא, "irrigating channel," with זִיקָא, "sprinkler, hose, skin for wine or water."¹⁶ Kohut translates מוֹזִיקָתָא

8 Allegro, 35, 140 n. 51.

9 Milik, 286, 244 C-72 (מוֹקָה is a typographical error for מוֹקָא); Milik^E, 139.

10 Lurie, 70-71 and n. 3.

11 Greenfield, 139b (in the list 71 is a typographical error for 72).

12 Allegro^{rev}, 22; Pixner, 346; Bendavid, 1, 99; Sharvit in "Iyyunim," 134. Wolters, 34-35; Garcia Martinez, 461; Beyer, 225-26; Vermes, 374; Wise, 192.

13 1 Kgs 18:32, 35, 38; 2 Kgs 18:17, 20:20; Isa. 7:3, 36:2. Some of these are mentioned by Milik and Sharvit.

14 See Rashi, Radak, Ralbag, and *Mešudat Zion* on this verse. The terms בְּרֶכָה, הָעֲלִיּוֹנָה occur in the Scroll (2:13, 1:8, 12:4, respectively).

15 See Rashi on תַּעֲלָה, 1 Kgs 18:32; 2 Kgs 18:17; Isa. 7:3, 36:2; on חֲרוּץ, Dan. 9:25; on חֲרִיץ, b. B.B. 107b. See also Catane (110a); Greenberg (84, 87, 93, 102, 226); Gukovitzki (80 #1175).

16 Jastrow, 396a, 755a.

- מִזְקָא as *Graben, Wasserbehälter* (“ditch, cistern”).¹⁷ Accordingly, מִזְקָא - מִזְקָה is a cognate or loanword of the Aramaic (א) מִזְקָת, and synonymous to מִזְקָה, מִזְקָה, and מִזְקָה. Regarding בִּרְכָה, see #11, 2:13.

מִזְקָא (= מִזְקָה, fem.), “water channel,” occurs later in the plural form מִזְקָת (see #45, 10:3). It is either derived from the root family זִק - זִיק - זִק - זִק, “to bind, join, forge, refine,” with a prefixed locative *mem*;¹⁸ or from the root מִזְק, related to מִזְג and מִסַּךְ (*gimmel-kaf-qof*, as well as *zayin-samekh* interchanges). The verbal forms of מִסַּךְ (BH) and מִזְג (MH, JA) mean “mixing drinks,” while the nominal, “mixture of drink.”¹⁹ The latter is a biblical *hapax legomenon*, מִזְגַּת הַמִּזְג, “the mixture of drink shall not be lacking” (Songs 7:3). In the Targumic explanation of this phrase, “(it is) not wanting מִזְגַּת הַמִּזְג (the water of the Great River) which flows from (the Garden) of Eden,” connotes flowing river. מִזְקָה can be compared to מִזְקָה (fem., MH), “mixture” of wine with water; e.g., מִזְקָה הַכּוֹס, “wine, enough for the mixture of a (full) cup” (m. Shab. 8:1; etc.).

(2:7-9) בִּבְרוּבָבוּר ... בּוּ כֵלִין ... וּבְמִזְקָא וּבְמִזְקָא שְׁבוּ — Both בּוּ, “in it (masc.),” and שְׁבוּ, “which is in it (masc.),” refer to בּוּר (usually masc.), “pit/cistern”; the first means “in a/the cistern/pit (there are) vessels” (see #18, 4:9-10), and the second tells that “a/the channel is located in/at/by the cistern/pit”; cf. בְּקִבְרוֹ בְּקִבְרָא ... בּוּ כֵלִין דְּמַע, “In a/the grave of ..., in it (there are) dedicated vessels” (see #54, 11:9-10). In these cases בּוּ, “in it (masc.),” refers to בּוּר and קִבְרָא (masc.), “grave,” respectively. Therefore, בִּבְרוּבָבוּר should be rendered as, “in a/the pit/cistern,” rather than “at/by a/the pit/cistern.” Also cf. בְּדִין בְּדִין שֶׁל הַשּׂוֹא בְּצִירְתָּהּ בְּצִירְתָּהּ שְׁבָא שְׁבָא, “In/at/by (the) Din of the Shaveh/Plain/Ruler, in/at/by a/the catacomb/tower which is in it (fem./masc.)” (8:14). The form בּוּ (ש)ב(...)וּה means, “in (a/the) ... (which is) in it(s ...)” (see #3, 1:6-7; #11, 2:13-14; #37, 8:14; #43, 9:14-16; #45, 10:4).

(2:9) ΔΙ כְּכָרִין עֶסֶר, “(there are) ten (unspecified) talents. (Code:) ΔΙ” — The Greek letters may specify the material. It is possible to read כְּכָרִין as כְּכָרִין, “in pitchers,” as in six other cases in the text. Accordingly, the meaning could be: (1) An undisclosed amount of pitchers contain ten unspecified objects, perhaps coins. (2) Unspecified objects are in ten pitchers. (3) The content of the ten pitchers is encoded as ΔΙ. See Appendices A and C.

17 AC 5, 102b.

18 It may be connected to זִקִּים (BH, pl.), “prisoner’s chain” (e.g., Isa. 45:14); זִיק (MH), “water-skin,” זִיקָה (MH), “duty,” and זִיקָק (MH), “water-skin maker or carrier.”

19 The Targumic forms are: וּמִזְגַּת הַמִּזְגָּה, “and she mixed her wine” (Prov. 9:2); מִזְגַּת, “bitter mixture” (Ps. 75:9); etc. See AC 5, 98b-99b; SB, 446, 478b-79a; BY 4, 2873b; ESh^{dic} 3, 1274a; I. Avinery, *Kakh batTanakh!* (1978), 37.

ITEM 10

2:10 בבור שתחת החומא מן המזרח
2:11 בשן הסלע כדין של כסף שש
2:12 ביאתו תחת הסף הגדול

- 2:10 In the cistern which is below the city wall, on the east
2:11 at the peak of the rock, (there are) six silver pitchers.
2:12 Its entrance is below the great threshold.

COMMENTARY

(2:10) **בְּבוֹר־בְּבוֹר שֶׁתַּחַת הַחוֹמָא** “In/at/by a/the pit/cistern which is below the city wall” — cf. **בְּבוֹר הַמֶּלַח שֶׁתַּחַת הַמַּעֲלוֹת** “In/at/by the salt pit which is below the steps” (2:1); **בְּקִבְרוֹבְקִבְר שֶׁתַּחַת הַסָּבִין (= הַסָּפִים)** “In/at/by a/the grave which is below the thresholds” (11:8); **בְּבוֹר־בְּבוֹר שֶׁנֶּגֶד הַשַּׁעַר הַמִּזְרָחִי** “In a/the cistern which is opposite to the eastern gate” (2:7). Regarding **בור**, see #3, 1:6; for **תַּחַת**, #25, 6:5; #30, 7:8; #49, 10:15-16.

הַחוֹמָא (fem., BH, MH), “(city) wall, fortification,” is from the root **חמה**, which in Arabic and South-Arabian means “to protect.” Its cognates are: *humitu* (Akkadian), *hmt* (Ugaritic), **חמת** (Moabite), and **חמית** (Phoenician).¹

The cache reported in this item is located in a cistern beneath a **חוֹמָא**, “city wall,” of an unnamed city, which may be Jerusalem; cf. **לְפָנֵים מִן הַחוֹמָא** “within the wall (of Jerusalem)” (m. Kel. 1:8; cf. Milik, Allegro, Pixner, Beyer, Wise; see #9, 2:7). This Mishnah also mentions the **חֵיל**, “rampart,” which was within the wall of Jerusalem. **חֵיל** as an alternate reading occurs in the Scroll, and it may be connected with the **חוֹמָא** of this item (see #49, 10:15).²

(2:10) **מִן הַמִּזְרָח** “on/at/to/from the east” — Both Biblical and Mishnaic Hebrew employ the form of **מִן ה־**, “from the,” plus a direction. However, in Mishnaic Hebrew it also means “on/at/to the” direction. Thus, **מִן הַמִּזְרָח**, “from the east,” also means “on/at/to the east” or “eastward.” The latter is essentially the same as **לְמִזְרַח־לְמִזְרָח**, “to (the) east” or “eastward” (1:2,

1 See BDB, 327; ESh^{dic} 2, 730; UT, 397b (#876); WUS, 104-05 (#944); KAI 1, 5, 33; 2, 41 (#26 A I 13,17; #181 21).

2 For a thorough study of **חֵיל וְחוֹמָא** of the Temple, see E. Eibeschtütz, — **חֵיל וְחוֹמָא**

6:9). Likewise, מִן הַצָּפוֹן, “from the north” (Ezek. 1:4; see #4, 1:11, #21, 5:2); מִן הַמַּעֲרָב, “from the west” (Dan. 8:5; see #56, 12:1); מִן הַדְרֹם, “from the south” (see #44, 9:17-10:1); מִן הַצֵּד הַמַּעֲרָבִי, “from the western side” (see #48, 10:12-13), all could mean “on/at/to the” direction.³ E.g.,

The Temple Mount was חֲמֵשׁ מֵאוֹת אַמָּה עַל חֲמֵשׁ מֵאוֹת אַמָּה (five hundred cubits by five hundred cubits; cf. Ezek. 42:20). Its largest (open area) was מִן הַדְרֹם (at the south), its second (largest open area) was מִן הַמִּזְרָח (at the east), its third (largest open area) was מִן הַצָּפוֹן (at the north), and the least (open area) was מִן הַמַּעֲרָב (at the west; m. Mid. 2:1).

(The produce of) the fourth year vineyard was brought to Jerusalem if it was within one day journey in any direction. And what is its border? Elath מִן הַדְרֹם (southward) and Aqrabah מִן הַצָּפוֹן (northward), Lod מִן הַמַּעֲרָב (westward) and the Jordan מִן הַמִּזְרָח (eastward). And when the produce became abundant (in Jerusalem, the sages) ordained that it could be redeemed (even) near the חוֹמָה (wall of Jerusalem) (m. Ma'as. Sh. 5:2).⁴

Thus, the first phrase of this item could mean: (1) “In the cistern which is below the wall from the east,” i.e., by approaching the wall from east there is the cistern. (2) “In the cistern which is below the wall to the east,” i.e., the cistern is below the eastern section of the wall. (3) “In the cistern which is below the wall eastward,” i.e., the cistern is eastward of the wall.

(2:11) בְּשֵׁן הַסֵּלַע, “in/at/by a/the peak of the rock” — This is the reading of the scholars, except MILIK⁵, who reads בִּשְׁוֹחַ סֵלַע, “in a place hollowed out of the rock.”⁵

שֵׁן הַסֵּלַע (const., same as שֵׁן שֶׁל הַסֵּלַע, abs.), “tooth of the rock,” means “peak of the rock.” It occurs three times in the Masoretic Text and once in Ben-Sira.⁶ Its Targum is שְׁנָא דְכִיפָא, “the tooth/peak of the rock” (1 Sam. 14:14). Similarly, שְׁינָא דְטוֹרָא (BTA), “the tooth of the hill,” means “peak of the hill” (b. Git. 68b). Their shortened forms are שֵׁן and שְׁינָא.⁷

רֹאשׁ הַסֵּלַע appears later in the Scroll, “top of the rock” (see #52, 11:5). In Mishnaic Hebrew סֵלַע could mean a clump of earth; e.g., אֵילָן עֲמוּ שְׁטָפוֹ נֶהָר וְהַסֵּלַע עֲמוּ, “a tree which is uprooted and the

“Sinai 100 (1987/88), 74-86.

3 Regarding the directions in the Scroll, see #19, 4:11. Bendauid (1, 99) states that in the Copper Scroll the forms מִן הַמִּזְרָח (3:11) are Biblical Hebrew, מִן הַצָּפוֹן (1:11) and מִן הַדְרֹם (10:12) are Mishnaic, while מִן הַמַּעֲרָב (4:2) is a hybrid. However, Bendauid (2, 454, 636) contradicts himself by listing cases where Biblical uses מִן הַמַּעֲרָב (e.g., מִן הַבַּיִת, מה־), while Mishnaic Hebrew uses מִן הַמַּעֲרָב (e.g., מִן הַבַּיִת, מה־).

4 This Mishnah also mentions חוֹמָה, the wall of Jerusalem.

5 BA 19 (1956), 62; SVT (1957), 22 (סלעו) is a typographical error for סלע).

6 1 Sam. 14:14 (twice); Job 39:28. M.H. Segal, *Sefer Ben-Sira hašŠalem* (1972), 207. Sharvit mention the Masoretic occurrences of סֵלַע, but not Ben-Sira (“Iyyunim,” 129).

7 E.g., 1 Sam. 14:5 and its Targum; m. Oh. 8:2.

clump of earth is with it, a river swept it away and the clump of earth is with it" (m. 'Orl. 1:3).

Alternatively *בְּשׁוּחַ וּבְשִׁיחוֹ בְּשִׁית סֶלַע* can be read as *בְּשׁוּחַ וּבְשִׁיחוֹ בְּשִׁית סֶלַע*, "in/at/by a/the (deep) pit of (the) rock" (cf. Milik⁸), i.e., the final *nun* is read as *waw/yod*, the *he* as *het/taw*, followed by a word separation. The first word is in the construct state, and the expected definite article is missing, i.e., *הַסֶּלַע*; cf. *בְּשׁוּחַ וּבְשִׁיחוֹ בְּשִׁית הָאֲדָמָא*, "in/at/by a/the clay/earth (deep) pit" (see #18, 4:9). The phrase *בְּשׁוּחַ וּבְשִׁיחוֹ בְּשִׁית סֶלַע* resembles *בְּנִיקְרָא דְּכִיפָא*, "in the cave of the rock," Targum Neophyti for *בְּסֶלַע*, "in the rock" (Num. 24:21; see #4, 1:11-12). Regarding *שׁוּחַ וּשִׁיחוֹ בְּשִׁית*, see #13, 3:8.

(2:11) *בְּדִין שֶׁל כֶּסֶף שֵׁשׁ*, "(there are) six silver pitchers," appears again later (7:10); cf. *שִׁבְעַת בְּדִין*, "seven pitchers" (9:2-3). The first word have been analyzed as follows. ALLEGRO^{PF}: *battin* (i.e., *בַּתִּין*; 2:11); "bars" (i.e., *בְּדִין*; 7:10). ALLEGRO^{PF}: "bars" (i.e., *בְּדִין*; 2:11). ALLEGRO and LURIE: *כַּדִּין*, "pitchers" (2:11, 7:10).⁸ MILIK: *בְּדִין*, "bars" (2:11, 9:3).⁹ PIXNER: "bars" (i.e., *בְּדִין*; 2:11); "pitchers" (i.e., *כַּדִּין*; 7:10).¹⁰ THORION: *בְּדִין שֶׁל כֶּסֶף*, "silver bars," where silver indicates the substance of the bar; cf. *סְדִין שֶׁל בּוּץ*, "sheets of byssus" (m. Yoma 3:4). Alternatively, *כַּדִּין שֶׁל כֶּסֶף*, "silver pitchers," where *כֶּסֶף* is either the composition of the pitchers or nature of their content.¹¹ WOLTERS: *כַּדִּין*, "jars" (2:11, 7:10, 9:3).¹² WISE: "jars" (i.e., *כַּדִּין*; 2:11, 7:10).¹³ The other scholars agree with Milik.¹⁴

שִׁבְעַת בְּדִין means "seven pitchers," while *בְּדִין שֶׁל כֶּסֶף שֵׁשׁ* (same as the construct *בְּדִין שֶׁל כֶּסֶף שֵׁשׁ*) could mean either "six silver pitchers," or "six pitchers (containing) silver (pieces/shekels)." Since often in the Scroll *kaf* and *bet* are indistinguishable, *בְּדִין* (= *בְּדִים*, pl. of *בֵּד*, "pitcher") can also be read as *בְּדִין* (= *בְּדִים*, pl. of *בֵּד*, "bar"; cf. Allegro^{PF}, Milik). Likewise, *כֶּכֶר*, "talent," can be read as *בְּכֶד*, "in a pitcher" (see #5, 1:15), and in seven cases *כֶּכֶרִין*, "talents," as *בְּכֶדִין*, "in pitchers" (see Appendix A).¹⁵ Accordingly, *שִׁבְעַת בְּדִין* means "seven bars," and *בְּדִין שֶׁל כֶּסֶף שֵׁשׁ* (same as the construct *בְּדִין שֶׁל כֶּסֶף שֵׁשׁ*), "six silver bars." Although *בֵּד* is masculine, while *שֵׁשׁ* and *שִׁבְעַת* are feminine, perhaps for the compiler(s) of the Scroll, *בֵּד* (like *בֵּדָה*) was a double

8 Allegro, 35, 45, 152 n. 150; Allegro^{rev}, 22, 24; Lurie, 72, 96.

9 Milik, 286, 291-94; Milik^E, 139-141; also (in this item), *BA* 19 (1956), 62; *SVT* (1957), 22.

10 Pixner, 346, 349.

11 Thorion, 171.

12 Wolters, 34-35, 44-45, 48-49.

13 Wise, 192, 194.

14 Garcia Martinez, 461-62; Beyer, 225-27, 229-30; Vermes, 374, 376.

15 Interestingly, a Midrash states, "Scripture says, 'and Jacob remained לְבָדוֹ (alone)' (Gen. 32:25). Do not read as לְבָדוֹ, rather as לְכָדוֹ (for his pitcher)"; cf. *Da'at hazZeqenim*, and *Torah Shelema* on the above verse. The latter adds, it is a *bet-kaf* interchange.

gender noun (see #38, 9:3).

(2:11-12) שש בִּיאָתוֹ תַּחַת הַסֶּף הַגָּדוֹל, “six. Its entrance is below the great threshold” — There are some differences in the drawings. BAKER^{dr}: שש בָּאָתוֹ תַּחַת, only the ‘foot’ of the second *taw* can be seen due to a small lacuna. MILIK^{dr}: שש בִּיאָתוֹ תַּחַת, the *yod* is a short vertical dotted line, the second *taw*’s right leg is a dotted line, while the upper part and the left leg except its foot is missing due to a lacuna. ALLEGRO^{dr}: שש מאות ותחת, the two adjacent letters *’alef* and *waw* are at least 30 percent smaller than the previous *mem* and the following *taw*, a good letter space separates these two words, a part of the top of the second *taw* is missing due to the lacuna.

The first three words have been analyzed as follows. ALLEGRO^{pr}, ALLEGRO, and LURIE: שש מאות ותחת, “six hundreds ... and under.”¹⁶ MILIK^{org}: שש מאת, “six hundred.”¹⁷ MILIK: שש בִּיאָתוֹ תַּחַת, “six ..., at its entrance, (hidden) under.”¹⁸ BENDAVID: The Scroll uses בִּיאָתוֹ (BH), rather than כְּנִיסָתוֹ (MH). However, elsewhere Bendavid lists בִּיאָה and יִצִּיאָה as Talmudic forms versus the Biblical בּוֹא and צֵאת.¹⁹ SHARVIT: בִּיאָה is both Biblical and Mishnaic Hebrew.²⁰ The other scholars, including ALLEGRO^{rev}, agree with Milik.²¹

Concerning Allegro’s drawing, if one disregards the space between the words and reads the *mem* as *bet* (cf. מְתִיאַ עֲצִין vs. בְּתִי הָעֲצִין; see #8, 2:5), it may be reconciled with Milik’s version in one of the following ways. (1) שש תַּחַת בָּאָתוֹ (= בָּאָתוֹ) — the first *waw* may represent a Tiberian long *qamaṣ*, while the *yod* is missing due to a defective spelling. (2) שש בָּאָתוֹ (= בִּיאָתוֹ) — the first *waw* is read as a *yod*, plus the letters *’alef* and *yod* are transposed. For both solutions compare the spelling of הַבּוֹאֵת instead of הַבָּאֹת (see #1, 1:2).

The reading שש בִּיאָתוֹ תַּחַת הַסֶּף הַגָּדוֹל is supported by similar usages in the Scroll: בִּיאָתָא ... (= בִּיאָתָהּ) תַּחַת הַפְּנָא הַמַּעַרְבִית “In/at/by a/the deep pit ... its entrance is below the western corner (tower)” (see #13, 3:8-10) and בִּיאָתוֹ מִן הַכְּרֹכָהּ מַעַרְבַּת תַּחַת הָאֵבֶן הַשְּׁחוּרָא “In/at/by a/the alley ... its entrance is from/to the city/w<e>st” (see #56, 11:16-12:12). The singular masculine possessive suffix *-i* of בִּיאָתוֹ, “its (masc.) entrance,” refers to בּוֹר, “cistern, pit” (usually masc.), i.e., the entrance of the cistern. Likewise, בִּיאָתוֹ refers to בֵּית הַמִּשְׁכָּב (masc.), and

16 Allegro, 35; Lurie, 72. In Allegro’s translation the last phrase of this item is bracketed, which may indicate that Allegro considers that it is out of place, or simply the brackets are typographical errors.

17 BA 19 (1956), 62; SVT (1957), 22.

18 Milik, 286; Milik^E, 139.

19 Bendavid 1, 99; 2, 443, 494.

20 “Iyyunim,” 132.

21 Allegro^{rev}, 22; Pixner, 346; Wolters, 34-35; Garcia Martinez, 461; Beyer, 225-26; Vermes, 374; Wise, 192.

בִּיאָתָהּ = בִּיאָתָהּ, "its (fem.) entrance," refers to שִׁית, "deep pit" (fem. in the Scroll). In addition, in two cases the text could be read as בִּיאָתְךָ, "your entrance" (see #16, 4:3).

סָף (masc.) is a "threshold" located at the entrance to a house; e.g., הִיא סָף, "she came to the threshold of the house" (1 Kgs 14:17). Also city gates had "thresholds":

וְהָיָה חוּמָהּ מִחוּץ לְבֵית סָבִיב סָבִיב ... וַיָּבֹא אֶל שַׁעַר אֲשֶׁר פָּנָיו דֶּרֶךְ הַקְדִּימָה ... וַיִּמָּד
אֶת סָף הַשַּׁעַר קֶנֶה אֶחָד רָחֵב וְאֶת סָף אֶחָד קֶנֶה אֶחָד רָחֵב

And behold, there is a wall all around the outside of the Temple ... And (the angel) came to the gate which is facing the eastern road ... and measured the threshold of the gate, one reed in width, and one threshold, one reed in width (Ezek. 49:5-6)

The plural סָפִים occurs in the phrase (הַסָּפִים =) שֶׁתַּחַת הַסָּבִיבִין, "In the grave which is below the thresholds" (see #53, 11:8).

The secondary meaning of סָף is "entrance hall," where שְׁמָרֵי הַסָּף, "guards of the threshold" of the Temple (priests and Levites), or "guards of the threshold" of the king were stationed (cf. 2 Kgs 12:10; 2 Chron. 34:9).²² שְׁמַר הַסָּף, "guard of the threshold" of the king held an important position.²³

סָף (BH, MH) and its Aramaic cognate סִיפָא (related to שְׂפָה, BH, "border, lip") have several meanings, such as "door-sill, door-post, bowl, paving block of stone, stone rows, border." Moreover, סִפְאִי שְׂפָא (e.g., b. B.B. 4a; BTA), is a synonym of גִּדְּבָךְ שֶׁל אֲבָנִים, "row of stones" (see #2, 1:5.).²⁴

הַסָּף הַגָּדוֹל, "the large threshold," implies that this place also had a smaller threshold. Since the cistern is located east or at the eastern section of the wall, it may suggest that the entrance below the threshold is the eastern gate mentioned in the previous item (see #9, 2:7).

The resemblance of the above cited part of the vision of Ezekiel's Temple to this and to the previous items, strongly suggests that the unnamed city of both items refer to Jerusalem or its Temple (cf. Milik, Allegro, Pixner, Beyer, Wise).

22 Sharvit lists סָף among those words which occur only in the Bible ("Iyyunim," 129).

23 Cf. Esth. 2:21. See also BY, 5, 4141-42; BDB, 706. Rashi explains וְסָפֹת as a "vessel to make use of," and compares it to סָפֹת כֶּסֶף (2 Kgs 12:14; Rashi on 2 Sam. 17:28), and to שְׁמַר הַסָּף (Rashi in b. 'A.Z. 38b). The Targum renders שְׁמָרֵי הַסָּף as אֲמִרְכָּלִיָּא, "counselors, officers" (2 Kgs 12:10; see Jastrow, 79b).

24 See AC 6, 98a; S. Fränkel, *Die Aramäischen Fremdwörter im Arabischen* (1886), 12; Jastrow, 1011a; BDB, 706; KS 2, 136b; *Dictionnaire Arameen-Hebreu*, 323b and n. 62; also, *Talmud Bavli 'im Targum 'Ivri* to b. B.B. 5a.

ITEM 11

בברכא שבמזרח כחלת במקצע	2:13
הצפוני חפור אמת בא ארבע	2:14
ככרין	2:15

- 2:13 In the pond which is in the east of Kahelet, at the northern
 2:14 corner, in it are buried four cubits (deep),
 2:15 22 (unspecified) talents.

COMMENTARY

(2:13) בברכא שבמזרח כחלת, "In a/the pond which is at (the) east of Kahelet"; cf. בשיתובשית המזרחית שבצפון (= שבעפון) כחלת, "In the eastern deep pit which is at (the) north of Kahelet" (see #19, 4:11-12); בשיתובשית, "In a/the deep pit which is in (the) Janoah at (the) north of Kahelet" (see #60, 12:10). Regarding Kahelet, see #4, 1:9.

ברכהבריכה (fem., BH, MH; Aramaic בריכתא [abs.], Trg. 2 Kgs 18:17; Arabic *birkah*), "pond, pool, reservoir,"¹ is probably from the root ברכ, "to bend, bless." בריכה can be converted into a ritual bath, מעין ... העבירו על גבי בריכה והפסיקו הרי הוא כמקוה, "Spring (water) ... if one passed it over a pond and then cuts it off, it is like a ritual bath" (m. Miq. 5:1; cf. t. Miq. 4:8; also, Isa. 22:11).

בריכה, "pond," is synonymous with אשוח ואשיה, "pool" (see #13, 3:8); בור, "cistern, grave" (see #3, 1:6); ביב and ביבאה, "drain canal" (see #42, 9:11); ים, "sea, pool" (see #40, 9:7; 47, 10:8); מערה, "cave, burial cave, ritual bath" (see #4, 1:11-12; #7, 2:3); שוח ושיה, "cistern, pit, grave," and שית, "deep pit, grave" (see #18, 4:9); etc.²

(2:13) במקצע הצפוני, "in/at/by the northern corner," must refer to

1 Rashi says that the בריכה is like a fish-pond dug into the earth (Isa. 7:3, 36:2; etc.).

2 The rare Mishnaic term גברכת (fem.) is related to בריכה. The Talmud, discussing the Mishnah (M.Q. 1:6), asks: "What is גברכת? Rav Judah said, it is בקיע (a trench). ... Ab-baye said ..., גיהא ובר גיהא (a burial niche [i.e., *kokh*], or a small burial niche [i.e., *kokh*)" (b. M.Q. 8b). See on the Gemara: Rabbenu Hananel, Rashi, Tosaphot; on the Mishnah: *Tif'eret Israel*, Kehati; on the term: BY 4, 3493b-94a and n. 4; on the topic: E.Y. Kutscher, "כרך and its Cognates," *EI* 8 (1967), 273-79. See also #59, 12:8. Accordingly, בריכה like גברכת, "pond," may also mean "burial niche," as some of its synonyms in the Scroll.

the בְּרֶכָה, "pool." Regarding the second word, the drawings differ. BAKER^{dr}: [הַצִּפְנִי]; MILIK^{dr}: הַצִּפְנִי (defective); ALLEGRO^{dr}: הַצִּפְנִי (*plene*).

מִקְצוֹעַ (masc., pl. מִקְצוֹעוֹת, const. מִקְצוֹעִי) means "corner" (from the root קָצַע, "to cut off," with a locative *mem*). Its second occurrence in the Scroll is spelled *plene*, מִקְצוֹעֵיהָ, "its (fem.) corners" (see #50, 11:1). Cf. לְשֹׁכֶת הַטְּלָאִים הָיְתָה בַּמִּקְצוֹעַ צְפוֹנִית מִעֲרֵבִית, "the chamber of the lambs was in the northwestern corner (of the Temple Court)" (m. Tamid 3:3). In the latter מִקְצוֹעַ seems to be feminine. פִּנָּה (fem.), a synonym of מִקְצוֹעַ, also occurs in the Scroll (3:1,4,10, 7:11, 11:2). Some define מִקְצוֹעַ as an inside corner, while פִּנָּה as an outside corner (see #12, 3:1). Regarding צִפּוֹן, see #19, 4:11.

(2:14) הַפּוֹרוֹתָפוֹר אֲמַת בְּאַבְא (= בְּהוֹבּו) אַרְבַּע (2:14), "in it are buried four cubits (deep)," or "dig in it four cubits (deep)" — ALLEGRO and LURIE: הַפּוֹר אֲמַת אַרְבַּע, "buried at one cubit, four *sits*."³ It should be added that this measurement in the Talmud appears always as הָסִיט (e.g., m. Kel. 13:4). According to Kohut, הָסִיט is derived from the Syriac סִיטָא.⁴ Thus, both the *he* of הָסִיט (H) and the *alef* of סִיטָא (A) are definite articles. MILIK: הַפּוֹר אַרְבַּע ... אֲמַת, "dig four cubits." The *bet* and the letter fragments are dittos like אֲרוּה (1:3).⁵ BEYER: אֲמַת (אֲמַת) אַרְבַּע, "did four cubits {cubits} deep."⁶ The other scholars agree with Milik.⁷

Regarding the two words preceding אַרְבַּע, the drawings differ. BAKER^{dr}: the upper part of an *alef* followed by a *mem*, *he*, space, *bet*, two 'hands' and a 'leg' of a broken letter; a small piece is missing below the letter *bet*.⁸ MILIK^{dr}: אֲמַת followed by a space, a *bet*, a dotted almost circular shape with two solid 'hands' and one solid 'left leg'; a small piece is missing below the *bet*.⁹ ALLEGRO^{dr}: אֲמַת סִיט; around סִיט there are several dotted lines indicating cracks, but nothing is missing. Allegro notes that the *samekh* "is on a broken piece replaced at a wrong angle."¹⁰

The drawing differences raise serious questions. Baker's drawings were made at the time of the opening of the Scroll. Milik's drawings are corrected versions of Baker's. Allegro's drawings were made in Jordan at much later date (see "Drawings" in the Discussion). It is difficult to reconcile the following contradictions. (1) The drawings of Baker and Milik have a *bet*, a broken character, and a missing piece below the *bet*, while Allegro's drawing

3 Allegro, 35 (the colon instead of a comma is a typographical error); Allegro^{rev} (the apostrophe is typographical error), 22; Lurie, 73 and n. 3.

4 AC 6, 35b-36a. See also Jastrow, 977b.

5 Milik, 286-7; Milik^E, 139.

6 Beyer, 225-26.

7 Pixner, 346; Wolters, 34-34; Garcia Martinez, 461; Vermes, 374; Wise, 192.

8 Milik, pl. xlv.

9 Milik, pl. l.

10 Allegro, 34, 141 n. 57.

has סִיט and some cracks. This would suggest that after Milik corrected Baker's drawings and before Allegro's drawings were made, small pieces were replaced and/or glued to the Scroll, creating the word סִיט. Consequently, one may conclude that Baker's drawings are the correct ones, while the dotted, almost circular shape should be disregarded in Milik's drawings. (2) In addition, the irregular shape of the bottom of the second column, the drawings differ. In this case the photographs of the Zuckermans support Milik's drawings except the first letter of the second word which resembles a *samekh* as in Allegro's. Yet it is still difficult to read סִיט, as does Allegro.

Behind the *bet*, the upper two hands and the lower left leg of the damaged letter could be parts of an *'alef*; i.e., בָּא. This word can be vocalized as בָּא = בָּה, "in it (fem.)," referring to the feminine בִּרְכָא; or as בָּה = בָּה, the archaic form of בּו, "in it (masc.)," referring to the masculine הַצְפוֹנִי (see #5, 1:13; #8, 2:6; #13, 3:9).

The phrase תְּפֹרוֹתָפֹר אֵמֶת בָּאִיבָא אֲרִבֵּעַ has an unusual word order, since one would expect either תְּפֹרוֹתָפֹר בָּאִיבָא אֵמֶת אֲרִבֵּעַ, or תְּפֹרוֹתָפֹר בָּאִיבָא אֵמֶת אֲרִבֵּעַ, "in it is hidden/dig four cubits (deep)." Cf. אֵמֶת תַּחַת הַמִּדְּיָהֶמֶת, אֵמֶת אֲרִבֵּעַ, instead of אֵמֶת תַּחַת הַמִּדְּיָהֶמֶת, אֵמֶת אֲרִבֵּעַ, "three cubits below the board/corpse" (see #14, 3:12-13); and לְמִזְרַח אֵמֶת אֲרִיחַ instead of לְמִזְרַח אֵמֶת אֲרִיחַ, "toward east of Ariaiah (at a distance of) forty cubits" (alt., see #1, 1:2-3).

Both explanations, בָּא ... בִּבְרָכָאִיבִּרְכָא, "in a/the pool ... in it (fem.)," or בָּא ... בְּמִקְצַע־בְּמִקְצַע הַצְפֹּנִי, "in the northern corner ... in it (masc.)," resemble the following phrases: בּוּר בְּ[] "a pit/cistern, in [it] (masc.)" (2:6); בּוּר בְּ[] "in a/the pit/cistern ... in it (masc.)" (2:8); קָלָל בּוּ, "a *qalal* (vessel), in it (masc.)" (6:4-5); בִּקְבֹר בּוּ, "in (the) grave ... in it (masc.)" (11:9-10); וּבְמִזְקָאִיבְּמִזְקָא שְׁבוּ, "and in a/the channel which is in it (masc.)" (2:9); בְּדִין־בְּדִין ... בְּצִירְחִיבְּצִירְחִי שְׁבָאִשְׁבָּא, "in (the) Din ... in a/the catacomb/tower which is in it (fem./masc.)" (8:14); כָּל שְׁבָה ... בְּשִׁית־בְּשִׁית, "in a/the deep pit ... everything in it (fem.)" (9:14-16). The form ... בְּ... means, "in (a/the) ... (which is) in it(s) ..." (see #3, 1:6:7; #9, 2:9; #37, 8:14; #43, 9:14-16; #45, 10:4; #54, 11:9).

(2:15) 22 כְּכִרִין, "22 (unspecified) talents" — It is possible to read in seven cases in the Scroll the word כְּכִרִין, "talents," as כְּכִדִין, "in pitchers." Accordingly, this phrase could mean: (1) "(there are) 22 (unspecified) talents"; (2) "(there are an undisclosed amount of unspecified objects) in 22 pitchers"; or (3) "in (an undisclosed number of) pitchers (there are) 22 (unspecified objects)." See Appendix A.

ITEM 12

בח[צר נב]ט תחת הפנא הדרו<->	3:1
מית אמות תשע כלי כסף וזהב של	3:2
דמע מזרקות כוסות מנקיאות	3:3
קסאות כל שש מאות ותשע	3:4
תחת הפנא האחרת המזרח<->	3:5
ית חפר אמות שש עסרה כסף	3:6
TP 40 ככ	3:7

- 3:1 In the C[ourtyard of Neba]t, below the southern cor-
 3:2 ner, nine cubits (deep) are dedicated silver and gold
 3:3 vessels: sprinkling basins, cups, (show-bread)
 supports,
 3:4 (show-bread covering) tubes; a total of six hundred
 and nine.
 3:5 Below the other, the eastern cor-
 3:6 ner, sixteen cubits (deep) are buried 40
 3:7 k(arsh of) silver. (Code:) TP.

COMMENTARY

(3:1) בַּח[צֵר נֶבֶט]פֶּלֶט, “In/at/by the C[ourtyard of Neba]t/Pele]t” — ALLEGRO^{PT}: “in it [...]” (i.e., [...] בַּה). ALLEGRO: בַּח[...], “In the C[ourt of (?) ...]”; perhaps בַּח[צֵר פֶּשֶׁט], “in the court of flaying,” or בַּח[צֵר שֶׁחֶט], “in the court of slaying.”¹ MILIK: בַּחצֵר[... יֵאֵט] (two-three characters are added on the basis of some unpublished fragments), “In the Cour[t of *Peribolos*.” *Peribolos* (from Greek) may be the outer colonnade of the Temple.² ALLEGRO^{EV}, LURIE, PIXNER, GARCIA MARTINEZ, and VERMES basically render, “In the [court] of ...”³ YADIN: בַּחצֵר[... ט], “In the cour[t ...].”⁴ WOLTERS follows Milik.⁵ BEYER: בַּחצֵר לִוְרֵי יֵאֵט, “in the half-circle formed courtyard of

1 Allegro^{PT}; Allegro, 37, 141 n. 59.

2 Milik, 287, 273 D-54; Milik^E, 139, 146.

3 Allegro^{EV}, 22; Lurie, 74-75 and n. 1; Pixner, 346; Garcia Martinez, 461; Vermes, 374.

4 *The Temple Scroll* (Eng.) 1, 227.

5 Wolters, 36-37.

Laur]eatus (or [Νιχ]ίατος).⁶ WISE: “In the courtyard of [...].”⁷

The damaged sign after the *bet* resembles a *he/het/taw* or a *dalet/reš* plus a *waw/yod*. It is followed by a lacuna of six letter spaces, and then a letter fragment that seems to be a part of a *tet*. Thus, the possible readings are: ט... ..בה, ט... ..בת, ט... ..ברו, ט... ..ברי, ט... ..בר, and ט... ..ברי. Logically, the first word should be a noun prefixed with the preposition *bet*. The second word modifies the first noun; it can be a noun, an adjective, even a verbal form. The two words may be joined by של, “of.”

The first word can be reconstructed as בִּתְּצֹר, or בִּתְּצֹרֶשׁל, “In/at/by the C[ourtyard of]” (as most scholars do). Cf. בְּכֹרֶבְבוֹר הַגָּדוֹל שֶׁבְּחֶצֶר, “In a/the great cistern which is in the Court of the Peristyle” (see #3, 1:6-7); and בְּצִרְיָה־בְּצִרְיָה שֶׁבְּחֶצֶר מְתֵי הָעֶצִּין, “In a/the catacomb which is in the cemetery of Ezion” (see #8, 2:5). Yet there are other options, as the following, selected from the vocabulary of the Scroll, show.

בְּדוֹק־בְּדוֹק = בְּדוֹק־בְּדוֹק, “in/at/by (the) Do[k (of)]” — cf. בְּדוֹק־בְּדוֹק תַּחַת פֶּנֶת, “in/at/by (the) Dok, below the corner of” (7:11).

בְּדוֹר־בְּדוֹר = בְּדוֹר־בְּדוֹר, “in/at/by (the) D[or (of)]” — cf. בְּדוֹר־בְּדוֹר שֶׁל הַשָּׂוֵא, “in/at/by (the) Dor of Shaveh” (8:14, alt.).

בְּדִין־בְּדִין = בְּדִין־בְּדִין, “in/in/at (the) Din (of)” — cf. בְּדִין־בְּדִין שֶׁל הַשָּׂוֵא, “in/at/by (the) Din of Shaveh” (8:14).

בְּדִיק־בְּדִיק = בְּדִיק־בְּדִיק־בְּדִיק, “in/at/by a/the si[ege wall (of)]” — cf. בְּדִיק־בְּדִיק, “in/at/by an/the siege wall, below the corner of” (7:11, alt.).

בְּדִיר־בְּדִיר = בְּדִיר־בְּדִיר, “in/at/by a/the st[able/st]orage (of)” — cf. בְּדִיר־בְּדִיר, “in/at/by a/the stable/storage of Shaveh” (8:14, alt.).

בְּדִיר־בְּדִיר = בְּדִיר־בְּדִיר־בְּדִיר, “in/at/by a/the dw[elling (of)]” or “in/at/by a/the wach[man’s quarter (of)]” — cf. בְּמִבְּאֵי דִּירָתָא [בְּדִיר־בְּדִיר], “in/at/by an/the alley of the watchman’s quar[ter of] the tomb” (11:16).

בְּהַר־בְּהַר = בְּהַר־בְּהַר, “in/at/by a/the m[ount (of)]” — cf. בְּהַר־בְּהַר גְּרִיזִין, “in/at/by Mount Gerizim” (12:4).

בְּחֶבְלֵה־בְּחֶבְלֵה־בְּחֶבְלֵה, “in/at/by a/the r[uin/d]istrict (of)” — cf. בְּחֶבְלֵה־בְּחֶבְלֵה־בְּחֶבְלֵה, “in/at/by a/the second ruin/district” (9:4).

בְּחֹל־בְּחֹל = בְּחֹל־בְּחֹל, “in/at/by the s[and (of)]” — cf. בְּחֹלֶה (= בְּחֹלֶה), “hidden in its (fem.) sand” (1:7; Allegro^{dr}).

בְּחֹר־בְּחֹר = בְּחֹר־בְּחֹר־בְּחֹר, “in/at/by a/the h[ole (of)]” — cf. בְּחֹר־בְּחֹר, “which (in) its east (there is) a hole” (8:2, alt.).

בְּחִיל־בְּחִיל = בְּחִיל־בְּחִיל, “in/at/by a/the ra[mpart (of)]” — cf. בְּחִיל־בְּחִיל, “of the rampart” (10:15, alt.).

בְּחִיל־בְּחִיל־בְּחִיל = בְּחִיל־בְּחִיל־בְּחִיל, “in/at/by an/the cir[cular-wall/-]sealing-ring (of)” — cf. בְּחִיל־בְּחִיל, “concealed in/at/by the circular-wall/sealing-ring” (1:7; Milik^{dr}).

6 Beyer, 225-227.

7 Wise, 192.

ברונבד = בְּרוֹנְבוֹדָבַד, “in/at/by a/the pl[atform/pa[vement (of)” — cf. בְּרוֹנְבוֹדָבַד הַשְּׁלִישִׁי, “in/at/by the third platform/pavement” (2:3).

ברונח = בְּרוֹנְחָבוֹרוֹחַ, “in/at/by a/the di[rection (of)” — cf. בְּרוֹנְחָבוֹרוֹחַ, “at a/the direction which is facing (the) sea/west” (9:7).

ברונש = בְּרוֹנְשָׁבוֹרָשׁ, “at/by a/the to[p (of)” — cf. בְּרוֹשׁ אֶמֶת הַמַּיִם, “At the outset of the water canal” (5:1).

בתור = בְּתוֹרִיבְתוֹר, “in/at/by a/the w[all (of)” — cf. שְׁמֹרְחָא תוֹר, “which (in) its east (there is) a wall” (8:2, alt.).

בתל = בְּתִלְבְּתִל, “in/at/by a/the m[ound (of)” — cf. בְּתִלְבְּתִל שֶׁל כְּהֶלֶת, “In the Mound of Kahelet” or “At Tel Kahelet” (1:9).

The missing second word seems to end with a *tet*. There are relatively few such Hebrew words, although it may be a loanword. In the following suggestions the first word can be substituted for any of the above possibilities.

בְּחָצֵר נֶבֶט, “in/at/by the C[ourtyard of Neba]t”; בְּהַר נֶבֶט, “in/at/by the M[ountain of Neba]t”; etc. — cf. יִרְבֵּעָם בֶּן נֶבֶט, “Jeroboam son of Nebat,” who rebelled against King Solomon (e.g., 1 Kgs 11:26).

בְּחָצֵר פֶּלֶט, “in/at/by the C[ourtyard of Pele]t”; בְּהַר פֶּלֶט, “in/at/by the M[ountain of Pele]t”; etc. — cf. Pelet son of Jahdai (1 Chron. 2:47), and Pelet son of Azmaweth, one of heroes of King David (1 Chron. 12:3).

בְּחָצֵר הַפְּלִיט or בְּחָצֵר הַפְּלִיטָה, “in/at/by the C[ourtyard of the Fugitiv]e;” בְּהַר הַפְּלִיט or בְּהַר הַפְּלִיטָה, “in/at/by the M[ountain of the Fugitiv]e;” etc. — בְּחָצֵר הַפְּלִיט means “the fugitive” (e.g., Gen. 14:13), while פְּלִיט is the assumed singular of פְּלִיטִים, “fugitives” (e.g., Num. 21:29). פְּלִיט, פְּלִיטָה, and פְּלִיטָה are from the root פָּלַט, “to escape” (cf. מָנַס, “escape,” see #5, 1:13, alt.).

בְּחָצֵר הַמְּקָלֶט, “in/at/by the r[efuge courtyar]d”; בְּהַר הַמְּקָלֶט, “in/at/by the M[ountain of Refuge]”; etc. — cf. עָרֵי מְקָלֶט, “refuge cities” (Num. 35:11, 13, 14; from the root קָלַט, “to absorb”).

בְּחָצֵר הַשְּׁלִיט, “in/at/by the r[uler’s courtyar]d”; בְּהַר הַשְּׁלִיט, “in/at/by the r[uler’s mountai]n”; etc. — cf. וַיֹּסֶף הוּא הַשְּׁלִיט, “and Joseph, he is the ruler” (Gen. 42:6; from the root שָׁלַט, “to dominate”).

Finally, חָצֵר נֶבֶט, Hazar Nebat, חָצֵר פֶּלֶט, Hazar Pelet, etc., could be toponyms; cf. חָצֵר אֶדְדָר, Hazar-addar or Addar Courtyard/Village (Num. 34:4); חָצֵר גַּדָּה, Hazar-gaddah or Luck Courtyard/Village (Josh. 15:27).

תַּחַת הַפִּנָּא הַדְּרוֹמִית אֲמוֹת תִּשְׁעַ ... תַּחַת הַפִּנָּא הָאֲחֵרֶת הַמְּזֻרְחִית (3:1-2, 5-6) “below the southern corner (tower), nine cubits (deep) ... below the other, the eastern corner (tower), sixteen cubits (deep) are buried (or dig sixteen cubits (deep))”⁸ — Both geographical directions

■ This is basically the reading of the scholars, except Allegro^{Pr}, who translates (from the beginning of line 3:1), “in it [...] under its corners, buried (?) at nine cubits ... under another corner to the East, there is buried (lit. dug) at sixteen cubits,” and notes to line 3:2, “מִית, for the usual חָפֹר, so ‘buried,’” and to line 3:6, “יָת, Aram. אֵית” (i.e., the same as the Hebrew יָשׁ, “there is/are”). At this stage, Allegro did not recognize that each of these words

מִית and הַמּוֹרָח and הַדְּרוֹ are interrupted; הַמּוֹרָח and הַדְּרוֹ are at the end of the line, while מִית is at the beginning of the next one. Other interrupted words in the Scroll are: הַמּוֹדֵף (Milik^{dr}) - הַמַּת (Allegro^{dr}, 3:12-13), הָעֵצְלָא (4:9-10, alt.), כַּחֲלַת (4:11-12), שְׁלוֹמוֹ (5:8-9), וְעַד (5:8-9, alt.), וּלְבֵית (Baker^{dr}, Milik^{dr}, 7:8-9), הַכּוֹזְבָא (or הַבִּיבָא, 7:14-15, alt.), הַגְּדוּלָא (11:6-7); also לְסַכְכָא (5:1-2), שְׁלוֹשׁ (5:3-4), לְאַשּׁוּחַ (5:5-6), הַדְּרוֹ or בְּדְרוֹ (9:17-10:1). Many ancient inscriptions have interrupted words; e.g., קְרָא and הַנִּקְבָּה in the Siloam Inscription (*KAI* 1, 34 [#189:2-4]). Regarding חֶפֶר, see #17, 4:7; for אֲמוֹת, #1, 1:2-3; for geographical directions, #4, 1:11; #10, 2:10; #14, 3:11-12; #19, 4:11.

A similar phrase occurs in the next item, תַּחַת הַפִּנָּא הַמַּעֲרֵבִית, “below the western corner (tower)” (3:10). פִּנָּת (const.), “corner (tower) of,” appears twice in the Scroll: תַּחַת פִּנָּת הַמְּשַׁמְרָה הַמְּשֻׁטָּח הַמְּזָרְחִית, “below the corner (tower) of the eastern guard post/spreading place” (see #31, 7:11-12); and מִתַּחַת פִּנָּת הָאֶסְטָאנָא (= פִּנָּת) הָאֶסְטָאנָא (= הָאֶסְטָאנָא) הַדְּרוֹמִית, “Below the southern corner (tower) of the ossuary” (see #52, 11:2). In these cases פִּנָּת - פִּנָּה is preceded by the preposition תַּחַת and followed by a geographical direction. It can also be compared with בְּמַעְרָא בְּמַעְרָא שֶׁל הַבֵּנָא (= הַפִּנָּה), “in/at/by a/the cave of the corner (tower)” (*bet-pe* interchange; see #26, 6:7, alt.).

פִּנָּה (fem., pl. פִּנּוֹת) occurs in the Masoretic Text thirty times; in sixteen it means “corner,” in ten “corner tower” of a fortification, twice “edge, narrow space,” and twice “leader” of the people.⁹ פִּנָּה and the related פְּנִים, “faces” (always pl.), are from the root פָּנָה, “to turn.” מַקְצוּעַ, “corner,” a synonym of פִּנָּה, appears twice in the Scroll: בְּמַקְצַע וּבְמַקְצַע הַצְּפוֹנִי, “in the northern corner” (2:13), and בְּאַרְבַּעַת מַקְצוּעוֹתֶיהָ, “in its (fem.) four corners” (10:17-11:1). According to Milik and Yadin, פִּנָּה is an outside corner while מַקְצוּעַ is an inside corner.¹⁰ However, פִּנָּה may refer to both types. E.g.,

and the Levites (keep watch on the Temple) at twenty four places ... four עַל אַרְבַּעַת פְּנוֹתָיו מִתּוֹכוֹ (at its four corners from inside) ... and four עַל אַרְבַּעַת פְּנוֹתָיו מִבְּחוּץ (at its four corners from outside; m. Mid. 1:1).

Biblical usage may distinguish between מַקְצוּעַ and פִּנָּה. E.g., עַד הַמַּקְצוּעַ וְעַד הַפִּנָּה, “till the corner and till the corner tower” (Neh. 3:24). Malbim says that פִּנָּה is a sort of tower, cf. עַל הָעָרִים הַבְּצֻרוֹת וְעַל הַפְּנוֹת הַגְּבוּהוֹת, “on the fortified cities and on the high corner towers” (Zeph. 1:16), and עַל הַמִּגְדָּלִים וְעַל הַפְּנוֹת, “on the towers and the corner towers” (2 Chron. 26:15).¹¹

בה [...] תחת פְּנוֹתֶיהָ. His reading can be reconstructed as: מִית (חֶפֶר ?) אֲמוֹת תִּשַׁע ... תחת הפּנא האחרת המזרחית (= אית - יש) חֶפֶר אֲמוֹת שֶׁשׁ עֶסְרָה.

⁹ Cf. ESh^{con} 3, 1768.

¹⁰ Milik, 239 C-11-12; Y. Yadin, *The Temple Scroll* (Heb.) 1, 158; 2, 93-94.

¹¹ See also *Mešudat Zion. Mešudat David* comments, “(The two structures) מַקְצוּעַ and פִּנָּה were next to each other” (Neh. 3:24; Zeph. 1:16). Ibn-Ezra says, הַפְּנוֹת כְּמוֹ גְּבָעוֹת, “the *pinnot* are like hilltops” (Zeph. 1:16).

הָאֵחֶרֶת, “the other one,” implies that this site had two פְּנוֹת. Since a site, such as a courtyard, usually has four corners, פָּנָא mean “corner tower,” a synonym of מִגְדָּל, “tower,” rather than “corner” (see #31, 7:11; #51, 11:2).

(3:2-4) כֶּסֶף וְזָהָב שֶׁל דְּמַע מְזֻקָּתוֹת כּוֹסוֹת מְנַקִּיאוֹת קִסָּאוֹת, “are dedicated silver and gold vessels: sprinkling basins, cups, (show-bread) supports, tubes (covering the show-bread)” — For an in-depth discussion of the *dema*^c vessels, see Appendix D.

(3:4) כָּל שֵׁשׁ מֵאוֹת וְתֵשַׁע, “a total of six hundred and nine (vessels)” — Cf. כָּל נַפְשֵׁי וְשִׁבְעִים, “a total of thirty-seven (men)” (2 Sam. 23:39); אַרְבָּעָה עָשָׂר, “a total of fourteen souls” (Gen. 46:22). Similarly, הַכֹּל, “the total, all,” appears three times in the Scroll: הַכֹּל שֶׁל דְּמַע, “all of *dema*^c” (see #4, 1:10); וְכֶסֶף הַכֹּל כְּכָרִין שֵׁשׁ מֵאוֹת, “plus a total of six hundred talents of silver” (12:7); and הַכֹּל מִשְׁקָל כְּכָרִין 71 מִנִּין עֶסְרִין, “a total weight of 71 (unspecified) talents (and) twenty (unspecified) minas” (12:9). Also cf. כָּל הַבֵּית הַכּוֹרֵה הַכּוֹרֵה, “the entire house of the niche” (12:8, alt.); and כָּל כֶּסֶף וְזָהָב, “all silver plus gold *dema*^c vessels” (12:6, alt.). Regarding the large amount of *dema*^c vessels mentioned in this item, see Appendix D.

(3:6-7) TP/TPI 40 כֶּסֶף כֹּחַ, “40 k[arsh] of silver. (Code:) TP/TPI” — ALLEGRO reads “TP,” however, he notes that an *iota* may follow the two letters, i.e., “TPI,” or the *iota* may actually be the upper extension of the shaft of the *lamed* beneath.¹² McCARTER reads both ways, “TP I” and “TP.”¹³ The other scholars read “TP.”¹⁴

The *iota* can be recognized in the drawing of BAKER, and perhaps also in MILIK’s. In ALLEGRO’s drawing the *iota* shape is a sort of attachment to the upper vertical line of the *lamed* below. Accordingly, it is possible to read both ways, TP and TPI. Furthermore, TP may be an abbreviation for the Hebrew word TRYMA = TRUMA = תְּרוּמָה, “priestly share,” a synonym of *dema*^c. Regarding the abbreviation כֹּחַ, see Appendix A; for עֶסְרָה, Appendix B; for the Greek letters, Appendix C; for *dema*^c, Appendix D.

Finally, since this item describes two deposits in a single location, it can be subdivided into #12a (3:1 - 3:4), and #12b (3:5 - 3:7). Indeed, the scholars consider this material as two separate items.

12 Allegro, 142 n. 69.

13 “Mysterious,” 40, and “Mysteryⁱⁱ,” 236, respectively.

14 Milik, 287; Milik^E, 139; Lurie, 76; Pixner, 335 and n. 32, 346; Wolters, 36-37; Garcia Martinez, 461; Beyer, 225, 227, renders Τρ(ύφωv) as Pixner suggests; Vermes, 375; Wise, 192 (transliterates as “TR”).

ITEM 13

בשית שבמלח מבצפּונו 3:8
כלי דמע ולבושין ביאתא 3:9
תחת הפנא המערבית 3:10

- 3:8 In the deep pit which is in Melah, in its north,
3:9 (there are an unspecified number of) dedicated vessels
and covers. Its entrance
3:10 (is) below the western corner.

COMMENTARY

(3:8) *בְּשִׁית־בְּשִׁית שְׁבַמְלַח־שְׁבַמְלַח מִבְּצָפוֹן* “In/at/by a/the deep pit which is in (the) Melah, in its north,” resembles the beginning of the next item, *בְּקֶבֶר* - *בְּקֶבֶר שְׁבַמְלַח־שְׁבַמְלַח מִמְּזֶרְחוֹ בְּצָפוֹן־בְּצָפוֹן* “In/at/by a/the grave which is in (the) Melah, in its (the) northeast”; see #14, 3:11-12). Regarding *שִׁית* see #18, 4:9. The word *שִׁית* can also be read as *שִׁיחַ* or *שִׁיחַ*, “pit/cistern.” While these are masculine nouns in Mishnaic Hebrew, they are feminine or double gender in the Scroll (see #18, 4:9).

The second and third words of this phrase have been analyzed as follows. ALLEGRO^{pt}: “malham” (i.e., מלחם); cf. the Arabic *malham*, “slaughter-house”; *קבר* in line 11 rules out to be a derivation from *לחם*, i.e., “dining hall.” Perhaps it means “armoury.” ALLEGRO: *שבמלחם בצפּונו* “which is in the MLHM, in its north.” מלחם was a funeral structure situated outside of Jerusalem. ALLEGRO^{rev}: “which is to the north of the Esplanade”; i.e., מלה (as Milik).¹ MILIK: *שבמלה מבצפּונו* “which is to the north of the Esplanade.” Esplanade of the Herodian Temple suggests the vocalization of *המלה*, “the Full, the Filled-in area,” cf. *מלוא* (BH) and *מליתא* (Trg.).² Elsewhere, Milik reads *המלה* כבור, “In the filled up cistern,” as a common noun (see #6, 2:1). LURIE: *שבמלחם בצפּונו* “in the north of Milham.” מלחם is either a place name or a well-known structure.³ BENDAVID: *מצפּונו* is a hybrid form of Biblical and Mishnaic Hebrew (i.e., *בצפּונו* [MH], while *מצפּונו* [BH], as *ממזרחו* [BH, 3:11]).⁴ Apparently, Bendavid reads *שבמלה מבצפּונו*.

1 Allegro, 37, 142 nn. 71, 75; “(the) MLHM” (3:8) is a typographical error for “the MLHM” (cf. 3:11). Allegro^{rev}, 22.

2 Milik, 287-88, 227 B-3b, 234 B-19h, 248 C-97, 272-73 D-53; Milik^E, 139, 146.

3 Lurie, 76-79, 77 n. 2, 78-79 and n. 1.

SHARVIT: מלה is spelled three times with a *he* for a *ḥolam*; same as biblical מלוא. However, the biblical שלמו in spelled twice in the Scroll as שלומו, *waw* for a *ḥolam*.⁵ PIXNER: "which is at the Milham at its northern end," i.e., שבמלחם בצפונו. Milham, מלחם, "war tower," is "the fortress-like tower built on top of the hill visible rock (circa 10 X 10 m) protruding from the rampart at the entrance of today's Gobat School ('American School of the Holy Land Studies')" in Jerusalem.⁶ Apparently, Pixner derives מלחם from לחם, "to fight, battle," with a prefixed locative *mem*, i.e., place of fighting, war tower. WOLTERS, GARCIA MARTINEZ, and WISE follow Allegro, while BEYER and VERMES agree with Milik.⁷

It is possible to read in both cases as שְׁבַמְלָה or שְׁבַמְלָה, "which is in (the) Millo" (like Milik). תְּמִלּוֹא, "the Millo, Citadel, Rampart" of Jerusalem (always with the definite article), occurs six times in the Masoretic Text. Its Targum is מְלִיתָא, "the mound, rampart."⁸ מְלּוֹא, accordind to Rashi, was a short wall filled with sand around the fortress of David (2 Sam. 5:9; 1 Kgs 9:15), while according to Radak, it was a wide area near the wall of Jerusalem where people assembled (2 Sam. 5:9; 1 Kgs 11:27). מְלּוֹא may be a toponym, as בֵּית מְלּוֹא, Beth-millo, a fortress near Shechem (Judg. 9:6,20).

It is also possible to read as שְׁבַמְלָה or שְׁבַמְלָה, "which is in (the) Millah," where מְלָה may be the Hebrew form of מְלִיתָא (A), Milta'. The Rehob Inscription mentions מְלִיתָא דְּכּוּרַיִם, Milta' of Kurayim (line 15),⁹ which appears in various editions and manuscripts of the Tosephta and Palestinian Talmud as מְלִיתָא דְּכּוּרַיִם רְבָתָא, מְלִיתָא דְּכּוּרַיִם רְבָתָא, etc.¹⁰

4 Bendavid 1, 99.

5 "Iyyunim," 129 and n. 19.

6 Pixner, 347 and n. 14.

7 Wolters, 36-37; Garcia Martinez, 461; Wise, 193; Beyer, 225-27; Vermes, 375.

8 2 Sam. 5:9; 1 Kgs 9:15,24, 11:27; 1 Chron. 11:8; 2 Chron. 32:5. The last two cases some versions have מְלִיתָא. The Targum for סוּלְלָה is מְלִיתָא מְלִיתָא (e.g., 2 Sam. 20:15; 2 Kgs 19:32); see #31, 7:11.

9 In the spring of 1974 the remains of a synagogue were excavated at Rehob in the Valley of Beth-Shean. A huge mosaic pavement of a 29 line inscription (c. 365 words or 1800 letters) was uncovered. It was later called the Rehob Inscription (c. 7th cent. CE). The basic content is a Halakhic text, known from the Tosephta, Palestinian Talmud, Sifre. The inscription lists additional townships in the area of Sebastia that are not mentioned in the Rabbinic sources. See, F. Vitto, "בית הכנסת של רחוב" in *Atiqot* (Hebrew) 7 (1974), 100-04, 17*-18*, xxxvi-xxxvii; Y. Sussmann, "כתובת הלכית מעמק בית-שאן" in *Tarbiz* 43 (1973/74), 88-158, v-vii, + 2 pls; "תוספות ותיקונים למאמרי 'כתובת הלכית מבית-שאן'" in *Tarbiz* 44 (1974/75), 193-95; "בתייתא ד'תחומי ארץ ישראל" in *Tarbiz* 45 (1975/76), 213-357, ii-iii; S. Lieberman, "לכותבת הלכית מעמק בית-שאן" in *Tarbiz* 45 (1975/76), 54-63, iv; E. Qimron, "כמה הערות לקריאתה כתיבתה ולשונתה של כתובת רחוב" in *Tarbiz* 45 (1975/76), 154-56; Z. Safrai, "בשולי כתובת רחוב" in *Zion* 42 (1977), 1-32, i; A. Demsky, "העיררות המותרות" in *Qadmoniot* 11 (1978), 75-77.

10 "כתובת הלכית מעמק בית-שאן" on p. 157, and the page after p. 158; "בתייתא ד'תחומי ארץ ישראל" on pp. 223, 230-31 and nn. 107-09. For a corrected reading and a composite

In the phrase *בְּבוֹרֵי הַמֶּלַח*, “in the salt pit,” “salt” modifies the “pit,” i.e., the pit is used for storing salt, while in *בְּשִׂיתֵי בְּשִׂית שְׁבַמְלַח וְשְׁבַמְלַח*, “in/at/by a/the deep pit which is in (the) Melah,” and *בְּקִבְרוֹתֵי קִבְר שְׁבַמְלַח וְשְׁבַמְלַח*, “in/at/by a/the grave which is in (the) Melah,” both *שִׂית* and *קִבְר* are located in Melah. However, *בְּבוֹרֵי הַמֶּלַח* could mean “in/at/by a/the pit/cistern of the (place) Melah,” thus the pit is located in Melah (see #6, 2:1).

עִיר הַמֶּלַח, Salt City, is one of the six cities in the Wilderness of Judah near *הַיָּם הַמֶּלַח*, the Salt Sea,¹¹ allotted to the Tribe Judah at the time of the conquest of Canaan (Josh. 15:61-62). Secacah, another of these cities, is mentioned in the Scroll (see #20 4:13). *מֶלַח* occurs as the second element in several toponyms: *גִּיאַ (א) מְלַח הַמֶּלַח*, Valley of (the) Salt in Edom (2 Sam. 8:13, 2 Chron. 25:11, Ps. 60:2, 2 Kgs 14:7), *תֵּל מֶלַח*, Tel-melah, Mound of Salt in Babylon (Ezra 2:59; Neh. 7:61), and *יָם הַמֶּלַח*, Salt Sea.

The term *מֶלַח* of the Scroll may be associated with: (1) *עִיר הַמֶּלַח* of the Bible. (2) The town of *מִלְחָא*, Salt (A); e.g., *ר' אַבְדִּימִי מִלְחָא*, “Rabbi Avdimeï (of) Milḥa” (y. B.M. 4:7 [15a]). (3) The town of *מִלְחָיָא*, Salts (A, pl.); e.g., *ר' יוֹסִי מִמְלַחָיָא*, “Rabbi Yose from Milḥayya” (Gen. Rabbah 42); *ר' דוֹסָא מִמְלַחָיָא*, “Rabbi Dosa from Milḥayya” (y. Soṭ. 3:7 [17a]). According to Kohut, *מִלְחָא* - *מִלְחָיָא* - *מִלְחָיָה*, Mellaha, is a place in Upper Galilee.¹² (4) *מִגְדֵּל מִלְחָא*, Tower of Milḥa or the Salt Tower (y. Dem. 5:1 [6a]). (5) The toponym *מֶלַח רִזְיָה*, Melah Raziza, listed in the Rehob inscription (line 18). The first element of this name occurs in the Palestinian Talmud as *מֶלַח*, while in the Sifri and Tosephta as *מִלְיָה*, *מִלְיָה*, *מִלְיָה*, and *עִלְיָה*.¹³

The composition of *מִבְּצָפוֹנוֹ* (= *מִן בְּצָפוֹן שְׁלוֹ*), “from in its (masc.) north,” i.e., “in/on its north(ern section), northward,” is similar to *מִבְּצָפוֹן וּמִבְּצָפוֹן* (= *מִן מִזְרָח שְׁלוֹ בְּצָפוֹן וּבְצָפוֹן*), literally “from its (masc.) east in (the) north,” i.e., in its northeast(ern section), or toward northeast; cf. the alter-

photograph of the Rehob Inscription, see F. Vitto, “בית הכנסת של רחוב” in *Atiqot* 7 (1974), 103, xxxvi.

11 Cf. Josh. 15:2,5. *יָם הַמֶּלַח* has several names: *יָם הָעֶרְבָה*, “the Sea of Arabah” (Josh. 3:16); *הַיָּם הַקָּדְמוֹנִי*, “the East Sea” (Ezek. 47:18); *יָמָה שֶׁל סְדוֹם*, “Sea of Sodom” (b. B.B. 64b); *יָמָה דְּסְדוֹם* (TA), “the Sea of Sodom” (b. Shab. 108b); *יָם הַמּוֹת*, Dead Sea (Exod. Rabbah 15; see *Eṣ Yosef*, cf. y. Sheq. 6:2 [23b]; also Rashi, Radak, *Meṣudat Zion*, and Malbim on Ezek. 47:8); *Mare Mortuum*, Dead Sea (first appears in Roman times). See AC 4, 135b-36a; J.D. Eisenstein, “יָם; יָמִים” in *OY* 5, 157; M. Avi-Yonah, “Dead Sea,” *EJ* 5, 1392-93; Z. Klein, “יָם-הַמֶּלַח (במקורות היהודיים)” in *EH* 19, 893-94. In the Masoretic text only *יָם סוּף*, Read/Red Sea (e.g., Exod. 13:8), is vocalized with a *patah* (const.; see MK 1, 482b). *יָמָה*, the feminine form of *יָם* (masc.; cf. Jastrow, 59b), is used in a diminutive sense, “small sea, lake” (cf. b. B.B. 64b).

12 AC 5, 152b. Regarding the possible location of *עִיר הַמֶּלַח*, see Z. Kalai, “עִיר הַמֶּלַח” in *EB* 6, 216-17.

13 The dot above the *het* of *מֶלַח* is Sussmann's work may be a printing error. It should be added that it is possible to read *מֶלַח* as *מִלְחָה* (with a *he*), and *מִלְתָּה* as *מִלְחָה* (with a *het*). See “בריתא ד'תחומי ארץ”, 157 and the page following p. 158; “כתובת הלכית מעמק בית-שאן” “בית הכנסת של רחוב”, 103, xxxvi.

nates מְבִירְחוּ בְצִפּוֹן, “from in Jericho in the north,” i.e., “north of Jericho”; מְבִירְדֵן בְצִפּוֹן, “from in Jordan in the north,” i.e., “north of the Jordan”; מְבִירְדוֹ בְצִפּוֹן, “from as it (masc.) descending in the north,” i.e., “as it descends in the north” (see #14, 3:11-12). The combined prefix מִבְּ- is often used in Mishnaic Hebrew; e.g., מִבְּעֶרֶב, “from the evening” (m. Tam. 2:5); מִבְּעוֹד יוֹם, “while it is still day” (e.g., m. Shab. 1:5; m. ‘Eruv. 6:4).¹⁴

In the phrase שְׁבִיתִי בְּשִׂית שְׁבַמְלַח־שְׁבַמְלַח מִבְּצִפּוֹנוּ the masculine suffix וֹ- must refer to a masculine noun (שִׂית is masc. in MH), rather than to the place מְלַח, since place names are feminine. While elsewhere שִׂית in the Scroll is feminine, here must be masculine (see #18, 4:9). Therefore, the meaning is, “in the north section of the deep pit which is in Melah.” On the other hand, since the common noun מְלַח, “salt,” is masculine, perhaps the compiler(s) considered the place מְלַח also masculine. Thus, it could mean, “in the deep pit which is in the northern section of Melah.”

(3:9) כְּלִי־כְלִי דָמַע וְלְבוֹשִׁין, “(there is) a dedicated vessel and (an unspecified number of) covers/garments” or “(there are an unspecified number of) dedicated vessels and covers/garments” — For the various readings, vocalizations and interpretations of this problematic phrase, as well as an in-depth discussion of the *dema*^c vessels mentioned in the Scroll, see Appendix D.

(3:9-10) בִּיאָתָהּ (= בִּיאָתָהּ) תַּחַת הַפִּנָּא הַמַּעֲרָבִית, “Its (fem.) entrance (is) below the western corner (tower)” — the feminine בִּיאָתָהּ = בִּיאָתָהּ is in apposition to שִׂית, “deep pit” (fem.). Cf. פִּתְחָהּ צִפּוֹן־צִפּוֹן, “its (fem.) entrance is hidden/north(ward),” where פִּתְחָהּ = פִּתְחָהּ, “its (fem.) entrance,” is in apposition to שִׂית; and בִּיאָתוֹ תַּחַת הַסֶּף הַגָּדוֹל, “its (masc.) entrance is below the great threshold,” where בִּיאָתוֹ (masc.) is in apposition to בּוֹר, “cistern, pit” (usually masc.; see #10, 2:12).

As noted earlier, שִׂית can also be read as שׁוֹחַ or שִׁיחַ, “pit/cistern”; and apparently they are feminine in the Scroll. However, if they are masculine as in Mishnaic Hebrew, the words in question should be vocalized as בִּיאָתָהּ = בִּיאָתָהּ = בִּיאָתוֹ and פִּתְחָהּ = פִּתְחָהּ = פִּתְחוֹ, “its (masc.) opening,” respectively (פִּתְחָהּ is a synonym of בִּיאָהּ; see #60, 12:10).

The term בִּיאָתָהּ = בִּיאָתָהּ consists of בִּיאָהּ (fem.), “entrance,” plus הָ- (sg. fem. third pers. poss. suffix), i.e., “its (fem.) entrance.” The spelling of *alef* instead of *he* (with a *mappiq*) in the words ביאתא, פתחא, שבא, etc., in the Scroll, can be compared to the verses, וְעַל אֶדְוֹם כָּלָא (= כָּלָה), “and upon Edom, all of it,” vs. וְכָל אֶדְוֹם כָּלָה, “and all Edom, all of it,” (Ezek. 36:5 and 35:15, respectively; see Radak and *Mešudat Zion* on the former verse). In addition, several times in the Masoretic Text the expected dot, i.e., *map-*

¹⁴ Cf. בְּעוֹד, “within yet” (e.g., Gen. 40:13,19), and מִעוֹד, “since one remembers” (Gen. 48:15; Num. 22:30).

piq, is missing from the *he*; e.g., לָהּ vs. לָהּ, “for her” (Num. 32:42 and Gen. 11:30, respectively). This shows that in the Masoretic tradition, occasionally the expected *mappiq he* is silent, as in the Scroll.¹⁵

On the other hand, over fifty times ה־ (sg. masc. third pers. poss. suffix) is spelled in the Masoretic Text as ה־; e.g., אָהֶלָה (*ketiv*) vs. אָהֶלוֹ (*qeri*), “his tent” (Gen. 9:21, 12:8, etc.), סוּתָה (*ketiv*) vs. סוּתוֹ (*qeri*), “his garment” (Gen. 49:11). In addition, in several places the *ketiv* is לֹא (usually means “no, not”), while the *qeri* is לוֹ (*qeri*), “his” (Exod. 21:8; Lev. 11:21, etc.). These *ketiv* cases are not mistakes, rather they reflect archaic forms.¹⁶

Additional similar cases in the Scroll are: בָּהּ = בָּהּ, “in it (fem.),” or בָּא = בָּהּ = בּוֹ, “in it (masc.)” (2:14); שָׁבָא = שָׁבָהּ, “which is in it (fem.),” or שָׁבֹא = שָׁבָהּ = שָׁבוּ, “which is in it (masc.)” (8:14); לָהּ = לָהּ (= בָּהּ), “in it (fem.),” or לֹא = לָהּ = לוֹ (= בּוֹ), “in it (masc.)” (4:10); בָּחֶלָהּ = בָּחֶלָהּ = בָּחֹלָהּ, “by its (fem.) sand,” or בָּחֶלָהּ = בָּחֹלָהּ = בָּחֹלוֹ, “by its (masc.) sand” (1:7, alt.); כִּי־רָדָהּ = כִּי־רָדָהּ = כִּי־רָדָהּ, “as it (fem.) descends,” or כִּי־רָדָהּ = כִּי־רָדָהּ = כִּי־רָדָהּ, “as it (masc.) descends” (1:13, alt.); בִּירְכָא = בִּירְכָא = בִּירְכָא, “in/at/by its (fem.) side/bottom,” or בִּירְכָא = בִּירְכָא = בִּירְכָא, “in/at/by its (masc.) side/bottom” (1:13, alt.); בָּדָהּ = בָּדָהּ, “his pitcher” (1:5, alt.); שְׁמֹרְחָהּ = שְׁמֹרְחָהּ, “which is (in) its (fem.) east,” or שְׁמֹרְחָהּ = שְׁמֹרְחָהּ = שְׁמֹרְחָהּ, “which is (in) its (masc.) east” (8:2, alt.).

The spellings, *’alef* instead of *he* (fem.) and *’alef* instead of *waw* (masc.), are similar to the Punic and Neo-Punic usage. In these Canaanite dialects both masculine and feminine third person possessive suffixes occur as *-a*; e.g., קִלָּא could mean קִילוֹ, “his voice,” or קִילוֹהָ, “her voice.”¹⁷

Finally, if פִּנָּא means “corner,” then the phrase הַפִּנָּא הַמַּעֲרִבִית indicates that the deep pit’s entrance is located below the western corner without mentioning the corner of what. If פִּנָּא means “corner tower,” then the entrance of the deep pit is located below the western corner tower. Both possibilities imply that there were also eastern, and probably northern and southern corners or corner towers. Regarding פִּנָּה, see #12, 3:1.

¹⁵ *He* cannot be geminated, thus it cannot have a *dageš* (= dot) in it. Usually at the end of a word the *he* is silent, but when it is pronounced (i.e., voiced), it is indicated by a dot. Such *he* is called הָאֵלֶּף הַיָּדֵּי, “irregular *he*.” If the expected dot is missing, it is called הָאֵלֶּף הַרַּף, “weak *he*.” See also Thorion, 165.

¹⁶ In these cases the *qeri* indicates the proper pronunciation. The archaic ה־ resembles the Aramaic ה־; e.g., בֵּיתָהּ, “his house” (Dan. 5:23; Ezra 6:11); מִשְׁכָּנָהּ, “his tent” (TO, PsJ, Gen. 9:21, etc.). In the Samaritan Pentateuch the older *he* forms were changed into *waws* (Gordis, 36 and n. 25, 92-94, 170 n. 77). Other archaic forms in the Scroll are שְׁוֹלָיו, “its (masc.) rim” (see #38, 9:1); תַּחְתֵּיוֹ for תַּחְתּוֹ, “under it (masc.)” (see #25, 6:5).

¹⁷ Z.S. Harris, *A Grammar of the Phoenician Language* (1936), 51-52; KAI 1, 14; 2, 79 (#63:3).

ITEM 14

בקר שבמלה ממזרחו	3:11
בצפון אמות תחת המ-->	3:12
ת שלוש ככ 13 [+]	3:13

- 3:11 In the grave which is in Melah, in its north-
 3:12 east, three cubits below the corp-
 3:13 se (are) 13 [+] k(arsh of) s(ilver).

COMMENTARY

(3:11-12) **בְּקֶרֶבְּבֶקֶר שְׁבַמְלַח מְמֹרְחוּ בְּצִפּוֹן־בְּצִפּוֹן**, “In/at/by a/the grave which is in (the) Melah, in its northeast” — Cf. **בְּשִׁית־בְּשִׁית שְׁבַמְלַח**, “In/at/by a/the deep pit which is in (the) Melah, in its north” (see #13, 3:8).

Regarding the first word, the drawings differ. **BAKER^{dr}**: **בַּחְבֵּר, בַּהֲבֵר, בַּתְּבֵר**; **MILIK^{dr}**: **בִּיקְרִבּוֹקֶבֶר**; **ALLEGRO^{dr}**: **בִּקְבֵּר**. According to Milik’s drawing, **בִּיקְבֵּר** may be a phonetic spelling for **בִּקְבֵּר**, the *yod* may represent a Tiberian *šewa*; cf. **בִּיגִי**, “in (the) Valley of” (see #34, 8:4, alt.); also, **שִׁיבְצִפּוֹן**, “in (the) north of” (9:14), **שִׁיבִית**, “in (the) house of” (10:5).

Concerning the third word, again the drawings differ. **BAKER^{dr}**: *mem, mem/bet, waw/zayin/yod, reš/dalet, dalet/reš, and waw/zayin/yod*. **MILIK^{dr}**: *mem, mem/bet, waw/zayin/yod, reš/dalet, he/ħet/taw, and waw/zayin/yod*. **ALLEGRO^{dr}**: *mem, mem/bet, waw/zayin/yod, reš/dalet, waw/zayin/yod, dalet/reš, and waw/zayin/yod*. The letters *reš/dalet* and *waw/zayin/yod* are touching each other, so they can be read as a single letter of *he/ħet/taw*; cf. the possible reading of **אֲרִיחַ** as **אַחַת** (see #1, 1:3). In addition, in the three drawing the last four letters are close to each other, while the first two have more space around them.

The first phrase has been analyzed as follows. **ALLEGRO**: **בִּקְבֵּר שְׁבַמְלַחַם** **בִּירִידוּ בְּצִפּוֹן**, “in the tomb which is in the MLHM, in its shaft in the north”; **בִּירִידוּ** for **בִּירִידוֹ**, “its shaft” or “its descent,” presumably of the tomb; cf. 10:1.¹ **MILIK**: **בִּיקְבֵּר שְׁבַמְלַחַם מְמֹרְחוּ בְּצִפּוֹן**, “In the tomb which is found to the northeast of the Esplanade.” The *qof* was reengraved on a *he*, false departure from **בִּיקְבֵּר שְׁבַמְלַחַם מְמֹרְחוּ** for **בִּיקְבֵּר שְׁבַמְלַחַם מְמֹרְחוּ בְּצִפּוֹן**.² **LURIE**: **בִּיקְבֵּר שְׁבַמְלַחַם מְמֹרְחוּ בְּצִפּוֹן**

1 Allegro^{Pr}; Allegro, 37, 142 nn. 71 and 75.

2 Milik, 287-88; Milik^E, 139.

בצפון, “In the grave which is in east of Milham, (in the) northern (side of the grave).” The scribe intended to write three *mems* but one was left out.³ Lurie fails to mention that Allegro’s drawing has מזרחו. BENDAVID: ממזרחו is Biblical Hebrew.⁴ Bendavid apparently reads שבמלה ממזרחו. PIXNER: “At the tomb which is to the north-east of the Milham.”⁵ WOLTERS: בקבר שבמלחם “In the tomb which is in east Milham, on the north.”⁶ WILMOT: read בקבר >ה<מזרחי שבמלחם, and restore as שבמלחם מזרחי >ה<מזרחי. GARCIA MARTINEZ: “In the tomb which is Milcham, to the North-east.”⁸ BEYER (reads as Milik): “In the (no longer used) grave site, which is the (same) terrace (and) in its northeastern part.”⁹ ALLEGRO^{rev} and VERMES agree with Milik.¹⁰ WISE: “In the grave that is in Milham, on the northeast.”¹¹

קָבֵר, “grave” (masc., pl. קָבָרִים), is mentioned in the Scroll in three ways. (1) The geographical location is given, but the name of the deceased is withheld: שְׁבַמְלַח־שְׁבַמְלַח בְּקָבֵר, “In/at/by a/the grave which is in (the) Melah” (this item); בְּקָבֵר בְּקָבֵר שְׁבַנְחַל הַכְּפֹאֵה־כְּפֹאֵה, “In the grave which is in the Wadi of the Rock/Dome” (5:12); וְקָבֵרִין עַל ... בְּשִׁית־בְּשִׁית שְׁבַנְחַל־שְׁבַנְחַל, “In the deep pit which is in (the) Janoah ... and are graves upon its opening” (12:10-11). (2) The name of the deceased is provided, but the geographical location is withheld: בְּקָבֵר צָדוֹק, “In the grave of Zadok” (11:3); בְּקָבֵר בְּנֵי הָעֵבֶט (= הָעֵבֶד) הִירְחִי, “In the grave of the Clan of Obed/t the Jerichoite” (11:9). (3) Neither the name of the deceased nor its geographical location are provided: בְּקָבֵר־בְּקָבֵר שְׁתַּחַת הַסָּבִין (= הַסָּפִין), “In/at/by a/the grave which is below the thresholds” (11:8). In view of the cryptic nature of this document, it is logical that some descriptive information was withheld. The fact that six out of the sixty items in the Scroll employ the word קָבֵר (in addition to other burial terms) demonstrates that grave-sites were popular hiding places for important objects.

The second word is שְׁבַמְלַח־שְׁבַמְלַח, “which is in (the) Melah.” For a detailed discussion see #13, 3:8.

The third and fourth words can be read, vocalized, and interpreted as follows.

מִן בִּירְחוֹ (Milik^{dr} and Baker^{dr} with minor corrections) = מִן בִּירְחוֹ בְּצִפּוֹן, “from in Jericho in the north,” i.e., “north of Jericho” — Jericho

3 Lurie, 78-79 and n. 1 (מצפון is a printing error for בצפון in the transcription, and הצפוני של [הצפוני] in the translation).

4 Bendavid 1, 99.

5 Pixner, 347 and nn. 14-15.

6 Wolters, 36-37.

7 “David J. Wilmot and the Copper Scroll,” 20.

8 Garcia Martinez, 461.

9 Beyer, 226-27.

10 Allegro^{rev}, 22; Vermes, 375.

11 Wise, 193.

occurs several times in the Scroll. Accordingly, Melah is located north of Jericho. Regarding the compound prefix **מב-**, see #13, 3:8.

מְבִירְדֵן בְּצָפוֹן (Baker^{dr}) or **מְבִירְדֵן בְּצָפוֹן** (Allegro^{dr}, *plene*, the second *yod* may represent a Tiberian *šewa*) = **מִן בְּיַרְדֵּן בְּהַצָּפוֹן**, “from in Jordan in the north,” i.e., “north of the Jordan river” — The *waw* is read as a final *nun*. Accordingly, Melah is located north of the Jordan river.

מִן בְּיַרְדֵּן שְׁלוֹ (Baker^{dr}) or **מְבִירְדֵן בְּצָפוֹן** (Allegro^{dr}, *plene*) = **מִן בְּיַרְדֵּן שְׁלוֹ**, “from in it (masc.) descends in the north,” i.e., as the grave or Melah (masc.) descends in the north — Cf. **מִיְרֵדִי בּוֹר** (*qeri*), “from my descent (to the) pit/grave” (Ps. 30:4); **יְרִידָתוֹ מִלְמַעְלָא** (fem., 10:1), and **בִּירְדָא** (= **לְסַמֵּל** = **בִּירְדָא לְשִׁמְעָל**, alt.; see #5, 1:13).

מִן בְּיַרְדֵּן שְׁלוֹ (Baker^{dr}) or **מְבִירְדֵן בְּצָפוֹן** (Allegro^{dr}, *plene*; the *dalet* is read as a short-legged final *kaf* in medial position) = **מִן בְּיַרְדֵּן שְׁלוֹ** = **מְבִירְדֵן בְּצָפוֹן**, “from in its (masc.) side in the north,” i.e., at the northern side of the grave or Melah — Cf. **בִּירְדָא לְסַמֵּל** = **בִּירְדָא לְשִׁמְעָל**, “at its (fem.) side/-bottom to the left/north” (see #5, 1:13, alt.; also #3, 1:7; #40, 9:8; for **צָפוֹן**, #19, 4:11). Regarding **יַרְדֵּן**, see #3, 1:7; #5, 3:13; #40, 9:8.

The suggested reading is **מִן בְּיַרְדֵּן שְׁלוֹ** (Baker^{dr} and Milik^{dr} with minor corrections). Allegro’s drawing is possible to read as **מְמוֹחָרוֹ**, and may be a scribal error for **מְמוֹרָחוֹ**, the fourth and fifth letters are mixed up.

מִן בְּיַרְדֵּן שְׁלוֹ (= **מִן בְּיַרְדֵּן שְׁלוֹ** = **מִן בְּיַרְדֵּן שְׁלוֹ**), “from/to its (masc.) east in/at/by (the) north,” i.e., in its northeast(ern section), or toward northeast. This is similar to **מִן בְּצָפוֹן שְׁלוֹ** = **מִן בְּצָפוֹן שְׁלוֹ**, “from in its (masc.) north,” i.e., in its north(ern section), on the north, northward, in the previous item. In these cases the masculine singular possessive suffix *l-* must refer to a masculine noun. Since **קֶבֶר** is masculine, and perhaps **שִׁית** is also masculine (as in Mishnaic Hebrew), while place names are feminine, the meaning in this item is, “in the northeastern section of the grave,” or “northeastward within the grave site,” and in the previous one, “in the northern section of the deep pit.” On the other hand, it is possible that the compiler(s) of the Scroll used Melah as a masculine noun. Accordingly, the phrase in this item means, “in the grave which is in the northeast(ern section of) Melah,” and in the previous one, “in the deep pit which is in the north(en section of) Melah (see #13, 3:8).

מִן בְּיַרְדֵּן שְׁלוֹ, “its east in (the) north,” i.e., northeast, and **מְבִירְדֵן בְּצָפוֹן**, “west in (the) south,” i.e., “southwest” (see #36, 8:11), are compound geographical directions. Cf. **בְּמַעְרֵב צָפוֹנוֹ**, “in west of its (masc.) north,” i.e., in its northwest (TS 30:7); **לְמַזְרַח צָפוֹן**, “to east of north,” i.e., “to northeast” (TS 39:14); **בְּגִבְּתוֹ מְזָרְחָא**, “south of east,” i.e., “southeast” (TS 31:10);¹² **וּמַעְרֵב צָפוֹן**, “and west of north,” i.e., and northwest (4Q274 fl

¹² See *The Temple Scroll* (Heb.) 2, 94; (Eng.) 1, 37.

i:2);¹³ כָּלִצְפוֹן מִדְּנֶהוֹן (A), “as/like to north of their east,” i.e., to their northeast (4QEn^c fl xxvi:4). Regarding the rarely used compound preposition כל-see #59, 12:8.

There are no compound geographical directions in the Masoretic Text. Mishnaic Hebrew expresses the compound geographical directions in the following manners.

and (the officiating priest) walked along (the altar) to the דְּרוֹמִית מְזֻרְחִית (south-west) corner, מְזֻרְחִית צְפוֹנִית (northeast), צְפוֹנִית מְעֻרְבִית (northwest), מְעֻרְבִית דְּרוֹמִית (southwest [corner]; m. Zev. 5:3).

(The officiating priest of the daily *Tamid* sacrifice) בָּא לוֹ לְקֶרֶן מְזֻרְחִית צְפוֹנִית (goes to the northeast corner [of the altar]), וְנוֹתֵן מְזֻרְחָה צְפוֹנָה (and he tosses [the sacrificial blood] to [the] northeast [corner of the altar]), מְעֻרְבִית דְּרוֹמִית ([then he goes to the] southwest [corner]), וְנוֹתֵן מְעֻרְבָה דְּרוֹמָה (and he tosses [the sacrificial blood] to [the] southwest [corner of the altar]; m. Tamid 4:1; cf. t. Zev. 6:12-13).

(To make a city into a square shaped area) מוֹדֵד לְקֶרֶן מְזֻרְחִית צְפוֹנִית (one measures to the northeast corner) אָמָה וְנוֹתֵן לְמְזֻרְחָה צְפוֹנָה אַלְפִים אָמָה (and adds to [the] northeast two thousand cubits), וּמוֹדֵד לְקֶרֶן מְעֻרְבִית דְּרוֹמִית (and [then] he measures to the southwest corner) אָמָה וְנוֹתֵן לְמְעֻרְבָה דְּרוֹמָה אַלְפִים אָמָה (and adds to [the] southwest two thousand cubits; t. ‘Eruv. 4:13 [6:13]).¹⁴

Seven days before the burning of the (red) cow they separate the priest who burns the (red) cow from his house מְזֻרְחָה צְפוֹנָה הַבֵּית שֶׁל פְּנֵי הַכֹּהֵן (to the chamber which is facing the Temple northeast; m. Parah 3:1).

The standard Mishnaic Hebrew compound directions are: דְּרוֹמִית מְזֻרְחִית, “southwest,” מְזֻרְחִית צְפוֹנִית, “northeast,” צְפוֹנִית מְעֻרְבִית, “northwest,” and מְעֻרְבִית דְּרוֹמִית, “southwest.” The rarely used forms מְזֻרְחָה צְפוֹנָה and מְזֻרְחָה מְעֻרְבָה, “northeast,” as well as מְעֻרְבָה דְּרוֹמָה, “southwest,”¹⁵ resemble the

13 One can claim that these compound directions are in the construct state (which are reflected in the suggested vocalizations), i.e., בְּמַעֲרָבִים מְעֻרְבִים שֶׁל צְפוֹנוֹ, “in (the) west of its north,” or בְּמַעֲרָבִים מְעֻרְבִים שֶׁבְּצִפוֹנוֹ, “in (the) west which is in its north”; לְמַזְרְחָהּ מְזֻרְחָה שֶׁל, “to (the) east of north,” or לְמַזְרְחָהּ מְזֻרְחָה שֶׁבְּצִפוֹן, “to (the) east which is in north”; נֶגֶב מְזֻרְחָה שֶׁל צְפוֹן, “south of east,” or נֶגֶב מְזֻרְחָה שֶׁבְּמִזְרָחָה, “south which is in east”; וּמַעֲרָב שֶׁל צְפוֹן, “and west of north,” or וּמַעֲרָב שֶׁבְּצִפוֹן, “and west which is in north,” respectively.

14 This Tosephta has several variant readings (see S. Lieberman, *The Tosephta* — ‘Eruvin [1962], 108-09).

15 There are some problems with these rarely used terms. Perhaps the Mishnah tells that the officiating priest goes to the northeast corner of the altar וְנוֹתֵן מְזֻרְחָה צְפוֹנָה, “and tosses (the blood) to the east side (and) to the north side” (of the altar), and goes to the southwest corner of the altar וְנוֹתֵן מְעֻרְבָה דְּרוֹמָה, “and he tosses to the west side (and) to the south side,” thus all four sides of the altar receives sacrificial blood. By other sacrifices, such as burnt, communal peace and guilt, thanksgiving, and peace offerings, the Mishnah rules that רָמֵן שְׁתֵּי מִתְנוֹת שֶׁהֵן אַרְבַּע, “their blood require two tosses which are four,” i.e., the priests required to make two tosses at opposite angles of the altar, thus all four sides of the altar receive sacrificial blood (m. Zev. 5:4-7; see Rashi, Maimonides).

usage found in the Dead Sea Scrolls.¹⁶

Finally, in the phrase **בְּבוֹר הַמֶּלַח**, “in the salt pit,” the “salt” modifies “pit,” i.e., the pit is used for storing salt, while in **בְּשִׁית שְׁבַמְלַח** (3:8) and **בְּקֶבֶר שְׁבַמְלַח**, both **שִׁית** and **קֶבֶר** are located in **מֶלַח**, *Melah* (see #6, 2:1).

(3:12-13) **אֲמוֹת תַּחַת הַמֶּת הַמֶּדֶפ שְׁלוֹשׁ**, “three cubits below the corpse/board” — BAKER^{dr} and ALLEGRO^{dr}: **הַמֶּת**; MILIK^{dr}: **הַמֶּדֶפ**. Milik’s *dalet* is the same as the right leg and top of Baker’s and Allegro’s *taw*, while a part of Milik’s *pe* is the left leg of Baker’s and Allegro’s *taw*. Although the photographs by the ZUCKERMANS tend to support Milik’s drawing, one may conclude that the original text had **הַמֶּת**. The word itself is interrupted, **הַמֶּ** is at the end of line, and **ת** or **דֶּפ** is at the beginning of the next one. Regarding interrupted words, see #12, 3:1-2.

This word has been analyzed as follows. ALLEGRO^{pr}: “the body” (i.e., **הַמֶּת**). ALLEGRO: **הַמֶּת**, “the corpse.”¹⁷ MILIK^F and MILIK^E: “the *body*” (i.e., **הַמֶּת**). MILIK: **הַמֶּדֶף**, “the stone (of the ossuary).”¹⁸ LURIE: **הַמֶּת**, “(the coffin of) the corpse.”¹⁹ PIXNER: “the stone slab” (i.e., **הַמֶּדֶף**).²⁰ WOLTERS: **הַמֶּדֶף**, “the defilement.”²¹ BEYER: **הַמֶּדֶף**, “the platform.”²² GARCIA MARTINEZ: “the trap.”²³ VERMES: “the trap(?)”²⁴ WILMOT: read **הַמֶּת שְׁלוֹשׁ אֲמוֹת תַּחַת הַמֶּת**, and restore as **אֲמוֹת שְׁלוֹשׁ <חֲפֹר> תַּחַת הַמֶּת**.²⁵ WISE follows Allegro.²⁶

16 The geographical terms, **מִזְרָח**, “east,” **מַעֲרָב**, “west,” **צָפוֹן**, “north,” **דָּרוֹם**, “south,” **יָם**, “sea, west,” etc., are masculine (e.g., ESh^{dic} 1, 461a; 3, 964a; 1283a; 4, 1447b; 5, 2254b). The forms with **־הַ** endings, **מִזְרָחָה**, **מַעֲרָבָה**, **צָפוֹנָה**, **דָּרוֹמָה**, **יָמָה**, etc., can be either feminine forms of the above, cf. **מִתֵּן** (masc.) vs. **מִתֵּנָה** (fem.), “gift” (e.g., Gen. 34:12 and Num. 18:6, respectively); or are directional (often accented on the penultimate syllable), i.e., toward that direction, e.g., **הָרָנָה** vs. **לְהָרֵן** (Trg.), “to(ward) Haran” (Gen. 28:10; see Rashi, also on Gen. 14:10; b. Yev. 13b). Occasionally, both forms are mixed, e.g., **לְמַעֲרָב לְנִגְבָּה ... לְצָפוֹנָה ... לְמִזְרָחָה ...**, “on the west ... on the east ... on the north ... on the south” (1 Chron. 26:16-17), instead of **לְנִגְבָּה ... לְצָפוֹן ... לְמִזְרָחָה ... לְמַעֲרָב** (also see #4, 1:11; #10, 2:10; #19, 4:11). Some scholars suggest that directional and geographical nouns with extra *he* endings may represent original forms (e.g., *HR* 1, 292-93). See also P. Muchowski, “Directional Terms in the Copper Scroll in the Light of the Phrases Denoting the Directions of the World,” *Methods of Investigation of the Dead Sea Scrolls and the Khirbet Qumran Site* (1994), 319-26.

17 Allegro, 37, 142 n. 77; Allegro^{rev}, 22.

18 Milik^F, 324; Milik^E, 139; Milik, 287-88; 246 C-82.

19 Lurie, 77-78 and n. 2.

20 Pixner, 347.

21 “Vocabulary,” 486 #11; “Analysis,” 249; Wolters, 36-37.

22 Beyer, 226-27.

23 Garcia Martinez, 461.

24 Vermes, 375.

25 “David J. Wilmot and the Copper Scroll,” 20. This reading, except **<חֲפֹר>**, is similar to the suggested correct word order discussed later (see Lefkovits^{diss} 1, 362).

26 Wise, 193.

מֵת (masc., pl. מֵתִים, pl. const. מֵתִי), “corpse,” also occur in the phrase, שְׂבַחְצֹר מֵתֵי הָעֶצֶן, “which is in the cemetery of Ezion” (see #8, 2:5). Cf. the children of Heth replied to Abraham, אֵת מֵתְךָ אִישׁ מִמֶּנּוּ אֵת, “in the choicest of our graves bury your dead (i.e., Sarah), none of us will withhold his grave from you for burying your dead” (Gen. 23:6)

מִדֶּף (MH) has several meanings, such as “wooden board,” “smoke producing vessel,”²⁷ “certain ritual impurity.”²⁸ It is usually vocalized as מִדֶּף, but according to Kohut it should be מִדֶּף.²⁹ Even-Shoshan suggests that מִדֶּף may originate from דָּף (masc.), “page, leaf, plank,” and it is related to the Arabic *mindaf*, “a wooden board used to cut wool.”³⁰ The phrase “under the board” may be explained that the corpse was carried on a מִטָּה, “bed,” to the grave (cf. 2 Sam. 3:31; m. Ber. 3:1), and buried without a coffin. In this grave such a board could cover the hidden treasure.

The phrase אֲמוֹת תַּחַת הַמַּתְהַמְדֵּף שְׁלוֹשׁ has an unusual word order; one would expect אֲמוֹת הַמַּתְהַמְדֵּף שְׁלוֹשׁ תַּחַת; cf. תַּחַת הַפְּנָא הִדְרוּמִית אֲמוֹת תִּשְׁעָ, “nine cubits below the southern corner” (see #12, 3:1-2); or perhaps אֲמוֹת שְׁלוֹשׁ תַּחַת הַמַּתְהַמְדֵּף. This unusual word order can be compared to the phrases: חֲפוּרֵה־פּוֹר בָּאוּבָא אֲמוֹת אַרְבַּע, instead of חֲפוּרֵה־פּוֹר אֲמוֹת אַרְבַּע, “in it hidden/dig four cubits (deep)” (see #11, 2:14); and לְמִזְרַח אֲרִיחַ אֲמוֹת אַרְבָּעִין instead of לְמִזְרַח אֲרִיחַ אֲמוֹת אַרְבָּעִין, “toward east of Arian (at a distance of) forty cubits” (see #1, 1:2-3, alt.).

(3:13) 13[+] ככ, “13[+] k(arsh of) s(ilver),” or 13 ככ, “13 k(arsh of) s(ilver)” — Since there is almost a square letter size lacuna between the numerals 10 and 1+1+1, some numerals may well be missing. Therefore, Allegro correctly reads “13 +,”³¹ however, the other scholars, including Allegro^{rev}, decipher only “13.”³²

27 “And the מִדֶּף of the bees” (m. Kel. 16:7). מִדֶּף has been explained either as a vessel used to smoke away bees when honey is removed from the beehive, or as a board placed in front of the beehive to ease the entry of the bees. Milik mentions this Mishnah. In modern Hebrew מִדֶּף is a “shelf,” while מִדֶּף is a “vessel used to smoke away the bees.”

28 מִדֶּף is a lesser ritual impurity than מִדְּרָס (cf. t. Par. 10:2). See Bertinoro and Tosephot Yom-Tov on m. Zav. 4:6. This impurity is mentioned by Milik.

29 AC 5, 90a-91a. See also Zuckerman’s *Tosephta*, lxii; BY 4, 2814b-15a. The latter is mentioned by Milik.

30 ESH^{dic} 3, 1238b-39a. Note, דָּף is also feminine, e.g., b. Men. 29b (see HR 3, 470b).

31 Allegro, 37, 142 n. 78. Allegro^{pr} indicates only three dots (“kk ...”).

32 Milik, 287-88; Milik^E, 139; Allegro^{rev}, 22; Lurie, 78-79; Pixner, 347; Wolters, 36-37; Beyer, 226-27; Garcia Martinez, 461; Vermes, 375; Wise, 193.

ITEM 15

בבור הג[דול שבכ]חלת בעמוד 4:1
 בצפוני ככ [...] ΣΚ 4:2

- 4:1 In the la[rge] cistern [which is in Ka]ḥelet, at the pillar
 4:2 in its north, (there are) [...] k(arsh of) s(ilver).
 (Coded:) ΣΚ.

COMMENTARY

(4:1) בְּבוֹר־בְּבוֹר הַגָּדוֹל שֶׁבְּכַחֲלֵת שְׁכַחֲלֵת חֲלֵת (4:1) “In/at/by the la[rge] cistern [which is in (the) Ka]ḥelet” — There is a lacuna in the middle of the top of column four, reaching into the fifth line. The first two letters of the second word are a *he/ḥet/taw* and a damaged *gimmel*. In ALLEGRO’s drawing after this damaged *gimmel* there is a letter fragment that may be the bottom of the (right) leg of a *dalet/he/waw/zayin/ḥet/yod/reš/taw*. It follows a lacuna of about seven character spaces. The first partial letters after the lacuna could be most of the top and right leg of a *he/ḥet/taw*, or a *qof* (cf. בְּקֶבֶר, 11:9). The next letter in MILIK’s drawing is an almost straight vertical dotted line that resembles a *lamed*, while ALLEGRO’s has a clear *lamed*; there is no trace in BAKER’s drawing for this letter. The last character is a *he/ḥet/taw*, but in BAKER’s drawing a part of its lower left leg is missing.

This phrase has been analyzed as follows. ALLEGRO^{pr}: “In the gr[eat] cistern [...] the hole.” ALLEGRO: (?) בְּחֵלָה ... בְּבוֹר הַגָּדוֹל, “In the Gr[eat] Cistern, [...] in] a hole (?)” ALLEGRO^{rev}: “In the Great Cistern which is in [...]”¹ MILIK: בְּבוֹר הַגָּדוֹל שֶׁבְּכַחֲלֵת (the drawing has בְּכוֹר הַגָּדוֹל, the rest is from some unpublished fragments), “In the large cistern, which is at [...]qeh.” The line of dots resembling a *lamed* between the *qof* and *he* is noted but not indicated in the reading.² LURIE: בְּבוֹר הַגָּדוֹל [...] חֲלָה מַעְמוֹד, there is no translation (perhaps due to a typographical error). Lurie states that “practically one cannot learn anything from this item,” yet he criticizes Allegro that the text has חֲלָה not חֵלָה since חֵלָה in line 1:7 (which Lurie renders as חוֹל, “sand”) is spelled with an *’alef* not with a *he*.³ This questions

1 Allegro, 39 (the question mark should be after בְּחֵלָה, rather than after בְּבוֹר הַגָּדוֹל; cf. the translation; it is a typographical error); Allegro^{rev}, 22.

2 Milik, 288 (in line 4:1 “(..)”) is a typographical error for “(..)”; Milik^E, 140.

Therefore, in all seven cases this word can also be read as בורִיבֹור (masc.), “furnace, smelter”; cf. בֵּין שְׁנֵי הַבּוֹרִים (= הַבּוֹרִים), “between the two furnaces” (see #17, 4:6, alt.); and בּוֹרִיבֹור, “burial niche” (see #8, 2:6; #59, 12:8). Accordingly, the additional readings of the phrase in question are:

בְּבוֹרִיבֹור הַגָּדוֹל שֶׁבְּכַחֲלֵת־שֶׁבֶכַחֲלֵת means, “In/at/by the large furnace/-smelter which is in (the) Kahelet.”

בְּבוֹרִיבֹור הַגָּדוֹל שֶׁבְּכַחֲלֵת־שֶׁבֶכַחֲלֵת means, “In/at/by the large burial niche which is in (the) Kahelet.”

(4:1) בְּעַמּוּד־בְּעַמּוּד בְּצִפּוֹנוֹ, “in/at/by a/the pillar in/at/by its (masc., the) north” — The masculine possessive suffix יָ (third pers. sg.) may refer either to בּוֹר, “cistern” (usually masc.), or עַמּוּד (masc.), “pillar.” בְּצִפּוֹן, “in/on the north,” appears once in the Masoretic Text (Eccl. 11:3), but it is common in Mishnaic Hebrew (e.g., m. Zev. 5:1).¹¹

If “in/at/by its north” refers to the “cistern,” then the pillar is in the northern part of the cistern. If it refers to the “pillar,” then the cache is hidden in the northern section of the pillar. On the other hand, it can be read with Lurie, מְעַמּוּד בְּצִפּוֹנוֹ, “from the pillar in/on its north,” or “north of the pillar”; cf. מִבְּצִפּוֹנוֹ, “from in its (masc.) north” (see #13, 3:8), and מִמּוֹרְחוֹ בְּצִפּוֹן־בְּצִפּוֹן, “from its (masc.) east in (the) north” (see #14, 3:11-12).¹²

(4:2) [...] כַּכ — ALLEGRO^{PF}: “*kk* [...].” ALLEGRO: [...] כַּכ, “[...] talents.”¹³ MILIK: 14 [...] כַּכ, “[...] 14 talents”; the numerals are based on fragments not indicated in the drawing.¹⁴ LURIE follows Allegro, while the rest of the scholars agree with Milik.¹⁵

This phrase could be read as: (1) [...] כַּכ (cf. Allegro), “(there are) [...] k(arsh of) s(ilver)”; (2) [...] כַּכ־רִין, “[...] ta[lents]”; or (3) [...] בַּכ־רִין, “in [...] pit[chers].” The numerals are missing due to the lacuna of 5-6 letter spaces. Similarly, there are seven cases in the Scroll where possible to read בַּכ־רִין, “talents,” as בְּכִדִּין, “in pitchers”; see Appendix A.

(4:2) ΣΚ, “(Code:) ΣΚ” — This is one of the seven sets of Greek letters in the Scroll. For a detailed discussion, see Appendix C.

11 According to Bendavid (1, 99), both בְּצִפּוֹן and בְּצִפּוֹנוֹ are Mishnaic Hebrew.

12 Regarding directions, see #4, 1:11-12; #10, 2:10; #19, 4:11-12; for עַמּוּד, see #25, 6:1.

13 Allegro, 39; Allegro^{rev}, 22.

14 Milik, 288; Milik^E, 140.

15 Lurie, 79 (there is a typographical error in the transcription); Pixner, 347; Wolters, 38-39; Garcia Martinez, 461; Beyer, 226-27; Vermes, 375; Wise, 193.